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CITY OF BERKELEY

BERKELEY CITY COUNCIL SPECIAL MEETING

APRIL 28, 2025

>> WELCOME TO THE MEETING. WE'RE GOING TO START IN A FEW MINUTES. THE FIRE MARSHAL ASKED ME TO ASK YOU IF YOU ARE NOT LINED UP TO SPEAK, PLEASE SIT IN A CHAIR SO THAT WE CAN KEEP THE AISLES AND EXITS FREE. WE DON'T WANT A BAD OUTCOME FROM NOT HAVING AN EGRESS. IF YOU ARE NOT IN LINUX FIND AN ACTUAL CHAIR. THANK YOU VERY MUCH. WE'LL START IN A FEW MINUTES. [RECORDING IN PROGRESS]

>> OKAY, WE'RE GETTING READY TO START SO IF EVERYBODY COULD FIND A SEAT. IF YOU ARE NOT LINED UP TO SPEAK, SIT IN AN ACTUAL CHAIR. MAKE SURE THE EXITS ARE CLEAR; THE AISLES ARE CLEAR FOR EGRESS. THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR ISHII: GOOD EVENING, EVERYONE. I WOULD LIKE TO ASK THAT THE CROWD QUIET DOWN PLEASE SO WE CAN GET STARTED. I'M CALLING TO ORDER THE SPECIAL MEETING. IT IS APRIL 28TH, 2025. AND I'M GOING TO ASK THE CLERK TO START BY TAKING THE ROLL.

>> CLERK: COUNCILMEMBER KESARWANI.

>> R. KESARWANI: HERE.

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>> CLERK: TAPLIN.

>> T. TAPLIN: PRESENT.

>> CLERK: BARTLETT.

>> B. BARTLETT: PRESENT.

>> CLERK: TREGUB.

>> I. TREGUB: PRESENT.

>> CLERK: O’KEEFE.

>> S. O'KEEFE: PRESENT.

>> CLERK: HUMBERT.

>> M. HUMBERT: PRESENT.

>> CLERK: MORY ISHII.

>> MAYOR ISHII: HERE.

>> CLERK: A QUORUM IS PRESENT. AND WE WILL DO THE SCRIPT FOR COUNCILMEMBER TAPLIN'S REMOTE PARTICIPATION. COUNCILMEMBER TAPLIN IS PARTICIPATING IN THE MEETING REMOTELY PURSUANT TO THE BROWN ACT AS AMENDED BY AB2249 UNDER THE JUST CAUSE EXCEPTION. A QUORUM OF THE COUNCIL IS PARTICIPATING IN PERSON AT THE NOTICED MEETING LOCATION, WHICH SATISFIES THE REQUIREMENTS OF THE BROWN ACT. COUNCILMEMBER TAPLIN, IF YOU CAN PROVIDE A DESCRIPTION RELATING OF THE NEED TO APPEAR REMOTELY NOW.

>> T. TAPLIN: I HAVE A CARE TAKING OBLIGATION THIS EVENING.

>> CLERK: THANK YOU. COUNCILMEMBER TAPLIN, PLEASE DISCLOSE IF THERE ARE ANY INDIVIDUALS 18 YEARS OF AGE OR OLDER PRESENT IN

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THE ROOM FROM WHICH YOU ARE PARTICIPATING. IF SO, THEIR RELATIONSHIP TO YOU.

>> T. TAPLIN: IN THIS ROOM, I AM JOINED BY MY SPOUSE.

>> CLERK: OKAY. AND COUNCILMEMBER TAPLIN WILL PARTICIPATE THROUGH AUDIO AND VISUAL TECHNOLOGY. WE CAN PROCEED. COUNCILMEMBER TREGUB AND VICE MAYOR KESARWANI ARE PARTICIPATING REMOTELY AS NOTICED ON THE AGENDA. SO WE CAN START.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU, ALL FOR BEING HERE THIS EVENING. I WANT TO START OFF WITH REMARKS. I APPRECIATE YOU COMING TONIGHT. AND I APPRECIATE MY COUNCIL COLLEAGUES FOR MAKING THIS A SAFE SPACE. ONE FULL OF RESPECT AND COMPASSION FOR ISSUES THAT RUN VERY DEEP FOR MANY OF US. I BELIEVE IN PEACE. AND TODAY THAT IS WHAT WE'RE HERE TO CALL FOR. I HOPE TODAY WE CAN KNOWLEDGE THE PAIN THIS TOPIC CAUSED OUR COMMUNITY. THAT WE CAN SEE THE PAIN THAT ALL ARE FEELING AND KNOWLEDGE ITS VALIDITY. WE CAN SHARE OUR STORIES WITHOUT ASSUMING ONE PERSON'S PAIN IS WORSE THAN ANOTHER. WHETHER YOUR OR YOUR FAMILY IS PERSONALLY INFLICTED, OUR CARE OUR HUMANITY IN GENERAL, I HOPE TODAY IS A DAY TO MOURN LOSSES AND STAND FOR PEACE AS A COMMUNITIES. I'M AWARE PEOPLE HAVE BEEN WAITING TO DISCUSS THE PEACE AND JUSTICE RESOLUTION SINCE SEPTEMBER OF 2024. AND I'M GRATEFUL WE'RE AT THIS PLACE WE CAN HAVE THE CONVERSATION. THANK YOU TO THOSE HERE TO SPEAK, THIS IS OUR OPPORTUNITY TO HAVE THE CONVERSATION. JUST SO FOLKS

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KNOW THE WAY THE MEETING WILL PROCEED WILL BE AS FOLLOWS. THE PEACE AND JUSTICE COMMISSION FIRST, THEY WILL HAVE 10 MINUTES TO SPEAK. I WILL ASK COUNCILMEMBER TAPLIN PRESENT HIS ALTERNATIVE AND I'LL PRESENT MY. AND THEN COUNCIL COMMENT, FOR STANDING, YOU MIGHT BE STANDING FOR A WHILE. FOR THOSE WHO NEED TO HAVE A SEAT, YOU KNOW, I WOULD LIKE TO ASK THAT IF SOMEONE COULD HOLD YOUR SPOT OR PERHAPS GRAB A CHAIR, IF YOU ARE HOLDING UP A SIGN AND YOU ARE BLOCKING SOMEONE'S VIEW, I'M GOING TO ASK YOU PUT THE SIGN LOWER SO THAT YOU ARE NOT BLOCKING ANYONE'S VIEW SO THEY CAN SEE WHAT IS GOING ON. AND THEN, JUST SOME HOUSEKEEPING THINGS AS WELL. THERE ARE RESTROOMS AND WATER TO THE RIGHT. THIS ROOM CAN GET VERY HOT WHEN IT'S FULL AND WE'RE AT MAX CAPACITY, IF YOU NEED TO STEP OUT INTO THE COURTYARD, FEEL FREE TO DO THAT. WE HAVE WINDOWSOPE AND WE'LL OPEN DOORS FOR MORE CIRCULATION. WE'RE TRYING TO KEEP THE SPACE SAFE. THAT'S IMPORTANT TO ME THIS EVENING. SO I'M GOING TO ASK THE PEACE AND JUSTICE COMMISSION GO AHEAD AND PRESENT THE RESOLUTION AND IF YOU COULD INTRODUCE YOURSELVES AND MAKE SURE THE MIC IS CLOSE, SOMETIMES CAN BE HARD TO HEAR. THANK YOU.

>> CAN YOU HEAR ME

>> MAYOR ISHII: YES.

>> GOOD AFTERNOON. I AM PASTOR PHILLIPS, THE NEW ELECTED CHAIRMAN OF THE PEACE AND JUSTICE COMMISSION. IT'S A PLEASURE TO

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BE HERE THIS EVENING. WE REALIZE BERKELEY IS IMPACTED BY WHAT IS GOING ON IN WASHINGTON D.C. TONIGHT I WANT TO ENCOURAGE YOU TO LISTEN TO OUR PRESENTATION AND VOTE ACCORDINGLY. I HAVE WITH ME COMMISSION LUKE TAYLOR WHO WILL DO THE PRESENTATION NOW. THANK YOU.

>> STAFF: GOOD AFTERNOON. MY NAME IS LUKE TAYLOR. I SERVE ON THE PEACE JUSTICE AND COMMISSION. BEFORE I INTRODUCE THE RESOLUTION, I WANT TO TAKE A MOMENT AND ACKNOWLEDGE TWO OF MY STUDENTS FROM THE GAZAIAN SUPPORT NETWORK MURDERED IN A STRIKE ON A CAFÉ.

>> MAYOR ISHII: FOLKS, PLEASE. HE'S GIVING HIS PRESENTATION; YOU ARE CUTTING INTO HIS TIME.

>> THEIR NAMES WERE AHMAD ALSO PHENE. THEY WERE PART OF A COHORT. SINCE THERE ARE NO UNIVERSITIES IN GAZA. TOO OFTEN THE CONVERSATIONS ALLIED THE HUMAN LIVES AT STAKE. IN WORKING WITH STUDENTS FROM GAZA, ONE OF THE MOST COMMON LINES WHERE I READ IS HAVING SURVIVED MULTIPLE WARS. THEY HAD SURVIVED FIVE AND NOW THEY HAVE BEEN KILLED. WITH WEAPONS WE THE UNITED STATES SENT TO ISRAEL. AS A PEACE AND JUSTICE COMMISSION, THE VERY FIRST LINE IN OUR MANDATE SAYS THE INTENTIONAL DESTRUCTION OF CITIES AND WAR IS THE RULE AND NOT THE EXCEPTION. OUR FIRST FUNCTION IS TO ADVISE THE CITY COUNCIL ON SUPPORT FOR HUMAN RIGHTS AND SELF-DETERMINATION THROUGHOUT THE WORLD SO MONEY NOW SPENT ON WAR AND PREPARATION OF WAR IS SPENT ON FULFILLING HUMAN NEEDS AND

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PROMOTION OF PEACE. THIS IS OUR REMIT. AND THE LOGIC UNDERPINNING THE RESOLUTION IN SEPTEMBER. WHAT IS REQUIRED TO CURTAIL DESTRUCTION OF CITIES AND SELF-DETERMINATION. ONE CANNOT CALL FOR PEACE WITHOUT LOOKING INTO THE MECHANISMS OF ABSENCE, AND THAT'S WHAT WE'VE DONE. THE COMMISSION'S RESOLUTION YOU WILL CONSIDER IS THE RESULT OF VAST COMMUNITY CONSULTATION WITH LOCAL AND NATIONAL ORGANIZATIONS, ACADEMICS, REPORTING, AND DOCUMENTATION FROM EVERY MAJOR HUMAN RIGHTS ORGANIZATION AND THE PLURALITY OF UNITS NATIONS ORGANS. REPRESENTS THE GLOBAL CONSENSUS, BERKELEY FOR HAVING NOT TAKEN A STANCE IS DE FACTO IN THE MINORITY AND BREECH OF RICH HISTORY OF ADVOCATING FOR JUSTICE AS WE DID WHEN WE STOOD AGAINST THE ILLEGAL WAR IN VIETNAM AND THE HORROR OF APARTHEID IN SOUTH AFRICA. TO VOTE AGAINST THE RESOLUTION IS TO SAY WE'RE WRONG, THAT WE WERE WRONG TO STAND AGAINST APARTHEID AND HANG A FLAG BEHIND THE DAYS. THOSE TWO WERE COMPLEX SIDES OR ISSUES WITH SIDES AND COMPETING NARRATIVES. EVERY INSTANCE OF INJUSTICE HAS SIDES THAT CONTRADICT ONE ANOTHER, THAT DOES NOT MEAN THE SIDES ARE EQUAL. SOMETIMES IT MEANS THAT ONE SIDE HAS ERECTED A MILITARY WALL. THAT DOESN'T MEAN THERE IS NOT A CLEAR POSITION THAT IS JUST, ABSTENTION WILL BRING ABOUT PEACE, SWITZERLAND UBSTANDED. TO REMAIN SILENCE IS TO CHOOSE THE OPPRESSOR. ISRAEL PRESENTED AID FROM ENTERING GAZA. IT'S IMPORTANT TO THINK ABOUT THAT SENTENCE,

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PREVENTED. ISRAEL PRESENTS AID FROM ENTERING GAZA, HOW CAN ONE GEOGRAPHY EXERT PREVENTION OVER ANOTHER. THAT ONE OF THE MOST ADVANCED MILITARIES. 15% OF THE BUDGET IS FROM U.S. MILITARY AID. TWENTY TRILLION THREE HUNDRED BILLION DOLLARS, WELL OVER TWICE WHAT THE NEXT COUNTRY RECEIVES. BECAUSE MONEY IS FUNGIBLE, THERE IS A DIRECT LINE BETWEEN THE BOMBS AND THE HOUSING WE DO NOT BUILD FOR OUR POOR. BETWEEN THE ARTILLERY SHELLS WE EQUIP THEM WITH AND JOBS PROGRAMS WE CUT. CONGRESS IS ABOUT TO CUT NEARLY $900 BILLION IN MEDICAID FUNDING BUT WE CAN SEND BOMB TODAY ISRAEL? LEAVING ASIDE THE RESOLUTION IN ITS ENTIRETY, HOW OUTDATED THE NUMBERS ARE, AND OUR PRIMARY ARGUMENT IS THIS IS A LOCAL ISSUE. THERE ARE A FEW POINTS OF CONTEXT WORTH HIGHLIGHTING. LAST YEAR THE DEADLIEST PLACE WAS GAZA. OTHERS TONIGHT MIGHT SPEAK TO CHILDREN AS YOUNG WITH 5 WITH SNIPER WOUNDS, KILL SHOTS. THESE ARE NOT ACCIDENTAL DEATHS AND THOSE ARE OUR BULLETS. THE MEDIAN AGE IN GAZA IS 18 DUE THE FREQUENCY OF WARS THAT TAKE ADULT LIVES. THE SCOPE OF DAMAGE IN GAZA IS DIFFICULT TO OVER STATE. NEARLY 70% OF STRUCTURES HAVE BEEN DESTROYED OVER DAMAGED AND 92% OF ALL HOUSING UNITS. THERE ARE NO FUNCTIONING UNIVERSITIES REMAINING OF THE DOZEN THAT PREVIOUSLY EXISTED AND NEARLY 40 HOSPITALS HAVE BEEN BOMBED. THE HEALTHCARE SYSTEM IS IN TATTERS. TARGETING HOSPITALS IS OF COURSE IN CONTRAVENTION OF THE GENEVA CONVENTIONS. THE IT'S

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IMPORTANT TO LOCATE THIS MOMENT. MORE THAN 70% OF PALESTINIANS IN GAZA WERE REFUGEES AND POSSESSED AFTER THEIR LANDS IN 1967. 70 PALESTINIAN REFUGEE CAMPS WITH MILLIONS. WHEN WE WROTE THE INITIAL RESOLUTION IN JULY AND AUGUST OF LAST YEAR, WE NOTED A THREAT OF A WAR LOOMING THAT CAME TO PASS IN LEBANON -- AND IN SYRIA WHERE ISRAEL OCCUPIES LARGE SWATHS OF THE HEIGHTS. SINCE THE BEGINNING OF THE WAR, NEARLY FORTH THOUSAND PALESTINIANS LOST THEIR HOMES IN THE WEST BANK. WANT OF THE JUSTIFICATIONS FOR THE UNPRECEDENTED DESTRUCTION IS SO-CALLED MILITANTS HIDE IN AREAS, THE CIVILIAN SHIELD ARGUMENT. WE MUST DESTROY ALL UNIVERSITIES, HUNDREDS OF SCHOOLS, MORE THAN A THOUSAND MOSQUES AND RELIGIOUS SITES. WHEN YOU PERMANENT THE SAME IN -- IN CITY HALL, IN ANY OF OUR CHURCHES, TEMPLES, HOSPITALS OR SCHOOLS IN BERKELEY. WOULD WE PERMIT LOGIC TO PREVAIL IF MILITANTS USE TEL AVIV TO HIDE. THE SCHOOLS BURNED TO THE GROUND. IF WE WOULD NOT TOLERATE THIS JUSTIFICATION IN THAT CONTEXT OR IN ANY OTHER, WHY WOULD WE JUSTIFY IN GAZA? FINALLY, ONE MUST CONSIDER THE IMPACT ON THE FABERABLE OF A STUDY WHEN ONE STATION, TWO IF YOU INCLUDE THE UNITED STATES IS NOT CONSTRAINED BY INTERNATIONAL LAW. DISPUTE UN RESOLUTIONS, ARREST WARRANTS, SEVERING OF DIPLOMA ATTIC TIES, IF DESPITE ALL THIS, A SINGLE NATION CAN IGNORE THE POST WORLD WAR II ORDER WE NEEDED AFTER THE HOLOCAUST. HOW A SOCIETY CORRODES IF WE CAN JUSTIFY DEATHS ON MASS. [NO AUDIO]

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CERTAINLY WON'T DO SO NOW. ADS WE'VE SEEN IN ISRAEL BROKE THE CEASEFIRE, CALLS FOR A CEASEFIRE ARE INFINITY. MATERIAL CONSTRAINTS ON THE WAR MACHINE, BY ITS NATURE, WILL CONTINUE TO CONSUME AND CONSUME INNOCENT LIVES. WE ASK YOU TO STAND ON THE SIDE OF JUSTICE THAT CREATE PEACE BY REMOVING THE MEANS FOR A GENSIDLE PROJECT. CALL FOR AN END OF WEAPONS TRANSFERS. THIS IS THE RIGHT THING TO DO FOR THE PEOPLE OF GAZA AND THE WORLD. IT IS THE RIGHT THING TO DO FOR THE CITY AND COMMUNITY OF BERKELEY. THANK YOU. [APPLAUSE]

>> MAYOR ISHII: YOU STILL HAVE A MINUTE AND 26 SECONDS. FOLKS, SORRY, EXCUSE ME. FOLKS? DID YOU WANT TO SAY ANYTHING ELSE? DO YOU HAVE ANYTHING ELSE YOU WANTED TO SAY INAND WANT TO MAKE SURE YOU DIDN'T LOSE YOUR TIME. OKAY. THANK YOU. ALL RIGHT. HEY, FOLKS. PLEASE. FOLKS. FOLKS. COME ON. I JUST WANT TO MAKE SURE YOUR PRESENTATION WAS COMPLETE. OKAY.

>> ONE THIS THING WE VOTED LAST SEPTEMBER 8-7. SO THERE WERE A LOT OF DISAGREEMENTS. THE 98 REMAINS DEMOCRACY LIVES IN BERKELEY. IT SHOULDN'T HAVE TAKEN THIS LONG FOR THE PROCESS TO COME THIS FAR. I URGE YOU AS A BERKELEY WHO LOVES BERKELEY, AS A PASTOR IN BERKELEY YOU DO THE RIGHT THING.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. OKAY. COUNCILMEMBER TAPLIN, CAN YOU PRESENT YOUR ALTERNATIVE RESOLUTION, PLEASE?

>> T. TAPLIN: THANK YOU, MADAM MAYOR. THERE IS A LAG OF 10

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SECONDS BETWEEN THE ROOM AND ZOOM. SO PLEASE LET ME KNOW IF THERE IS ANY PROBLEMS.

>> MAYOR ISHII: ABSOLUTELY.

>> T. TAPLIN: YEAH. WE ALL LOVE BERKELEY. SO I'M HAPPY TO REPRESENT BERKELEY. THE CITY NEITHER SETS DICTATES NOR INFORMS FOREIGN MILITARY POLICY. THE MEMBERS OF THE DAIS, FOR THE COMBATANTS, THE STORAGE OF MUNITIONS AND MILITARY OPERATIONS. WE ARE NOT THE U.N. SECURITY COUNCIL. IT IS FAIR WE TRY TO REFLECT SOME SEMBLANCE OF THE COMMUNITY'S WILL FOR PEACE ON THE ISRAEL HAMAS WAR. THAT IS WHAT MY ALTERNATIVE RESOLUTION ACCOMPLISHES. THE CITY OF BERKELEY HAS OUTSIDE INFLUENCE ON THE OUTCOME OF FOREIGN AFFAIRS. THE REALITY FOR DECADES THE BERKELEY CITY COUNCIL HAS DETRIMENT OF OUR PUBLIC REALM. WE'RE CONFRONTED WITH A DEFICIT AND DEFERRED INFRASTRUCTURE NEEDS. WHICH I AND THE MAYOR AND COLLEAGUES ARE COLLABORATING TO ADDRESS. THAT BEING SAID, EVERY MEMBER OF THIS DAIS HAS BEEN EMPOWERED TO EXERCISE SPEECH AND ENGAGE IN ACTIONS OF THEIR CHOOSING. WITH THE MAYOR AND COUNCIL OFFICES HAVING PROFESSIONAL 5 AND 6 FIGURE SALARIES AND PROFESSIONAL FULL-TIME STAFF, THERE IS AN -- WE'LL ADDRESS LOCAL PROBLEMS, MAINTAIN THE PUBLIC REALM AND KEEP THE CITY SOLVENT WITH UNWAVERING FOCUS. IT WOULD NO LONGER MAKE SENSE FOR ME PERSONALLY TO EXPEND THE -- BUT VERY MANY OF US HAVE TRIED. AND I'LL SAY IN CLOSING THAT I COUNCILMEMBER BARTLETT. AND

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FORMER COUNCILMEMBER ROBINSON ALL SUBMITTED RESOLUTIONS FOR PEACE AND WERE ASKED BY SOME OF THE SAME PEOPLE ADVOCATING FOR TO ADOPT THIS TO NOT SUBMIT IN FAVOR FORCING THE COUNCIL TO ADOPT SPECIFIC LANGUAGE DESPITE WHICH SEVERAL OF US PERSISTED IN DOING SO. THANK YOU. [APPLAUSE]

>> MAYOR ISHII: ARE YOU COMPLETE, COUNCILMEMBER?

>> T. TAPLIN: I AM. THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. OKAY, FOLKS, COME ON. WE'VE GOT TO HOLD DECORUM IN THE SPACE. WE HAVE CHILDREN HERE WATCHING. LET'S SHOW THEM THAT WE CAN BE RESPECTFUL. THANK YOU. FOLKS, COME ON. COME ON. THANK YOU. ALL RIGHT. I WILL NOW PRESENT MINE. SO FOR THE OPPOSITION THREE MONTHS, MY STAFF AND I HAVE MET WITH A BROAD CROSS SECTION OF THE BERKELEY STAKEHOLDERS CONCERNED ABOUT THE CRISIS IN ISRAEL AND GAZA. MY STATED GOAL HAS BEEN AND CONTINUES TO BE TO FIND COMMON GROUND, ROOTED IN COMPASSION, PEACE, AND JUSTICE. I REALIZE WE MAY NOT AGREE ON EVERYTHING BUT I'M HOPING TONIGHT WE CAN COME TOGETHER STILL. I APPRECIATE ALL THE WORK THE PEACE AND JUSTICE COMMISSION DID LAST FALL AND CONDITIONS CONTINUE TO CHANGE. OUR RESOLUTION SEEKS TO ADDRESS PEACE, THE INCREASE IN HATED CRIMES SINCE OCTOBER 2023 AND ATTACKS ON FREE SPEECH, FOR THOSE REASONS I PUT FORWARD THIS ALTERNATIVE. I'LL READ MY RESOLUTION. IT IS AVAILABLE OUT THERE. I BELIEVE THERE ARE SOME COPIES IN THE BACK. BUT I WILL ALSO

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SHARE THE SCREEN. EVEN THOUGH I UNDERSTAND THAT IT'S QUITE SMALL. YOU CAN ALSO LOOK IT UP ON THE WEBSITE. IF YOU CAN'T READ IT FROM HERE. OKAY. RESOLUTION REAFFIRMING THE CITY OF BERKELEY'S COMMITMENT TO COMBATING HATE, SUPPORTING A LASTING PEACE BETWEEN ISRAEL AND GAZA, OPPOSING A U.S. OCCUPATION OF GAZA, AND RESPECTING FREEDOM OF SPEECH. WHEREAS, ALL HUMAN LIFE IS PRECIOUS, AND THE TARGETING OF CIVILIANS IS A VIOLATION OF INTERNATIONAL HUMAN RIGHTS AND HUMANITARIAN LAW. THE BERKELEY CITY COUNCIL DEFENDS THE RIGHTS OF ALL PERSON, IRRESPECTIVE OF NATIONALITY, RACE, ETHNICITY, RELIGION, SEXUAL ORIENTATION, GENDER IDENTITY, POLITICS OR OTHER GROUP AFFILIATION TO ENJOY PEACE AND FREEDOM FROM VIOLENCE, INTIMIDATION AND HARASSMENT. HATE HAS NO PLACE IN THE CITY OF BERKELEY AND MUST NOT BE TOLERATED. AND SINCE OCTOBER 2023 BERKELEY POLICE DEPARTMENT HAS SEEN AN INCREASE OVERALL IN THE NUMBER OF ANTI-JEWISH, ANTI-ARAB, AND ANTI-MUSLIM HATE INCIDENTS. AND WHEREAS, THE BERKELEY CITY COUNCIL EXPRESSES EMPATHY, COMPASSION AND RESPECT FOR RESIDENTS WHO HAVE PERSONAL CONNECTIONS TO FAMILY AND FRIENDS IN ISRAEL AND/OR PALESTINE, OR HAVE LIVED IN THOSE COUNTRIES THEMSELVES AND ARE DEEPLY AFFECTED AND TRAUMATIZED BY THE WAR, WHICH IS INTENSIFIED BY THE HISTORICAL TRAUMA BOTH JEWISH AND PALESTINIAN PEOPLES HAVE CARRIED WITH THEM OVER GENERATIONS AS A RESULT OF LIVED EXPERIENCES. WHEREAS, BERKELEY HAS A UNIQUE

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HISTORY OF FIGHTING FOR PEACE AND UNIVERSAL HUMAN RIGHTS FOR AT LEAST 65 YEARS. THESE MOVEMENTS INCLUDE AMONG OTHERS THE ANTI-VIETNAM INDOCHINA WAR MOVEMENT, STOP THE DRAFT CAMPAIGN, OPPOSITION TO U.S. FUNDED WARS IN CENTRAL AMERICA IN THE 1980S, APARTHEID IN SOUTH AFRICA, THE GULF WAR, ELECTION AUDIT 9/11 FOREVER WARS AND OPPOSITION TO THE RUSSIAN GOVERNMENT'S INVASION OF UKRAINE. WHEREAS, THE DECADES LONG CONFLICT BETWEEN THE ISRAELI GOVERNMENT AND THE PALESTINIANS ESCALATED MILITARILY WITH THE HAMAS ATTACK ON ISRAEL ON OCTOBER 7TH, 2023, THAT RESULTED IN THE MURDER OF 1200 CIVILIANS, THE ASSAULT AND WOUNDING OF MANY OTHERS AND TAKING OF 251 HOSTAGES INCLUDING WOMEN, CHILDREN, AND THE ELDERLY AND BERKELEY BORN HERSH POLIN-GOLDBERG WHO WAS MURDERED AFTER 11 MONTHS OF CAPTIVITY. AND WHEREAS, IN THE AFTERMATH OF OCTOBER 7TH, 2023 ATTACKS, THE ISRAELI GOVERNMENT RESPONDED WITH A EXCALATION OF BOMBS AND ARTILLERY ON GAZA, RESULTING IN THE DEATHS OF THOUSANDS AND INJURIES TO MANY MORE, PREDOMINANTLY WOMEN, CHILDREN, AND ELDERLY, ALONGSIDE THE DESTRUCTION OF HOMES, HOSPITALS, SCHOOLS AND VITAL SERVICES, DEEPENING THE HUMANITARIAN CRISIS AND DISPLACING HUNDREDS OF THOUSANDS. WHEREAS, ON FEBRUARY 4TH, 2025, THE PRESIDENT DECLARED AND REPEATED IN SUBSEQUENT STATEMENTS THE UNITED STATES WOULD TAKEOVER THE GAZA STRIP AND REMOVE THE PALESTINIAN PEOPLE PERMANENTLY, PROMPTING WIDESPREAD

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CALLS FOR ADHERENCE TO INTERNATIONAL HUMANITARIAN LAW AND PROTECTION OF CIVILIANS. AND NOW, THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED THAT THE BERKELEY CITY COUNCIL REAFFIRMS ITS DEFENSE OF THE BASIC HUMAN RIGHTS OF ALL PEOPLE, IRRESPECTIVE OF RACE, ETHNICITY, RELIGION, SEXUAL ORIENTATION, GENDER IDENTITY, POLITICS OR OTHER GROUP AFFILIATION TO ENJOY PEACE AND FREEDOM FROM VIOLENCE, INTIMIDATION AND HARASSMENT. BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, THE BERKELEY COUNCIL REAFFIRMS ITS UNEQUIVOCAL COMMITMENT TO COMBATING HATE AND BIGOTRY, INCLUDING BUT NOT LIMITED TO ANTISEMITISM AND ISLAMOPHOBIA, AND DISCRIMINATION AGAINST ISRAELIS, PALESTINIANS, JEWS, MUSLIMS, OR ARABS. AND ALSO COMMITTING TO UNITING OUR COMMUNITY IN SUPPORT OF THE RIGHTS FOR ALL PEOPLE IN BERKELEY AND ACROSS THE GLOBE TO LIVE, WORK, PLAY, WORSHIP, GATHER, ADVOCATE, PROTEST, MOURN AND CELEBRATE IN PEACE AND SAFETY, FREE FROM RACISM, BIGOTRY AND HARASSMENT OF ALL KINDS. BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, THE CITY OF BERKELEY CITY COUNCIL REITERATES AN UNWAVERING COMMITMENT TO ELEVATING OUR COLLECTIVE HUMANITY IN CALLING FOR PEACE, AND CONDEMNS ALL ACTS VIOLENCE AND MURDEROUS ATTACKS ON UNARMED INNOCENT CIVILIANS AND CALLS FOR AN IMMEDIATE, SUSTAINED AND MUTUAL END TO THE WAR BETWEEN ISRAEL AND HAMAS, THE PEACEFUL RETURN OF ALL HOSTAGES, THE IMMEDIATE SUSTAINED AND URGENT EXPANSION OF UNRESTRICTED HUMANITARIAN ASSISTANCE AND PROTECTIONS FOR PERSONS WITH

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DISABILITIES ON INTERNATIONAL LAW. AND BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, THE CITY OF BERKELEY CITY COUNCIL URGES THE UNITED STATES GOVERNMENT OF ISRAEL AND ANY ALLY COMPLIES WITH THE INTERNATIONAL HUMANITARIAN LAW AND IS NOT USED IN WAYS THAT CONTRIBUTE TO THE TARGETING OF NONCOMBATANTS, OBSTRUCTION OF HUMANITARIAN RELIEF, OR EFFORTS THAT COULD AMOUNT UNLAWFUL POPULATION TRANSFER. AND BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, THE CITY OF BERKELEY CALLS INTERNATIONAL STAKEHOLDERS TO ACTIVELY FURTHER A JUST AND LASTING PEACE BETWEEN ALL PARTIES THAT ALLOWS BOTH PALESTINIANS AND ISRAELIS TO LIVE IN FREEDOM WITH DIGNITY AND SELF-DETERMINATION AND SAFETY. THE BERKELEY CITY COUNCIL CALLS UPON LEADERSHIP OF OUR EDUCATIONAL INSTITUTIONS, THE UNIVERSITY OF CALIFORNIA, PERALTA COMMUNITY COLLEGE DISTRICTS, BERKELEY UNIFIED SCHOOL DISTRICT TO PROTECT FREE SPEECH ON CAMPUSES AND PROVIDE SUPPORT AND PROTECTION FOR STUDENTS' NON-VIOLENT EXERCISE OF THEIR RIGHT TO FREE SPEECH REGARDLESS OF THEIR NATIONALITY, RACE, ETHNICITY, RELIGION, SEXUAL ORIENTATION, GENDER IDENTITY, POLITICS OR OTHER GROUP AFFILIATION. A COPY OF THE RESOLUTION SHOULD BE SENT TO SENATOR ALEX PADILLA, ADAM SCHIFF, CONGRESSWOMAN LATEEFAH SIMON, STATE SENATOR JESSE ARREGUIN, STATE ASSEMBLY MEMBER BUFFY WICKS, UNIVERSITY OF CALIFORNIA PRESIDENT MICHAEL DRAKE, U.C. BERKELEY CHANCELLOR RICH LYONS, ALAMEDA COUNTY SUPERVISOR NIKKI BAS, PERALTA

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COMMUNITY COLLEGE CHANCELLOR GILKERSON, BERKELEY CITY COLLEGE PRESIDENT DENISE RICHARDSON, BERKELEY SCHOOL BOARD PRESIDENT BROWN AND BUSD SUPERINTENDENT MORTHEL. THANK YOU. [APPLAUSE]

>> MAYOR ISHII: FOLKS, PLEASE. PLEASE. PLEASE, PLEASE ORDER. ORDER. FOLKS, FOLKS, WE CAN'T CONTINUE IF YOU ARE YELLING LIKE THAT. HEY, FOLKS, PLEASE. PLEASE. ORDER. COUNCILMEMBER TAPLIN, YOU HAVE YOUR HAND RAISED.

>> T. TAPLIN: THANK YOU, MADAM MAYOR. MY APOLOGIES, I DIDN'T REALIZE YOU WERE READING INTO THE RECORD. I BELIEVE I HAVE TIME LEFT. IF THAT IS CORRECT, I WOULD LIKE TO READ MY RESOLUTION. AND REQUESTING THE ABILITY TO SHARE SCREEN. SORRY, IT'S DIFFICULT TO NOT BE IN THE ROOM TONIGHT. BUT I -- HAVE TO TAKE CARE OF MY MOM AND THE CITY'S SPECIAL MEETING.

>> MAYOR ISHII: GO AHEAD, COUNCILMEMBER.

>> T. TAPLIN: OKAY.

>> MAYOR ISHII: FOLKS, I EXPECT YOU TO BE RESPECTFUL WHILE HE'S READING HIS.

>> T. TAPLIN: LET'S SEE.

>> T. TAPLIN: LET'S SEE. I SEE, THERE WE GO. ARE YOU ABLE TO SEE THIS?

>> MAYOR ISHII: YES.

>> T. TAPLIN: THANK YOU. REAFFIRMING BERKELEY'S COMMITMENT TO PEACE AT HOME AND ABROAD AFTER THE OCTOBER 7TH ATTACKS. THOUGH I

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BELIEVE I TOOK THIS PART OUT IN THE DRAFT. WHEREAS THE CITY OF BERKELEY SEES ALL HUMAN LIFE AS PRECIOUS AND RECOGNIZES THE IMPORTANCE OF PEACE AND SECURITY FOR ALL COMMUNITIES IN OUR CITY, OUR STATE, OUR NATION AND OUR WORLD, REGARDLESS OF NATIONAL, ETHNIC OR RELIGIOUS AFFILIATIONS AND WHEREAS, THE MEMBERS OF THE BERKELEY COMMUNITY HAVE BEEN DEEPLY AFFECTED BY THE SUFFERING AND LOSS OF INNOCENT LIFE RESULTING FROM THE ONGOING WAR IN ISRAEL, GAZA AND LEBANON WITH MANY CARRYING DIRECT TIES TO THE CONFLICT, DRIVING FEAR FOR LOVED ONES AND PROFOUND PERSONAL LOSSES AND WHEREAS THIS CONFLICT ABROAD IS DRIVING HATE AT HOME AND THE CITY COUNCIL HAS HEARD FROM INDIVIDUAL BERKELEY RESIDENTS AND GROUPS WHO HAVE BEEN TARGETED, INSULTED AND THREATENED AND WHO FEAR FOR THEIR FAMILY'S SAFETY, SENSE OF BELONGING, AND WELL-BEING HERE IN BERKELEY AND BERKELEY SCHOOLS AND WHEREAS, BERKELEY POLICE DEPARTMENT'S 2023-2024 ANNUAL REPORTS SHOWED A LOCAL SPIKE IN HATE FOLLOWING OCTOBER 7TH 2023 INCLUDING SIGNIFICANT INCREASE IN THE RATE OF ANTI-JEWISH HATE CRIMES AND HATE INCIDENTS AND INCREASE IN ANTI-ARAB AND ANTI MUSLIM HATE CRIMES AND WHEREAS BERKELEY HAS LONG BEEN A BASTON OF TOLERANCE AND BEACON OF HOPE AND ACCEPTANCE FOR PEOPLE OF ALL BACKGROUNDS AND THESE HATEFUL INCIDENTS RUN COUNTER TO OUR COMMUNITY'S VALUES AND WHEREAS THE CITY COUNCIL OF BERKELEY ACKNOWLEDGES RESIDENTS BERKELEY HAVE STRONG AND OFTEN DIVERGENT

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OPINIONS ABOUT THE WAR IN MIDDLE EAST AND U.S. FOREIGN POLICY, WHEREAS IT IS THE RESPONSIBILITY OF THE BERKELEY CITY COUNCIL AND ELECTED OFFICIALS TO COMBAT HATE AND PROVIDE MORAL LEADERSHIP IN OUR CITY, NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED THAT BERKELEY CITY COUNCIL MAYOR OF BERKELEY GRIEVE THE TERRIBLE LOSS OF LIFE AND EMPATHIZE WITH COMMUNITY MEMBERS WHOSE FAMILIES ARE IMPACTED BY THE CONFLICT AND SHARE THE HOPE FOR A JUST AND ENDURING PEACE THAT ALLOWS ISRAELIS PALESTINIANS AND RESIDENTS OF THE REGION TO LIVE SIDE-BY-SIDE WITH DIGNITY, SECURITY HUMAN RIGHTS CIVIL RIGHTS AND SELF-DETERMINATION AND BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED CITY OF BERKELEY VALUES -- BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED THE CITY OF BERKELEY REAFFIRMS ITS COMMITMENT TO BE A SAFE AND WELCOMING PLACE FOR PEOPLE OF ALL BACKGROUNDS, RELIGIONS AND ETHNICITIES AND PLEDGES TO WORK WITH COMMUNITY LEADERS AND FIRST RESPONDERS TO KEEP EVERY MEMBER OF OUR COMMUNITY SAFE. THANK YOU. [APPLAUSE]

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU, COUNCILMEMBER. THANK YOU FOR BEING RESPECTFUL WHILE HE READ. YOU CAN CLAP, SNAP, BUT NO BOOING.

>> T. TAPLIN: IS THERE A BREACH OF DECORUM IN THE ROOM, I CAN'T TELL WHAT'S GOING ON?

>> MAYOR ISHII: THERE ARE SOME FOLKS SPEAKING. WE WILL MOVE ONTO PUBLIC COMMENT, I WOULD LIKE TO MAKE A MOTION TO SUSPEND THE RULES AND LIMIT THE COMMENT FOR THREE HOURS, TWO HOURS IN PERSON

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AND ONE HOUR FOR ZOOM PARTICIPANTS. IS THERE A SECOND? SECOND FROM COUNCILMEMBER HUMBERT.

>> CITY CLERK: OKAY, ON THE MOTION.

>> MAYOR ISHII: FOLKS, PLEASE.

>> SHE IS BLOCKING MY VIEW.

>> MAYOR ISHII: I WILL ASK, PUT YOUR SIGNS LOW ENOUGH SO FOLKS CAN SEE. WE NEED TO BE RESPECTFUL OF EACH OTHER. LET'S SET A GOOD EXAMPLE, PLEASE. GO AHEAD.

>> CITY CLERK: ON THE MOTION, COUNCILMEMBER KESARWANI?

>> R. KESARWANI: YES.

>> CITY CLERK: TAPLIN?

>> T. TAPLIN: YES.

>> CITY CLERK: BARTLETT?

>> B. BARTLETT: YES.

>> CITY CLERK: TREGUB?

>> I. TREGUB: AYE.

>> CITY CLERK: O'KEEFE?

>> S. O'KEEFE: YES.

>> CITY CLERK: BLACKABY?

>> B. BLACKABY: YES.

>> CITY CLERK: LUNAPARRA?

>> C. LUNAPARRA: ABSTAIN.

>> CITY CLERK: HUMBERT?

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>> M. HUMBERT: YES.

>> CITY CLERK: AND MAYOR ISHII?

>> MAYOR ISHII: YES.

>> CITY CLERK: MOTION CARRIES.

>> MAYOR ISHII: OKAY, SO WHAT THAT MEANS IS THERE IS GOING TO BE A CLOCK. WITH THREE HOURS ON IT. FOR PUBLIC COMMENT. AND YOU WILL ALSO HAVE YOUR OWN COMMENT TIME, WHICH WILL BE ONE MINUTE PER PERSON. AS I MENTIONED, THE WAY WE ARE SEPARATING IT IS TWO HOURS IN PERSON, ONE HOUR FOR ZOOM PARTICIPANTS. AS MANY OF YOU KNOW, I'M A STICKLER TO TIME, I WILL HOLD EACH SPEAKER TO ONE MINUTE, THAT'S BECAUSE WE WANT TO HEAR FROM AS MANY OF YOU AS POSSIBLE. UP TO THREE SPEAKERS CAN CEDE THEIR MINUTE FOR UP TO FOUR SPEAKERS FOR ONE SPEAKER. IF YOU ARE CEDING YOUR TIME YOU NEED TO BE THERE WITH THE SPEAKER, THE PERSON NEEDS TO ACTUALLY BE HERE, OTHERWISE WE CAN'T REALLY TELL THAT YOU'RE ACTUALLY CEDING YOUR TIME.

>> CITY CLERK: THEY HAVE TO HAVE THEIR HAND RAISED.

>> MAYOR ISHII: FOLKS, PLEASE. COUNCILMEMBER TAPLIN, YOU ARE STILL SHARING YOUR SCREEN. JUST F.Y.I. SO I KNOW MANY FOLKS WANT TO SPEAK, THIS IS THE TIME YOU HAVE BEEN WAITING FOR. SO I ASK THAT YOU ALL BE RESPECTFUL OF EACH OTHER. AVOID COMMENTING OR CRITICIZING PEOPLE'S TESTIMONY. BECAUSE WE WANT THIS TO MOVE SMOOTHLY SO WE CAN HEAR FROM AS MANY FOLKS AS POSSIBLE. FOLKS,

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PLEASE.

>> HE HASN'T TAKEN DOWN HIS SCREEN.

>> MAYOR ISHII: OKAY, THANK YOU. I WILL ASK THAT WE TAKE BREAKS AT THE HOUR MARK. BECAUSE MANY OF THE COMMENTS ARE QUITE HEAVY AND I DO WANT TO BE AWARE OF JUST THE EMOTIONAL TOLL IT COULD TAKE ON FOLKS. I DO WANT TO GIVE SOME BREAKS, SO WE WILL TAKE THOSE, JUST TO SET EXPECTATIONS. I REALLY RECOGNIZE THIS CONVERSATION IS EMOTIONALLY-CHARGED. I SEE IT AS MY JOB AS MODERATOR TO HOLD THE SPACE, KEEP IT SAFE AND MAKE SURE PEOPLE ARE BEING HEARD. I'M GOING TO TAKE A MOMENT.

>> [OFF MIC]

>> MAYOR ISHII: PLEASE. PLEASE? YOU NEED TO BE RESPECTFUL.

>> I AM BEING RESPECTFUL. IT'S A QUESTION ABOUT PROTOCOL. [OFF MIC]

>> MAYOR ISHII: YES, I WILL STOP THE CLOCK WHEN I MAKE A BREAK. I CAN'T HEAR EVERYTHING FROM HERE, SO YOU HAVE TO KEEP THAT IN MIND, PLEASE. SO BEFORE WE START, I JUST WANTED TO SET THE TONE A LITTLE BIT HERE. PLEASE FEEL FREE TO JOIN ME, IF YOU WOULD LIKE TO. I WILL ASK MY COLLEAGUES TO JOIN ME, JUST TO TAKE A FEW BREATHS. I WANT US TO BE HERE AND BE PRESENT AND LISTENING AND ALSO TO KEEP IN MIND, IF YOU ALL WOULD LIKE TO JOIN ME IN DOING THIS, I'M REALLY TRY TO SET THE TONE FOR HOW WE ARE GOING TO ENTER THE SPACE. PLEASE PUT YOUR SIGNS DOWN SO THAT FOLKS CAN

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SEE. AND YOU ABSOLUTELY DON'T HAVE TO JOIN ME BUT I'M GOING TO TAKE THREE SLOW BREATHS TO GET MYSELF CENTERED AND TO BE PRESENT. [TAKING BREATHS] OKAY. I INVITE ALL OF YOU TO TAKE -- I INVITE ALL OF YOU TO RETURN TO THIS, IF IT'S USEFUL FOR YOU. OKAY.

>> LET'S START!

>> MAYOR ISHII: OKAY, I WILL START THE PUBLIC COMMENT. CAN THE FIRST PERSON PLEASE COME?

>> THANK YOU, MAYOR AND BLESS EACH OF YOU FOR THE JOB YOU ARE GOING TO DO TONIGHT. I RISE ON BEHALF OF EVERYONE IN THE ROOM WHETHER BLUE OR PINK OR YELLOW, AND I RISE ON BEHALF OF INTERNATIONAL HUMANITARIAN LAW. PASSED AFTER WORLD WAR II ON BEHALF OF THE MILLIONS KILLED AND WHO SUFFERED AT THE HANDS OF NAZI FASCIST REGIME. AND PART OF THAT LAW PROHIBITS GENOCIDE. THE GENOCIDE CONVENTIONS WERE PASSED AND ADOPTED AND RATIFIED BY THE UNITED STATES AS A TREATY. AND UNDER ARTICLE 6 OF THE U.S. CONSTITUTION, IT IS NOW THE HIGHEST LAW OF THE LAND. AND YOU SEE IF THE U.S. CAN FUND WITH OUR TAX DOLLARS WEAPONS OF WAR AND DEATH AND DESTRUCTION OVER THE PEOPLE OF PALESTINE, THEN THOSE, WHOEVER HAS THE GREATEST MILITARY FORCE CAN DO THIS ANYWHERE IN THE WORLD. AND WE WILL ALL SUFFER.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU FOR YOUR COMMENT. [APPLAUSE]

>> MAYOR ISHII: FOLKS. FEEL FREE TO COME UP AS SOON AS THE OTHER

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PERSON IS FINISHED BECAUSE YOUR CLOCK IS RUNNING DOWN.

>> HELLO, EVERYBODY. THANK YOU, MAYOR ISHII FOR FINALLY BRINGING THIS ISSUE TO THE CITY COUNCIL. I WAS CHAIR WHEN THIS PASSED AND WE HAVE BEEN WAITING OVER SIX MONTHS FOR IT. SINCE THAT TIME, ALMOST 20,000 MORE PEOPLE HAVE BEEN KILLED IN PALESTINE, THOUSANDS MORE INJURED AND CITIES WERE ACTUALLY RE-BOMBED. AND THIS HAPPENED WHEN IT WAS CEASE FIRE. SO IN MY HEAD I THINK OF CEASE FIRE NOW WITH KILLING FIELDS. THAT'S WHAT IT MEANS TO ME WHEN WE SAY CEASE-FIRE NOW. AND THAT'S WHY I REALLY WANT TO SPEAK, IT'S FINE TO SAY WE DON'T WANT TO FUND, BUT I WANT EXPLICIT LANGUAGE SAYING THAT WE WILL NO LONGER FUND ISRAEL FOR THE DESTRUCTION IT'S POUNDING ONTO THE PEOPLE OF PALESTINE. I ALSO WANT TO MENTION, I'M JAPANESE AMERICAN AND I'M HERE WITH A GROUP OF OTHER JAPANESE AMERICANS.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU, GRACE. THANK YOU, COME FORWARD, PLEASE.

>> MAYOR, I HAVE A NOTE, LUKE TAYLOR IS CEDING A MINUTE AND ERIK CANA, AS WELL. MICHAEL YOSHI UNITED METHODIST CLERGY. AND A VILLAGE IN THE BETHLEHEM VILLAGE IN THE WEST BANK. I'M ALSO A NATIVE OF BERKELEY. MY PARENTS ON BOTH SIDES WERE SUBJECTED TO MASS INCARCERATION DURING WORLD WAR II. I RESETTLED IN THE BERKELEY AREA WHERE I GREW UP. I USED TO PLAY HOOPS ACROSS THE WAY AT THE GYMNASIUM. I ALSO HAVE A SON-IN-LAW WHO WAS A REFUGEE

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FROM VIETNAM. HIS FAMILY EXPERIENCED THE SCOURGES OF WAR THERE. HE IS THE YOUNGEST OF 13 REFUGEES NOW LIVING IN THIS COUNTRY. MY MOTHER-IN-LAW WAS ONE OF THE VICTIMS OF THE HIROSHIMA BOMBING. SHE WAS A SURVIVOR, AMONG THE THOUSANDS THAT WERE KILLED, SHE WAS A SURVIVOR OF THAT PARTICULAR WAR. THAT'S A PERSPECTIVE I BRING TO YOU TODAY, BOTH FROM A SPIRITUAL MORAL PERSPECTIVE BUT ALSO FAMILIAR CULTURAL PERSPECTIVE HISTORICALLY. I BELIEVE THAT LUKE TAYLOR ELOQUENTLY DESCRIBED THE FACTS TO YOU AND THE LOGIC FOR THE RESOLUTION THEY BROUGHT FORWARD. I WANT TO THANK HIM AND THE COMMISSIONERS FOR THE PEACE AND JUSTICE COMMISSION FOR BRINGING THAT RESOLUTION FORWARD LAST YEAR. AND I DON'T THINK YOU NEED TO HEAR MORE OF THE DETAILS BECAUSE HE OUTLINED THEM VERY GREATLY. I WANT TO SPEAK STRONGLY IN FAVOR OF THE RESOLUTION THAT HAS NOW MADE IT HERE TO YOUR COUNCIL MEETING. I WANT TO THANK MAYOR ISHII FOR MAKING THE SPACE FOR THIS TO BE HEARD HERE. I WANT TO UNDERSCORE ONE THING IN THAT ORIGINAL RESOLUTION, THAT IS THE WORDING THAT SAYS WE IMMEDIATELY END ALL WEAPON SHIPMENTS AND MILITARY AID TO ISRAEL. IT'S NOT JUST GOOD TO CALL FOR A CEASE FIRE BUT WE'VE GOT TO STOP SENDING OUR WEAPONS THERE. BUT PEOPLE WHO SAY THIS IS NOT A LOCAL ISSUE, IT IS A LOCAL ISSUE BECAUSE THE MONEY IN YOUR POCKETS AND PURSES AND WALLETS IS FUNDING THOSE WEAPONS THAT GO TO KILL PEOPLE THERE. SO WE HAVE A DIRECT RELATIONSHIP WITH WHAT'S GOING ON AND

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A DIRECT RESPONSIBILITY TO TAKE THAT BACK AND OWNING RESPONSIBILITY FOR THAT AS WELL. SO I BELIEVE THAT WE NEED TO MOVE FORWARD WITH THIS RESOLUTION AT THIS PARTICULAR MOMENT IN TIME, BUT I WANT TO UNDERSCORE AS WELL, THIS IS A CRITICAL MOMENT IN THE LIFE OF THE GAZANS. THEY HAVE BEEN THROUGH A LOT IN THE LAST YEAR AND A HALF BUT THE DECADES BEFORE THAT AS WELL. IN THE WEST BANK, AT THE SAME TIME, AS WE KNOW THERE'S A MOVE TO ANNEX ALL OF THE WEST BANK. SO IT'S A CRITICAL MOMENT IN TIME WE HAVE THE OPPORTUNITY TO TAKE A STRONG MORAL AND SPIRITUAL STANCE AS THE CITY OF BERKELEY THAT CAN MAKE A DIFFERENCE NOT ONLY HERE BUT AROUND THE WORLD AS WELL.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU.

>> GOOD EVENING, I'M HASAN -- I LIVE IN BERKELEY, I'M HERE TO ASK YOU TO SUPPORT THE ORIGINAL RESOLUTION FOR IMMEDIATE CEASE-FIRE AND ARMS EMBARGO BECAUSE YOUR KIDS AND GRAND KIDS WILL ASK YOU, WHAT DID YOU DO WHEN ISRAEL WAS SADISTICALLY STAFFING TWO MILLION PALESTINIANS IN GAZA AND USING AMERICAN WEAPONS TO KILL AND MAIM PALESTINIANS AND DESTROY HOSPITAL, SCHOOL AND ALL SUPPORTING LIFE INFRASTRUCTURE. WHAT DID YOU DO WHEN FOR 19 YEARS, ISRAEL -- GAZA AND KEPT TWO MILLION PEOPLE CAGED IN AN OPEN-AIR PRISON. WHAT DID YOU DO WHEN ISRAEL KIDNAPPED, IMPRISONED, TORTURED AND RAPED PALESTINIANS INCLUDING WOMEN AND CHILDREN? WHEN THE NAZIS --

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>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU, I'M SORRY, YOUR TIME IS UP. SIR, I'M SORRY, BUT YOUR TIME IS UP. THANK YOU FOR YOUR COMMENT. I'M SORRY, WE HAVE SO MANY PEOPLE, WE HAVE TO MOVE FORWARD OTHERWISE WE WON'T BE ABLE TO HEAR. THANK YOU. THANK YOU. PLEASE COME UP. THANK YOU.

>> JULIET LEE HAS CEDED A MINUTE OF HER TIME.

>> MAYOR ISHII: IS SHE HERE SOMEWHERE? YES, THANK YOU.

>> THIS IS DEDICATED TO MOHAMMED OMER, A FRIEND OF MINE, A JOURNALIST WHO WAS TARGETED AND HIS FATE IS UNKNOWN. MY NAME IS RABBI GOTTLIEB, I LIVE IN DISTRICT 5 IN BERKELEY. I'M ONE OF THE FIRST TEN WOMEN IN JEWISH HISTORY TO SERVE AS A RABBI. FOR AN EVEN LONGER TIME, I HAVE BEEN FIGHTING FOR THE RIGHT OF PALESTINIANS NOT TO BE ERASED FROM THEIR LAND. I HAVE SERVED HOLOCAUST SURVIVORS MY ENTIRE LIFE. THIS IS NOT AN ASYMMETRICAL CONFLICT. I URGE YOU TO PASS THE FIRST RESOLUTION THAT WAS GIVEN BY THE BERKELEY PEACE AND JUSTICE. THIS IS NOT SYMMETRICAL. WHEN SAY ARABS AND ISRAELIS THAT SAYS IT ALL TO ME, THAT'S A RACIST CONCEPTUALIZATION, THERE ARE MANY WHO SPEAK MUSLIM, THEY HAVE CULTURE, ARAB LANGUAGE IS PART OF IT BUT PALESTINIANS ARE LITERALLY BEING ERASED FROM THE FACE OF THE EARTH. AND WE KNOW THAT PALESTINIANS, THE MORE PEOPLE COME FOR PALESTINIANS, THE MORE THEY COME FOR US, PEOPLE ARE LITERALLY BEING KIDNAPPED OFF THE STREET AND SENT TO HORRIFIC PLACES, JUDGES ARE BEING

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ARRESTED. THINK ARE NOT IN LINE FOR THIS? RACISM OF THE UNITED STATES URGES US AS PEOPLE FROM BERKELEY TO RECLAIM BERKELEY'S TRADITION OF STANDING UP FOR ALL SIDES BY VOTING FOR A HALT TO THE MILITARIZATION OF OUR LIFE, OUR LANDS, OUR BEING. MILITARIZATION NEEDS TO BE STOPPED. SO PLEASE VOTE FOR THE ARMS EMBARGO TODAY. THANK YOU. [APPLAUSE] [CHEERS AND APPLAUSE]

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU.

>>

>> MY NAME IS CATHERINE LEWIS AND I HAVE LIVED IN BERKELEY FOR 13 YEARS. SOME CALL THE RESOLUTION FOR AN ARMS EMBARGO DIVISIVE. LET'S TALK ABOUT WHAT DIVISIVE MEANS. DIVISIVE MEANS USING OUR TAX DOLLARS TO SUPPORT MASS BOMBINGS OF A CIVILIAN POPULATION. THE TONNAGE OF BOMBS DROPPED ON GAZA ALONE HAS SURPASSED FOUR ATOMIC BOMBS. THE TONNAGE OF BOMBS DROPPED ON GAZA HAS SURPASSED FOUR ATOMIC BOMBS. DIVISIVE IS A STATE OF ISRAEL LOBBYING LOCAL ELECTED OFFICIALS IN BERKELEY, CALIFORNIA, TO SWAY OUR GOVERNMENT. DIVISIVE IS MAKING IT ILLEGAL TO BREAK OFF THE STATE OF ISRAEL IN 27 U.S. STATES WHILE GENOCIDE AND ETHNIC CLEANSING OF PALESTINIANS HAS BEEN HAPPENING FOR MORE THAN 76 YEARS.

>> MAYOR ISHII: SORRY, YOUR TIME IS UP. EXCUSE ME, I'M SORRY, YOUR TIME IS DONE. EXCUSE ME, PLEASE. YOU NEED TO BE RESPECTFUL, THANK YOU. [CHEERS AND APPLAUSE]

>> THANK YOU, I BELIEVE DARWIN HAS GIVEN ME A MINUTE.

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>> MAYOR ISHII: WHO IS THE PERSON GIVING YOU A MINUTE? OKAY, THANK YOU.

>> HI, SOMETIMES CALLING FOR COMMON GROUND DOESN'T WORK AND SOMETIMES THERE MAY NOT BE COMMON GROUND. SOMETIMES THERE'S A TIME FOR DIVISION AND I THINK THIS IS ONE OF THOSE TIMES. THERE'S DIVISION BETWEEN RIGHT AND WRONG. AND TRYING TO AVOID THAT DOES NOBODY ANY FAVORS. THE ORIGINAL RESOLUTION CALLED FOR AN ARMS EMBARGO, CALLED FOR THE END OF THE OCCUPATION, MAYOR ISHII, I WAS MOVED BY THE FACT THAT YOU WERE MOVED CLEARLY WHEN YOU READ YOUR RESOLUTION. AND I'M SURE YOU INTENDED IT IN GOOD FAITH. BUT I HAVE TO TELL YOU THAT, WHEN YOU WRITE A RESOLUTION NOW THAT CALLS VAGUELY FOR USING, SUPPLIES WE GIVE IN A HUMANITARIAN WAY, YOU ARE SPECIFICALLY NOT CALLING FOR AN END TO THE ARMS EMBARGO, YOU ARE NOT CALLING IT, THAT'S HOW I READ IT. IF YOU CALL FOR BOTH SIDES TO LIVE IN FREEDOM AND DIGNITY, YOU ARE NOT CALLING OUT FOR THE REALITY, WHICH IS THAT THERE'S ONE SIDE WHICH CAN NOT NOW LIVE IN FREEDOM AND DIGNITY BECAUSE IT'S UNDER OCCUPATION, YOU ARE DENYING THAT. WHEN YOU CALL FOR AN END OF VIOLENCE IN GENERAL, AND MAKE SOME EQUATION THERE, YOU ARE NOT ACKNOWLEDGING THE REALITY OF THE VAST DISPROPORTION IN VIOLENCE, HERE. THE REALITY OF A GENOCIDE. AS THE RABBI JUST SAID, THIS IS NOT A SYMMETRICAL SITUATION. AND YOUR RESOLUTION, YOUR ATTEMPT TO MAKE IT SYMMETRICAL DOES NO GOOD AT ALL. IT WILL

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BE READ, WHATEVER THE FINE LANGUAGE, IT WILL BE READ AS A RESOLUTION TO PREVENT US CALLING FOR AN ARMS EMBARGO, TO PREVENT US CALLS FOR AN END TO THE OCCUPATION.

>> MAYOR ISHII: YOU ARE OUT OF TIME. THANK YOU FOR YOUR COMMENT. PLEASE STEP FORWARD. [CHEERS AND APPLAUSE]

>> MAYOR ISHII: FOLKS, I WILL ASK THE LINE TO SHIFT UP, PLEASE. IF THE LINE CAN SHIFT UP. GO AHEAD AND START YOUR COMMENT.

>> MY NAME IS RACHEL NEWMAN, THAT WAS MY FATHER, OCEAN IS HERE, THREE GENERATIONS. YOU HAVE TALKED ABOUT WAITING FROM SEPTEMBER 2024. HAVE TO EXCUSE MY NERVOUSNESS, I'VE BEEN WAITING SINCE 1987 WHEN I WAS THE FIRST BERKELEY HIGH REPRESENTATIVE TO THE PEACE AND JUSTICE COMMISSION, AND WE PASSED A RESOLUTION BEGGING FOR A SISTER CITY AND STOP THE OCCUPATION IN GAZA. AT THAT TIME I WAS CALLED A SELF-HATING JEW AS A TEENAGER AND THINGS WERE THROWN AT ME. HOPEFULLY TIMES HAVE CHANGED. I WAS ALSO WAITING 22 YEARS AGO WHEN I WAS IN A REFUGEE CAMP PREGNANT WITH MY FIRST CHILD. AND I THOUGHT, IF ANYONE COULD SEE THERE'S NO WAY THIS OCCUPATION WOULD CONTINUE. WHEN YOU TALK ABOUT WAITING SINCE SEPTEMBER I FEEL I HAVE BEEN WAITING MY WHOLE LIFE. I DON'T WANT TO WAIT FOR A FOURTH GENERATION TO STOP THIS WAR. WE HAVE GOT THE ENDING; THE EMBARGO IS THE LEAST WE CAN DO.

>> MAYOR ISHII: SORRY, THANK YOU FOR YOUR COMMENT. [APPLAUSE]

>> MAYOR ISHII: THE OTHER MIC.

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>> MY NAME IS CINDY SHAMBAM, I'M SPEAKING OF A REPRESENTATIVE OF JEWISH VOICE FOR PEACE, THE BAY AREA CHAPTER. AND WE ARE IN STRONG SUPPORT OF THE PEACE AND JUSTICE RESOLUTION AS IT IS WRITTEN. IT CLEARLY LAYS OUT WHY IT IS SO IMPORTANT FOR CITY COUNCIL MEMBERS TO SUPPORT THIS RESOLUTION. WE OPPOSE ANY ATTEMPTS TO AMEND IT. THERE IS ONE QUOTE FROM THE RESOLUTION I WOULD LIKE TO EMPHASIZE WHICH SPEAKS TO THE IMPORTANCE OF THE END TO U.S. MILITARY AID. "AS WITH THE RAGING WILDFIRE, THE WITHDRAWAL OF SUCH FUEL CAN ONLY PROMOTE THE REDUCTION OF VIOLENCE AND IN DOING SO CREATE THE CONDITIONS OF PEACE AND JUSTICE." THE GENOCIDE THAT ISRAEL IS VISITING ON THE PALESTINIAN PEOPLE WITH U.S. SUPPORT MUST END. A CEASE-FIRE AND --

>> MAYOR ISHII: YOU CAN FINISH YOUR SENTENCE.

>> OKAY, ARE THE ONLY WAY TO CREATE THE CONDITIONS FOR THE RETURN OF OUR FREEDOM, JUSTICE, AND EQUALITY FOR PALESTINIANS.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. [APPLAUSE]

>> HELLO, I HAVE LIVED IN BERKELEY SINCE BIRTH AND I'VE BEEN A STUDENT OF THE BERKELEY PUBLIC SCHOOL SYSTEM UNTIL GRADUATING BERKELEY HIGH AND NOW A UNIVERSITY SYSTEM. HOWEVER, ALL THE KNOWLEDGE AND EDUCATION ON PALESTINIAN HISTORY IS NO CREDIT TO THE BERKELEY PUBLIC SCHOOL SYSTEM. I BELIEVE IT'S EMINENT FOR YOU TO STAND WITH YOUR CONSTITUENTS SUCH AS MYSELF AND FELLOW

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BERKELEY RESIDENTS AND PASS THE PEACE AND JUSTICE COMMISSION'S ARMS EM BARGO RESOLUTION. IT WOULD BE HYPOCRITICAL NOT TO PASS THIS RESOLUTION. DO THE RIGHT THING, THE JUST THING, THE HUMANE THING. PUT FORTH A REAL RESOLUTION, IMMEDIATE RESOLUTION FOR THE PEOPLE THAT YOU REPRESENT. I WANT TO ADD I'M HORRIFIED BY MY DISTRICT COUNCILMEMBER TAPLIN'S POSITION ESPECIALLY AS A PERSON OF COLOR, IT'S EMBARRASSING. I HOPE YOU GENUINELY TAKE INTO CONSIDERATION MY COMMENT AND THOSE OF MY FELLOW COMMUNITY MEMBERS. I HOPE YOU SEE THE HOPE AND STRENGTH OF THE PEOPLE IN THIS ROOM ASKING YOU TO CLEARLY HEAR AND LISTEN TO WHAT I HAVE TO SAY AND TAKE THE ACTION ON OUR BEHALF.

>> MAYOR ISHII: SORRY, YOUR TIME IS UP.

>> THANK YOU FOR YOUR TIME. [APPLAUSE]

>> HELLO, BERKELEY CITY COUNCIL. MY NAME IS SONALI SWAN, I'M A STUDENT AT BERKELEY HIGH AND MEMBER OF THE PEACE AND JUSTICE COMMISSION THAT PASSED THIS RESOLUTION. I URGE YOU TO PASS THE ORIGINAL PEACE AND JUSTICE COMMISSION ARMS EMBARGO RESOLUTION. I'M HERE BECAUSE THE PEOPLE WHO REPRESENT ME ARE CONTINUING TO SEND BILLIONS OF OUR TAX DOLLARS TO SUPPORT THE BOMBARDMENT, GENOCIDE AND DISPLACEMENT OF THE PALESTINIAN PEOPLE. I AM HERE BECAUSE I SEE THE NEED FOR FUNDING WITHIN OUR COMMUNITIES. BECAUSE I SEE PEOPLE WHO CANNOT AFFORD TO FEED THEIR FAMILIES AND PAY RENT. WE ARE CALLING UPON YOU AS OUR REPRESENTATIVES TO

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CHOOSE TO INVEST IN REBUILDING, NOT DESTROYING. WHAT MESSAGE ARE WE SENDING TO OUR CHILDREN WHEN WE CONTINUE TO SEND OUR TAX DOLLARS TO FUND THE BOMBING OF SCHOOLS AND REFUGEE CAMPS? WHAT FUTURE ARE WE CREATING WHEN WE TELL OURSELVES THIS IS KEEPING OUR SAFE. DON'T WATER DOWN THE RESOLUTION, STAND FOR AN ARMS EMBARGO TO KEEP THE PEACE. THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. [APPLAUSE] COME ON, EVERY SECOND COUNTS. GO AHEAD.

>> ACTUALLY, SOMEBODY IS CEDING THEIR TIME TO ME AS WELL.

>> MAYOR ISHII: WHO IS CEDING THEIR TIME?

>> DYLAN CASTLE TON IS CEDING THEIR TIME.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU, GO AHEAD.

>> HELLO, MY NAME IS JULIO, I'M A HIGH SCHOOLER AT BERKELEY HIGH, REPRESENT. AND TODAY I WOULD LIKE TO TALK ABOUT SOMETHING REALLY IMPORTANT. IT'S THIS. IN OUR WORLD TODAY, WITH OUR VAST CAPABILITIES OUR VAST ABUNDANCE, OUR VAST POTENTIAL, IF WE WANTED TO, WE COULD MAKE SURE THAT EVERY PERSON IN THIS ROOM, IN THIS COUNTRY, THE RICHEST COUNTRY IN THE WORLD, AND EF HUMAN BEING ON EARTH, WE COULD MAKE SURE THAT THEY ALL HAD FOOD, WATER, HOUSING, CLOTHING, MEDICINE AND MUCH MORE AS HUMAN RIGHTS. SO THEY COULD LIVE MUCH HAPPIER AND HEALTHIER LIVES AND YET, WE CHOOSE TO WASTE ALL THAT, OUR CAPABILITIES, ABUNDANCE, OUR ENORMOUS POTENTIAL AS HUMAN BEINGS WE CHOOSE TO WASTE ALL OF

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THAT AND INSTEAD DECIDE TO HATE EACH OTHER, TO FIGHT ONE ANOTHER, TO HAVE POVERTY, WARS, TO HAVE GENOCIDE, TO HAVE ETHNIC CLEANSING LIKE WHAT WE ARE WITNESSING RIGHT NOW IN PALESTINE. NOW IS OUR OPPORTUNITY NOT TO KEEP THE STATUS QUO OR MAKE THINGS WORSE BUT MAKE THINGS BET HE. NOT JUST FOR OURSELVES BUT FOR THE NEXT SEVEN GENERATIONS AND BEYOND. ON THAT NOTE LET'S SUPPORT A PERMANENT CEASE FIRE AND ARMS EMBARGO IN PALESTINE. THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. GO AHEAD AND MOVE THE MIC LOWER SO YOU CAN SPEAK. THERE YOU GO.

>> A CEASE-FIRE NOW WITH THE MEDIEVAL DEATH CULT OF HAMAS STILL IN POWER WILL NOT BRING PEACE.

>> MAYOR ISHII: FOLKS, PLEASE BE RESPECTFUL.

>> OUR ARABS IN GAZA, A CEASE FIRE NOW IS NOT A CALL FOR PEACE BUT MEANS GENOCIDE OF JEWS, POTENTIAL DESTRUCTION OF ISRAEL, THE ONLY JEWISH STATE. IS THAT SOMETHING YOU ENDORSE? IN ADDITION, REMEMBER THERE ARE 50 MILLION SLAVES IN THE WORLD TODAY, 13 MILLION IN THE ARAB WORLD. THERE ARE 32 PLUS ONGOING WARS, AS WELL AS AN ACTUAL ONGOING GENOCIDE OF CHRISTIANS IN THE MIDDLE EAST AND NORTH AFRICA. CONDEMNATION OF ONLY ONE COUNTRY IN THE ENTIRE WORLD FOR DEFEND ITS RIGHT TO EXIST IS JEW HATRED, PLAIN AND SIMPLE. THERE COULD BE NO CEASE-FIRE --

>> MAYOR ISHII: FOLKS, PLEASE, YOU NEED TO BE RESPECTFUL OF THE COMMENTS.

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>> IS UTTERLY DEFEATED, IF YOU DELVE INTO ISSUES OF FOREIGN POLICY BEYOND --

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. CALM DOWN. YOUR TIME IS UP. YOUR TIME IS UP, PLEASE. THANK YOU, YOUR MINUTE IS OVER. THANK YOU. FOLKS, IF YOU ARE INTERRUPTING ME, HOW CAN I INTERRUPT WHEN SOMEONE IS SPEAKING OVER THEIR TIME? PLEASE, GO AHEAD YOU HAVE A MINUTE. FOLKS.

>> THE SAN MATEO DAILY JOURNAL CONDUCTED A SURVEY, ASKING READERS SHOULD LOCAL GOVERNMENTS WEIGH IN ON FOREIGN POLICY, 97% VOTED NO, THIS TRACKS WITH WHAT WE HAVE SEEN LOCALLY. THERE ARE OVER 100,000 PEOPLE LIVING IN BERKELEY AND IT'S THE SAME FEW OVER AND OVER THAT GLADLY DEMAND BERKELEY TAKE A STAND ON A WAR 7,000 MILES AWAY IN OTHER COMMUNITIES, COUNCILS AND COMMISSIONS HAVE CAVED TO THE BULLIES. IN AN EFFORT TO CONDUCT THE REAL BUSINESS OF GOVERNING THEIR CITIES WITHOUT IPT RUPP SHUN, IT'S A DANGEROUS PRECEDENT. WE HAVE SEEN THE RISE IN ANTI-SEMITIC AND ANTI-MUSLIM CRIMES IN BERKELEY AND BEYOND. THE CITY COUNCIL OUGHT TO PUT ITS EFFORT INTO CREATING PROGRAM THAT'S HEAL OUR CITY RATHER THAN RESOLUTIONS THAT DIVIDE IT. THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU FOR YOUR COMMENTS. FOLKS, PLEASE. YOU NEED TO BE RESPECTFUL OF EVERYONE WHO IS GIVING PUBLIC COMMENT.

>> I'M A BERKELEY RESIDENT OF DISTRICT 2 WHO BELIEVES IN A PRO-PEACE RESOLUTION THAT FREES ISRAEL AND PALESTINE FROM HAMAS.

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THERE WILL NEVER BE PEACE AND CO-EXISTENCE WHILE HAMAS CONTROLS GAZA AND WE NEED TO AMPLIFY VOICES THAT CANNOT SPEAK BECAUSE HAMAS MURDERS LGBTQ+ COMMUNITY AND ANYONE WHO DISSENTS. 90% OF BAY AREA JEWS BELIEVE IN ISRAEL'S RIGHT TO EXIST -- [READING RAPIDLY] THE ORIGINAL RESOLUTION REFUSES TO CONDEMN HAD A HAS AND JUSTIFIES RAPE AND MURDERS AS RESISTANCE. OUR HISTORIC HOMELAND AND ANY RESOLUTION FOR PEACE SHOULD HONOR AND RESPECT BOTH PEOPLES. HOWEVER, WE DON'T NEED ANY RESOLUTION WHEN HAMAS COULD END THIS WAR FASTER THAN THIS MEETING BY SIMPLY SURRENDERING AND RELEASING THE HOSTAGES.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU FOR YOUR COMMENTS. EVERYONE, PLEASE. YOU NEED TO LET PEOPLE SPEAK. GO AHEAD.

>> MAYOR ISHII, IF THEY INTERRUPT, I HOPE YOU WILL ADD TIME.

>> MAYOR ISHII: YOUR TIME IS RUNNING, PLEASE SPEAK.

>> ISRAEL HAS A RIGHT TO DEFEND ITSELF FROM BEING ATTACKED OF SINCE CREATED IN 1948, EVERY ARAB COUNTRY HAS TRIED TO DESTROY ISRAEL. OCTOBER 7, 2023, HAMAS MURDERED PEOPLE, TOOK HOSTAGES AND CONTINUED TO REIGN DOWN ON ISRAEL 20,000 AND MORE ROCKETS INTO ALL CIVILIAN AREAS. DON'T TELL ME THIS IS NOT A WAR CRIME. ISRAEL HAS A RIGHT TO DEFEND ITSELF. WHEN PUTIN INVADED UKRAINE, BIDEN SENT SUPPORT TO UKRAINE. BIDEN SENT AID TO ISRAEL, HEZBOLLAH, SYRIA MILITIAS, PROXIES LAUNCHED OVER 40,000 MISSILES INTO ISRAELI TERRITORY. TRUMP SENDS AID TO ISRAEL BUT IS AN

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ALLEY OF THE U.S. YOU ARE AIDING IN THE DESTRUCTION OF ISRAEL.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU, YOUR TIME IS UP. FOLKS, PLEASE KEEP YOUR SIGNS DOWN SO THAT PEOPLE CAN SEE. PLEASE PUT YOUR SIGNS DOWN SEW THAT FOLKS CAN SEE BEHIND YOU.

>> MY NAME IS YOSI --

>> MAYOR ISHII: HEY, SORRY. CAN YOU PAUSE HIS TIME FOR A SECOND? FOLKS? THERE IS A CLOCK. HOW MUCH TIME IS LEFT, MARK, ON OUR CLOCK, FOR THREE HOURS.

>> CITY CLERK: TWO HOURS 34 MINUTES.

>> MAYOR ISHII: EVERY MINUTE YOU ARE TAKING UP BY BEING RUDE TO THE PEOPLE TRYING TO SPEAK IS TIME THAT YOU ARE LOSING IN PUBLIC COMMENT. MY GOAL IS TO GET US THROUGH THIS HEARING SO WE CAN HEAR FROM FOLKS. I KNOW PEOPLE WANT US TO VOTE ON SOMETHING, IF WE ARE GOING TO VOTE ON SOMETHING WE NEED TO HEAR FROM OUR PUBLIC COMMENTERS. PLEASE STOP CALLING OUT. GO AHEAD.

>> MY NAME IS YOSI VENDEL, I WAS BORN IN BERKELEY AND I STILL LIVE HERE WITH MY FAMILY IN DISTRICT ONE. I'M HERE TO ASK YOU TO REJECT THE RESOLUTION. FOR OVER A YEAR I'VE BEEN RECEIVING REGULAR TEXT MESSAGES FROM UNLISTED NUMBERS CALLING ME A MURDERER BECAUSE I'M A JEW AND ZIONIST. THEY SOMETIMES INCLUDE MY CHILDREN'S NAMES AND WHEREABOUTS.

>> MAYOR ISHII: FOLKS? PLEASE CONTINUE.

>> THE POLICE TELL ME THEY CAN'T PREVENT THIS HARASSMENT, THAT

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EVENTUALLY THE HEAT WILL DIE DOWN ON ITS OWN, I'M NOT ALONE. MANY HAVE BEEN SUBJECT TO HARASSMENT, DEMONIZATION, THREATS, AND OTHER ABUSES SINCE OCTOBER 7TH. BY SPEAKING HERE, I REALIZE I'M RISKING ADDITIONAL ABUSE. DON'T MAKE THINGS WORSE BY LEGITIMIZING THIS BY PASSING THE RESOLUTION. THE BIGOTS WILL SEE IT AS VINDICATION. PLEASE VOTE AGAINST THE P.J.C. RESOLUTION.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU, THE FIRE MARSHAL IS ASKING IF YOU FINISH YOUR COMMENT, PLEASE SIT BACK DOWN SO WE AREN'T BLOCKING ENTRANCES. DO YOU HAVE SOMEONE GIVING YOU A MINUTE?

>> I BELIEVE (?)

>> MAYOR ISHII: CAN YOU WAVE YOUR HAND? THANK YOU. YOU HAVE TWO MINUTES TO SPEAK.

>> MY NAME IS ROBERT; I'M A BERKELEY RESIDENT AND FORMER TEACHER. I USED TO BELIEVE LIKE THOSE OPPOSING ISRAEL HERE TODAY, BUT I MADE 20 TRIPS TO THE REGION, AVERAGING MORE THAN THREE MONTHS PER TRIP, AS WELL AS SHORTER TRIPS TO EGYPT, JORDAN, TURKEY, AND MOROCCO. I KNOW THE INFORMATION WE SIEVE IN THE WEST IS BOTH INACCURATE AND BIASED. ONE EXAMPLE FROM ONE TRIP, I HEARD ONE JOURNALIST SAY TO ANOTHER, HEY, WAS IT YOU THAT TOOK THAT PICTURE OF THE ISRAELI SOLDIER BEING BLOWN UP? THE SECOND ONE SAYS, YES, IT WAS ME. THE FIRST ONE SAYS, CONGRATULATIONS, HOW MUCH DID YOU GET FOR THAT? SO WE CAN LEARN FROM THIS THAT THE MAIN INTEREST OF THE PRESS IS TO SELL. THEIR

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INTERESTED IN CONFLICT. THEY ARE NOT INTERESTED IN PEACE. IF THERE WERE PEACE, THEY WOULDN'T HAVE STORIES. A LOT OF INFORMATION WE GET IS MEANT TO FERMENT CONFLICT. I WOULD ALSO LIKE TO SAY THIS HAS BEEN VERY DIVISIVE ALREADY IN THE COMMUNITY AND IN MEETINGS LIKE THIS. I WENT TO THE WEST BANK. I WENT TO JERICHO, HEBRON, NABLUS AND -- UNIVERSITY. ON THE WHOLE, PALESTINIANS WERE APPRECIATIVE THAT I CAME, THAT I WANTED TO TALK TO THEM. THAT I WANTED TO HEAR FROM THEM WHAT THEY HAD TO SAY. I HAVE NOT THE FELT THE SAME APPRECIATION, RESPECT OR COURTESY HERE. THIS IS ACTUALLY ANTI-ISLAM, THERE'S A CONCEPT OF ADAB, WHICH MEANS COURTESY AND RESPECT. I ASK PEOPLE HERE TO HAVE THAT. I AM ASKING THAT THE COUNCIL ACCEPT TERRY TAPLIN'S RESOLUTION AS THE LEAST DIVISIVE. THANK YOU VERY MUCH.

[APPLAUSE]

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU FOR YOUR COMMENTS.

>> BARBARA SHICK, DISTRICT 5. I URGE YOU TO REJECT THE PEACE AND JUSTICE COMMISSION'S RESOLUTION AND SUPPORT COUNCILMEMBER TAPLIN'S PROPOSAL. ACHIEVING TRUE PEACE BETWEEN ARABS AND DEMOCRATIC ETHNIC REQUIRES DISMANTLING HAMAS, DELEGITIMIZING AND USING DOUBLE STANDARDS AGAINST JEWS. ITS PURPOSE IS ELIMINATION OF ISRAEL, EVEN IF HAMAS ACTIONS CAUSE DISASTROUS RESULTS FOR GAZANS. AS LONG AS THEY ARE BRAIN WASHED TO HATE JEWS WHAT CHANCE IS THERE FOR PEACE.

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>> MAYOR ISHII: FOLKS, PLEASE BE RESPECTFUL.

>> IF THE MURDEROUS, HAMAS IS KICKED OUT OF GAZA, GAZANS CAN CREATE A DEMOCRATIC FREE SOCIETY WILLING TO LIVE SIDE-BY-SIDE IN PEACE WITH ISRAEL. HOPEFULLY AFTER TONIGHT THE COUNCIL CAN DEVOTE ITS LIMITED TIME AND ENERGY.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU.

>> MY NAME IS ALAN; I'M A RESIDENT KENSINGTON. THE WORDS AND ACTS OF THE BERKELEY CITY COUNCIL HAVE A DIRECT IMPACT ON ME. I WANT TO POINT OUT. THE P.J.C. RESOLUTION IS BASED ON A FALSE PREMISE THAT IT WILL REVERSE THE CYCLE WAR. THINK OPENLY VOW TO DESTROY ISRAEL NO MATTER WHAT THE BORDERS ARE. THE REALITY IS THE ENEMIES OF ISRAEL OPENLY VOW TO DESTROY ISRAEL NO MATTER WHAT THE BORDERS ARE. THE P.J.C. RESOLUTION RATHER THAN BRINGING PEACE WILL BRING A WAR OF DESTRUCTION AGAINST ISRAEL. PLEASE DO NOT VOTE FOR THAT RESOLUTION AND PLEASE FOCUS ON LOCAL ISSUES. THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU.

>> CITY CLERK: MAYOR, JUST A TIME CHECK, WE ARE 28 MINUTES.

>> I HAVE ONE MINUTE CEDED BY LOUISE ROSENKRANTZ.

>> MAYOR ISHII: IS SHE HERE? THERE IS ONE PERSON HERE WHO WILL GIVE YOU A MINUTE. GO AHEAD, YOU HAVE TWO.

>> MY NAME IS IMAM, A PROUD YEMENI AMERICAN, RAISED IN OAKLAND, I VOLUNTEER FOR A COLLECTIVE THAT DOES WATER DISTRIBUTION IN?

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(?) LAST WEEK WE HAD THE FUNDS BUT WE COULD NOT DO THE TRANSACTION BECAUSE THERE WAS NO WATER FOR THEM TO DISTRIBUTE. THEY ARE ON DAY 56 OF NOT A SINGLE DROP OF WATER ENTERING THE GAZA STRIP, TWO MILLION CIVILIANS OVER HALF OF THE POPULATION OF CHILDREN, FOR THE PEOPLE SAYING YOU ARE VOTING AGAINST PEACE, THAT'S THE PEACE COMMISSION. THAT'S THE PEACE COMMISSION, NOT THE HAMAS COMMISSION. THE PEACE COMMISSION AND THE PASTOR AND JEWISH VOICE FOR PEACE AND YOUR CONSTITUENTS AND THIS COMMUNITY WHO HAS BEEN HURTING FOR 570 DAYS. IT'S HONESTLY DESPICABLE THAT IT'S TWO SIDES, IT'S NOT WHEN IT'S BEEN 76 YEARS OF OCCUPATION. I WOULD LOVE TO READ YOU FROM THE COMMISSION ON A JEWISH HOMELAND IN PALESTINE 19 37, QUOTE FROM WINSTON CHURCHILL, ONE OF THE FIRST ZIONISTS, I DO NOT AGREE THE DOG IN THE MANGER HAS THE FINAL RIGHT TO THE MANGER EVEN THOUGH HE HAVE LANE THERE A VERY LONG TIME, FOR A GREAT WRONG HAS BEEN DONE TO THE RED INDIANS OF AMERICA OR THE BLACK PEOPLE OF AUSTRALIA, I DON'T ADMIT A WRONG HAS BEEN DONE TO THESE PEOPLE, A STRONGER HIGHER GRADE RACE, HAS COME IN AND TAKEN THEIR PLACE. AND THE FORMER PRIME MINISTER OF ISRAEL USED TO REFER TO US ARABS AS HUMAN BEASTS, THIS IS SYSTEMATIC, ETHNIC CLEANSING AND IT'S BEEN GOING ON A VERY LONG TIME, A THREAT TO OUR JUSTICE IS A THREAT TO JEWISH JUSTICE EVERYWHERE. [CHEERS AND APPLAUSE]

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU FOR YOUR COMMENTS. FOLKS, PLEASE, YOU

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ARE EATING INTO THE PUBLIC COMMENT PERIOD. GO AHEAD.

>> GOOD EVENING, MY NAME IS RABBI CAT SAVIS, I HAVE A CONGREGATION IN THE EAST BAY WITH MANY MEMBERS OF BERKELEY. I WILL READ WORDS FROM A GAZAN DOCTOR, ALI WORDS FROM TODAY. HE WAS ON HIS WAY YESTERDAY TO MEET FRIENDS AT A CAFE WHEN THE CAFE WAS BOMBED. AND HE WRITES, SORRY, IF I CAN FIND THE FIRST -- IF I AM TO BE MASSACRED LET IT BE AT VERY CENTER OF THE WORLD SO MY BLOOD MAY FOREVER STAIN THE FACES AND HANDS OF ALL WHO DENIED MY HUMANITY, WHO REFUSED TO SEE ME AS SOMEONE WORTHY OF LIFE, WORTHY OF SAVING FROM THE HUMAN BEASTS WHO HUNTED US. HE HAS BEEN CRYING OUT FOR US TO DO SOMETHING. YOU HAVE AN OPPORTUNITY TO DEMAND THERE BE AN ARMS EMBARGO, PLEASE SUPPORT THE ARMS EMBARGO.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. [CHEERS AND APPLAUSE]

>> GOOD EVENING, COUNCILMEMBERS, MAYOR. I'M VERY GRATEFUL TO YOU FOR CALLING THIS SPECIAL MEETING. AND I'M VERY GRATEFUL TO THE PEACE AND JUSTICE COMMISSION. YOU HEARD FROM LUKE TAYLOR, GEORGE LIPPMAN AND HE WROTE THAT RESOLUTION AFTER A LOT OF STUDY AND CONSULTING WITH THE COMMUNITY AND IT EXPRESSES THE WILL OF THIS COMMUNITY THAT WE CALL FOR AN ARMS EMBARGO. I'M THE BAY AREA CHAPTER COORDINATOR FOR PINK; AN ARMS EMBARGO IS ABSOLUTELY WHAT WE NEED. RECENT POLLING SHOWS THAT 71% OF DEMOCRATS IN THIS COUNTRY WANT AN ARMS EMBARGO. IT IS COMPLETELY IN KEEPING WITH

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NOT ONLY THIS COMMUNITY WHERE I THINK THE PERCENTAGE IS EVEN HIGHER AND GRANTED IT WENT UP 10% SINCE WE TALKED TO YOU. IT WAS 62% WHEN WE TALKED TO YOU AND THANK YOU FOR MEETING WITH US, BUT NOW IT'S 71% AND IT'S NOT A RADICAL IDEA, IT'S NOT ANTI-SEMITIC, I'M JEWISH. I DON'T SPEAK FOR ALL JEWS, BUT I WANT AN ARMS EMBARGO.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU, YOUR TIME IS UP. THANKS. [APPLAUSE]

>> MY NAME IS STACEY ZOLTHAIR, I'M A DISTRICT FIVE RESIDENT, BEING HERE TONIGHT IS INCREDIBLY TRIGGERING. FEELS LIKE WE ARE HERE IN NOVEMBER 2023, WHEN I HAND DELIVERED PETITION OF 1200 SIGNATURES TO B.U.S.D. ASKING THEM TO PROTECT OUR CHILDREN FROM AN TI SEMITISM IN SCHOOL. THINGS GOT WORSE THEN SOMEWHAT BETTER. ARABS TURNED DOWN TO WHERE IT WAS TOLERABLE TO LIVE HERE, THE HATE INCIDENTS MORE FREQUENT BUT OUTLIES BUT HERE WE ARE AGAIN WHEN ANTI SEMITES BUST IN AND ZOOMING IN FROM OUTSIDE THE STATE. A JEWISH BERKELEY RESIDENT WAS ASSAULTED OUTSIDE THESE DOORS TONIGHT. THE CHOICE BEFORE THE CITY COUNCIL IS CLEAR, ARE YOU GOING TO TAKE A STEP BACKWARD AND UNDER LIE THIS DIVISIVENESS OR TAKE A STEP FORWARD AND VOTE FOR UNITY, VOTE FOR TERRY TAPLIN'S RESOLUTION. THANK YOU. [APPLAUSE]

>> MAYOR ISHII: GO AHEAD.

>> I BELIEVE EUGENE TURRETS HAS GIVEN ME A MINUTE.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THEY NEED TO BE HERE, IS HE HERE?

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>> HE IS RAISING HIS HAND IN THE AUDIENCE.

>> MAYOR ISHII: WHERE ARE YOU, I CAN'T SEE YOU. ONLINE? I SEE HIM THERE.

>> HELLO, MY NAME IS LILY GRODZINS. THIS IS A LAST NAME I HAVE BEEN SPELLING MY ENTIRE LIFE, IT'S A LITHUANIAN JEWISH LAST NAME, AND EVERY TIME I HAVE TO SPELL IT I THINK OF MY FAMILY THAT WAS MASSACRED IN THE HOLOCAUST SHOT LIKE RABID DOGS IN LITHUANIA OR GASSED WITH ZYKLON B IN AUSCHWITZ. THAT'S WHAT BRINGS ME, THE PAIN MY FAMILY WENT THROUGH MEANS NEVER AGAIN FOR ANYONE. I AM CALLING FOR A COMPLETE ARMS EMBARGO, NO WATERED DOWN RESOLUTION AND PUT THAT MONEY BACK IN THE COMMUNITY WHERE IT CAN ACTUALLY SAVE LIVES BECAUSE YOUR RADICAL CENTRAL LIKE -- DON'T MEAN ANYTHING, UNTIL YOUR CROCODILE TEARS CAN GIVE WATER TO THE CHILDREN IN GAZA DYING OF THIRST, THEY DON'T MEAN ANYTHING TO ME. I'LL TELL YOU ONE MORE STORY IN MY LAST MINUTE THAT WAS SO KINDLY GIVEN TO ME. FOR THE PAST YEAR I HAVE BEEN RAISING MONEY FOR A FAMILY IN GAZA. A MOTHER AND HER DAUGHTER WHO AT 14 YEARS OLD WAS TRAPPED UNDER THE RUBBLE OF A BUILDING FOR 72 HOURS. DURING THAT TIME HER DAUGHTER RAWADA RECEIVED HORRIBLE BRAIN INJURIES TO THE POINT SHE CAN NOT SPEAK, SHE CAN NOT RELIEVE HERSELF, NEEDS CONSTANT PAIN KILLERS AND SHE SCREAMS BECAUSE THAT THE ONLY WAY SHE CAN VOCALIZE HER PAIN. THESE ARE NOT OUT OF POCKET LIKE STRANGE STORIES IN THE GAZA STRIP, THESE

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ARE STORIES THAT EVERY FAMILY IN THE GAZA STRIP HAS. AND IN THE WEST BANK, AND WHEN I'M TAKING A COURSE OF THE HISTORY OF THE HOLOCAUST, WHEN I READ THE STORIES OF DAVID ZERKOVIAK WHO WROTE A DIARY ABOUT THE STARVATION AND BLOCKADES ON FOOD, ALL I CAN THINK OF IS MY FRIENDS IN GAZA WHO CANNOT AFFORD FLOUR WITHOUT MAGGOTS IN IT.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. FOLKS, WHOEVER IS NEXT?

>> I BELIEVE THAT CALEB POLLOK CEDES TIME. BRIEFLY, TERRY TAPLIN, POET TO POET, REAL POETS DON'T SUPPORT GENOCIDE. I'M A HIGH SCHOOL STUDENT AND I AM STILL ALIVE. I AM DISABLED, I'M TRANS AND STILL ALIVE, I'M QUEER AND STILL ALIVE, I'M YOUNG AND STILL ALIVE, WHICH IS TO SAY THAT I HAVE A RESPONSIBILITY TO ALL OF THE YOUNG QUEER DISABLED PEOPLE IN GAZA, IN THE WEST BANK, TO ALL PALESTINIANS TO SPEAK TO YOU ALL TONIGHT AND DEMAND, DEMAND THAT YOU ALL REQUEST AN ARMS EMBARGO BECAUSE THAT IS YOUR RESPONSIBILITY, THAT IS WHAT Y'ALL, AGAIN, TERRY TAPLIN PAID FIVE AND SIX FIGURE SALARIES FOR. SO IT IS IRRELEVANT THAT I AM JEWISH. IT IS IRRELEVANT THAT I AM QUEER, IT IS IRRELEVANT THAT I AM DISABLED BECAUSE THE ONLY THING THAT IS RELEVANT, THE ONLY THING THAT IS RELEVANT, THE ONLY THING THAT IS RELEVANT IS ERASING GENOCIDE. THAT SHOULD BE THE ONLY THING ON YOUR MINDS TONIGHT. THE ONLY THING ON YOUR MINDS. SO WHAT LEGACY DO YOU ALL INTEND TO LEAVE? WHAT LEGACY? DO YOU ALL WANT TO GO DOWN IN THE

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HISTORY BOOKS ON THE TERRY TAPLIN SIDE OF THINGS, ON THE FASCIST SIDE OF THINGS, YOU WANT TO GO IN THE MIDDLE. WAIT, THE MIDDLE DOESN'T GO IN THE HISTORY BOOKS, NEVER MIND, OR DO YOU WANT TO GO IN THE RADICAL HOWARD HISTORY BOOKS. DO YOU WANT TO VOTE FOR THE ARMS EMBARGO, DO YOU CARE ABOUT YOUNG PEOPLE IN PALESTINE, DO YOU CARE ABOUT DISABLED PEOPLE IN PALESTINE? DO YOU CARE ABOUT QUEER PEOPLE IN PALESTINE? ABOUT CHILDREN ANYWHERE, BECAUSE WHEN YOU HURT ANY CHILD YOU HURT ALL CHILDREN. WHEN YOU KILL ONE OF US, YOU HURT US ALL, YOU ARE HURTING US ALL. YOU WILL NOT BE FORGIVEN, BUT THIS IS SOMETHING YOU CAN DO TO MOVE IN THE RIGHT DIRECTION, SUPPORT THE ARMS EMBARGO, THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. [CHEERS AND APPLAUSE]

>> I'M SORRY, GIVE ME ONE, I WANT TO CHECK AND SEE IF MY COLLEAGUE, HOW ARE YOU FEELING? WE WILL CONTINUE ON, GO AHEAD.

>> [INDISCERNIBLE] CEDES A MINUTE. MY NAME IS DESMOND LION, I LIVE IN DISTRICT ONE, I'M A LIFELONG BERKELEY RESIDENT. I'M HERE TO ASK YOU PASS TERRY TAPLIN'S RESOLUTION ONLY. HOLOCAUST REMEMBRANCE DAY, I WANT NO FAMILY TO SUFFER THE WAY MY FAMILY DID. [AUDIO CUTTING OUT] CHOSE NOT TO LEAVE THE CHILDREN TO FACE TERROR ALONE AND ALICE AND THE CHILDREN DIED TOGETHER IN A GAS CHAMBER. I HAVE FIVE GENERATIONS OF FAMILY IN ISRAEL, I HAVE SIX GRANDCHILDREN WHO WERE SHELLED EVERY SINGLE DAY FOR 14 MONTHS FOR OCTOBER 7TH AND HAVE NEITHER A SHELTER NOR A SAFE ROOM. I

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WANT THEIR SAFETY, I WANT PALESTINIAN SAFETY, I WANT EVERYONE LIVING IN THAT COUNTRY TO HAVE SAFETY AND AUTONOMY. BUT IT IS NOT THE JOB OF THE BERKELEY CITY COUNCIL TO GET INVOLVED WITH A COMPLICATED FOREIGN AFFAIRS ISSUE THAT IS DIVIDING OUR BERKELEY COMMUNITY, RESULTING IN AN INCREASE IN HATE INCIDENTS. I THANK YOU FOR SOLVING PROBLEMS LIKE HOUSING AND TRAFFIC SAFETY. PLEASE VOTE YES ON TERRY TAPLIN'S ALTERNATIVE RESOLUTION AND VOTE NO ON ANY FOREIGN AFFAIRS RESOLUTIONS. THANK YOU. [APPLAUSE]

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU FOR YOUR COMMENTS.

>> MY NAME IS TIM O'BRIEN, I'M A BERKELEY RESIDENT, CAL GRAD BACK WHEN WE WERE FIGHTING FOR, OH, CAN I GET AN EXTRA MINUTE? THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR ISHII: CAN YOU SIT DOWN THOUGH, SO I CAN KEEP TRACK OF WHO HAS GIVEN A MINUTE? PLEASE, GO AHEAD. GO AHEAD. I WILL KEEP TRACK; I WILL GIVE HIM AN EXTRA FEW SECONDS. PLEASE STOP TALK, YOU ARE INTERRUPTING HIS TIME.

>> I WAS A CAL FIGHTING IN THE LAST APARTHEID IN SOUTH AFRICA AND THE ROLE UNITED STATES HAD WHICH WAS A PROUD ONE. THIS YOUNG MAN, WAS TARGETED AND KILLED INSIDE HIS TENT LAST MONTH. THIS YOUNG WOMAN FATIMA HASUMA, WHOSE ENTIRE FAMILY WAS KILLED BY OUR BOMBS AFTER DOCUMENTARY SHE IS FEATURED IN. MORE JOURNALISTS HAVE BEEN KILLED IN THE TINY ENCLAVE OF THE GAZA STRIP IN THE LAST 18 MONTHS THAN KILLED IN AFGHANISTAN, VIETNAM, KOREA, AND

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BOTH WORLD WITH AS COMBINED. WHY ARE OUR TAX DOLLARS GOING TO KILL JOURNALISTS AT AN UNPRECEDENTED RATE RATHER THAN TO THE NEEDS OF OUR BERKELEY RESIDENTS. ISRAEL HAS KILLED WOMEN AND CHILDREN, INCLUDING THIS WOMAN WITH A BULLET LODGED IN HER BRAIN. NUMEROUS DOCTORS AND SURGEONS TESTIFIED THAT ISRAELI SNIPERS ARE R TARGETING CHILDREN. WHY ARE OUR TAX DOLLARS GOING TO LODGE BULLETS IN 8-YEAR-OLD GIRL'S HEADS RATHER THAN TO THE ISSUES OF EDUCATION AND EARLY CHILD DEVELOPMENT HERE IN BERKELEY? ISRAEL HAS KILLED MORE THAN 1816 DOCTORS, HEALTH WORKERS, U.N. AID STAFF AND BOMBED EVERY HOSPITAL IN GAZA, INCLUDING EXECUTION OF 15 MEDICAL WORKERS AND THE BURYING OF AMBULANCES IN SHALLOW GRAVES. THESE ARE ACTIONS OF A ROGUE STATE. WHY ARE OUR TAX DOLLARS GOING TO TARGET AND KILL AND BURY HEALTH WORKERS RATHER THAN LOCAL ISSUES LIKE SAVING ALTA BATES HOSPITAL? WHO WOULD RATHER SEND MONEY FOR THAT PURPOSE THAN PROVIDE HEALTH CARE FOR OUR NEEDIEST RESIDENTS? YOU CAN'T DECRY THIS CARNAGE WITHOUT DISRESPECTING THE MEANS. CONTINUES TO PROVIDE GASOLINE AND LIGHTER TO THE WORLD'S MOST ACCOMPLISHED ARSONISTS HAS TURNED THEIR BACK. ARMS EMBARGO IS THE ONLY MEANINGFUL ACTION THAT CAN STOP THIS UNCONSCIONABLE MASSACRE OF PALESTINIANS. DO THE RIGHT THING AND PASS A RESOLUTION THAT STOPS WEAPONS TO A COUNTRY THAT [AUDIO CUTTING OUT] PASS THE PEACE AND JUSTICE RESOLUTION. THANK YOU. [APPLAUSE]

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>> MAYOR ISHII, I WANT TO THANK YOU FOR HAVING THIS SPECIAL MEETING. WE WAITED ONE YEAR WITH OUR FORMER MAYOR AND HE WOULDN'T LET IT COME TO THE COUNCIL, SO I THANK YOU. [AUDIO CUTTING OUT] TO POWERFUL MEN. WHILE HE MUST LEARN HOW TO EAT WITH HIS FEET. 30,000 CHILDREN IN GAZA HAVE THAT FATE. THIS IS THE GREATEST NUMBER OF AMPUTEE CHILDREN IN THE WORLD, EVER, DURING OUR LIFETIME. I'M A PHYSICAL THERAPIST.

>> MAYOR ISHII: SORRY, YOUR TIME IS UP.

>> CAN SOMEONE CEDE ME A MINUTE? I'M A PHYSICAL THERAPIST, I CAN TELL YOU TO LEARN HOW TO DO ANYTHING WITH AN AMPUTATED LIMB IS SO TRAGIC AND HORRIFIC, NOBODY SHOULD GO THROUGH IT. UNLESS IT'S DISEASE THAT CAUSES IT, NOT MONEY THAT'S POURED INTO BOMBS THAT GO TO KILL THE CHILDREN THERE. YOU ARE THE JUDGE, YOU ARE THE JURY, YOU HAVE COME TOGETHER AND BEEN PUT HERE, NINE PEOPLE IN A PLACE WHERE YOUR VOICE REPRESENTS AND MAKES DECISIONS FOR 120,000 OF YOUR CONSTITUENTS. PLEASE, DO NOT TAKE THIS LIGHTLY. I PRAY THAT YOU TAKE THIS ADVANTAGE TO CRAFT A SIMPLE RESOLUTION ASKING FOR AN ARMS EMBARGO. WE MUST CONDEMN THIS ACT OF BARBARITY, WHICH AS A NATION WE ARE COMPLICIT IN, END THE SALE OF ARMS TO ISRAEL, WE NEED AN ARMS EMBARGO NOW. I ASK YOU, PLEAD WITH YOU NOT TO ALLOW THE STORY OF MAHMOUD TO CONTINUE WITHOUT TAKING A STAND. WE NEED YOU TO ACT TONIGHT. THANK YOU.

[APPLAUSE]

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>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. I'M SO SORRY, MARCIA, I'M HEARING FROM FOLKS THE AUDIO IS OUT. SO WE ARE GOING TO TAKE THIS OPPORTUNITY TO TAKE A QUICK BREAK SO WE CAN HOPEFULLY FIX THIS ISSUE THAT'S BEEN GOING ON. MARK, IS THERE A WAY WE CAN AT LEAST TAKE NUMBERS OR SOMETHING SO THAT FOLKS DON'T HAVE TO STAND WHILE WE ARE HAVING OUR BREAK? OR SOMETHING.

>> CITY CLERK: WELL, WE COULD WRITE OUT SOME TICKETS OR SOMETHING.

>> MAYOR ISHII: OKAY, WE ARE GOING TO WORK ON THAT. BUT IN LIEU OF THAT, KEEP IN MIND YOU WILL NEED TO HOLD ONTO YOUR SPOT. WE WILL TAKE A, HOW LONG SHOULD WE TAKE, MARK?

>> CITY CLERK: WELL, AT LEAST TEN MINUTES, MAYBE 15.

>> MAYOR ISHII: AT LEAST TEN MINUTES, 15.

>> CITY CLERK: THERE'S TWO HOURS, TEN MINUTES REMAINING ON THE OVERALL CLOCK. [BREAK] [BREAK] TEST, TEST AUDIO TEST, FOR THE BCM AUDIO. MAX OR NED, GIVE ME A THUMB'S UP OUT THE DOOR IF THE AUDIO IS COMING THROUGH OKAY, SO I CAN SEE YOU FROM ACROSS THE ROOM. OKAY, THANK YOU, NED. ALL RIGHT.

>> CITY CLERK: WE'RE GOING TO GET STARTED. WE'RE GOING TO GET THE MEETING BACK UNDER WAY.

>> MAYOR ISHII: OKAY, FOLKS. ALL RIGHT; WE'RE GOING TO GO BACK TO PUBLIC COMMENT. DO I HAVE MY COUNCILMEMBERS ONLINE? I WANT TO MAKE SURE EVERYONE KNOWS WE ARE COMING BACK. COUNCILMEMBER

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TAPLIN, TREGUB. KESARWANI, GREAT. I JUST WANTED TO MAKE SURE YOU ALL WERE HERE. ALL RIGHT, THANK YOU VERY MUCH. OKAY, WE ARE GOING TO GO BACK INTO PUBLIC COMMENT. WE ARE STARTING WITH MARCIA. SO PLEASE BE QUIET SO SHE CAN SPEAK. WILL HAVE A MINUTE, GO AHEAD.

>> THANK YOU, MAYOR ISHII, AND CITY COUNCIL MEMBERS. MY NAME IS MARCIA ISHII, I'M A 30-YEAR RESIDENT, AS A JAPANESE AMERICA I'M ACUTELY AWARE OF THE CRITICAL IMPORTANCE OF LOCAL COMMUNITIES STANDING UP FOR HUMAN RIGHTS AT HOME AND ABROAD AND JOINING IN SOLIDARITY TO END LAND THEFT, ILLEGAL OCCUPATION AND GENOCIDE. I URGE THE CITY COUNCIL, THEREFORE, TO VOTE IN FAVOR OF THE P.J.C.'S RESOLUTION AS WRITTEN. BERKELEY CAN NO LONGER REMAIN SILENT AND WE MUST NOT SIDESTEP THE REALITY IT'S U.S. WEAPONS FUELING THIS GENOCIDE AND THAT'S WHY WE NEED AN ARMS EMBARGO NOW. THE U.N. SPECIAL RAP TORE ON THE RIGHT TO FOOD MICHAEL STATED LAST WEEK THAT THE HUMANITARIAN CRISIS IN GAZA IS THE RESULT OF A DELIBERATE POLICY BY ISRAEL AND THE UNITED STATES BEARS RESPONSIBILITY FOR THIS CRISIS. HE SAYS, AND I QUOTE, "THE UNITED STATES IS COMPLICIT IN THE GENOCIDE...

>> MAYOR ISHII: YOU CAN FINISH YOUR SENTENCE BUT YOUR TIME IS UP. SHE IS ASKING FOR A MINUTE? THERE'S A MINUTE OVER IN THE BACK. GO AHEAD.

>> THANK YOU, HE CONTINUES, THERE'S NO CONDITION, THERE'S NO

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POLITICAL EXCUSE FOR THIS NO MATTER WHAT. WE KNOW THAT THE MOST EFFECTIVE WAY TO END THIS HUMANITARIAN CRISIS AND TO CONTRIBUTE TO PEACE WITH JUSTICE IN THE REGION IS TO END THE U.S. SALE OF WEAPONS AND MILITARY AID TO ISRAEL. THAT'S WHY I URGE THE COUNCIL TO SUPPORT THE RESOLUTION AS WRITTEN. THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. [APPLAUSE]

>> GOOD EVENING, MY NAME IS NIDA? (?) I'M HERE TO STRONGLY URGE YOU TO SUPPORT THE P.J.C.'S RESOLUTION, WHICH IS GROUNDED IN SUPPORT AND RESPECT FOR LIFE AND HUMANITY. AND ARMS EMBARGO IS ABSOLUTE NECESSITY. AND WE DON'T NEED TO TRY TO INVESTIGATE AND SEE IF OUR WEAPONS ARE BEING USED TO MURDER CIVILIANS IN GAZA. WE KNOW THAT WE DON'T NEED ANY MORE EVIDENCE, IT'S RIGHT IN FRONT OF US. WHEN YOU LOOK AT THE DEAD BODIES OF THE CHILDREN WHO HAVE HOLES IN THEIR HEAD, YOU KNOW THAT SNIPERS HAVE BEEN SHOOTING THEM TO KILL THEM. SO WE KNOW THAT OUR WEAPONS ARE DOING ALL OF THIS. SO EMBARGO AND ALSO THE RELEASE OF ALL PALESTINIAN HOSTAGES IS WARRANTED. THAT'S ALL.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. [APPLAUSE] FOLKS, MAKE SURE YOU ARE MOVING UP IN THE LINE SO WE CAN HAVE AS MANY FOLKS AS POSSIBLE. IF HAVE SPOKEN, I RECOMMEND YOU MAKE SPACE SO OTHERS CAN SPEAK.

>> I HAVE A MINUTE FROM LIZ WATS, A MINUTE FROM ALEX AND A MINUTE FROM --

>> MAYOR ISHII: WHO ARE THESE PEOPLE, SORRY, THEY NEED TO BE

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ABLE TO IDENTIFY. TWO AND THREE. IF YOU ARE NOT MAKING A COMMENT, I ASK YOU SIT IF YOU CAN, PLEASE. GO AHEAD.

>> SO THAT'S FOUR MINUTES THAT I HAVE.

>> CITY CLERK: YES, SEE THE CLOCK IN FRONT OF YOU.

>> MAYOR ISHII: GO AHEAD, YOU HAVE FOUR MINUTE TZ.

>> I'M EDUARDO MARTINEZ, I'M THE MAYOR OF THE CITY OF RICHMOND. [APPLAUSE] AND IN OCTOBER 2023, WE PASSED A RESOLUTION CALLING FOR A CEASE-FIRE AND DISARMAMENT OF SHIPMENTS TO ISRAEL. THAT SHOULD HAVE BEEN DONE IN OCTOBER WITH YOU AS WELL. I'M LOOKING AT THESE RESOLUTIONS AND WHEN I LOOK AT THE ONE BY TERRY TAPLIN, COUNCILMEMBER TERRY TAPLIN, I SEE A REDUCTION OF A VERY, VERY COMPLEX SITUATION TO, LET ME READ YOU, LET IT FURTHER BE RESOLVED THE CITY OF BERKELEY VALUES ITS ARAB ISRAELI, JEWISH, PALESTINIAN RESIDENTS AND CONDEMNS THE RISE OF ANTI-JEWISH AND ANTI-MUSLIM HATE LOCALLY AND ACROSS THE COUNTRY. IT SHOULD NOT BE REDUCED TO ANTI-JEWISH AND ANTI-MUSLIM; IT'S FAR MORE COMPLEX. THERE ARE CHRISTIANS WHO ARE BEING PERSECUTED BY THE ISRAELIS. I WOULD ALSO LIKE TO SAY TO THE PUBLIC THAT LET'S BE RESPECTFUL. WHEN I HAD MY TIME AS MAYOR THERE WAS A LOT OF ANIMOSITY FROM BOTH SIDES. AND ANY TIME ANYONE SAID SOMETHING RIDICULOUS THERE WAS A LOT OF BACKLASH FROM THE CRAZINESS THAT WAS BEING SPOUTED. SO I ASK EVERYONE TO HOLD THAT ANGER, HOLD THAT REACTION TO CRAZINESS SO THAT THE SPEAKERS CAN SAY WHATEVER

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IT IS THEY NEED TO SAY AND YOU CAN LISTEN. AND LISTEN WITH YOUR HEARTS FOR THE TRUTH. IN THE ITEM BY MAYOR ISHII, SHE SAYS THE PEACEFUL RETURN OF ALL HOSTAGES AND I WONDER WHAT SHE MEANS BY ALL HOSTAGES. THERE IS, THERE ARE THOUSANDS OF HOSTAGES IN ISRAELI JAILS. THOUSANDS. AND MANY OF THEM CHILDREN. WHEN YOU ARE ARRESTED, WHEN YOU ARE CONFISCATED OFF THE STREET AND NOT GIVEN DUE PROCESS, THAT IS HOSTAGE-TAKING. AND IT'S WORSE THAN HOSTAGE-TAKING BECAUSE THERE'S NO ONE TO NEGOTIATE FOR YOU. AND THERE'S NO ONE TO NEGOTIATE FOR YOU BECAUSE THE PEOPLE WHO WOULD NEGOTIATE DO NOT HAVE ARMS. AND WHEN THOSE PEOPLE ARE RETURNED, THEY DO NOT HAVE THE SAFETY OF KNOWING THAT THEY AREN'T GOING TO END UP BACK IN JAIL. BACK IN ISRAELI PRISON. SO A CEASE-FIRE NEEDS TO HAPPEN NOW. ARMS EMBARGO NEEDS TO HAPPEN NOW. IT IS THE ONLY WAY TO A TRUE PEACE IN THE MIDDLE EAST. INSTEAD OF SPENDING ALL THIS MONEY FOR DESTRUCTION, WE NEED TO SPEND IT ON BUILDING. IF ALL THIS MONEY HAD BEEN SPENT BUILDING UP PALESTINE INSTEAD OF TAKING IT AWAY, WE WOULD HAVE HAD A COUNTRY FOR EVERYONE.

[APPLAUSE]

>> MAYOR ISHII: FOR THE GENTLEMAN WHO GAVE HIS MINUTE, I KNOW YOU ARE STANDING IN LINE STILL, COULD YOU TAKE A SEAT SO WE CAN KEEP TRACK.

>> I HAVE A MINUTE FROM LYNETTE ONLINE. A MINUTE FROM MY HUSBAND IN THE ROOM. AND FROM SOMEONE ELSE IN THE ROOM.

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>> MAYOR ISHII: OKAY, THERE'S ANOTHER HAND.

>> THAT'S FOUR.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THERE'S TWO PEOPLE IN THE ROOM, TWO PEOPLE ON THIS SIDE AND ONE ON THIS SIDE WHO GAVE A MINUTE.

>> THAT'S FOUR MINUTES, OKAY, I'M CHERYL DAVILA, FORMER COUNCILMEMBER OF THE CITY OF BERKELEY, DISTRICT 2 AND FORMER HUMAN WELFARE COMMUNITY ACTION COMMISSIONER WHERE I ADDED DIVESTMENT FROM ISRAEL APARTHEID AGENDA IN 2014 WHICH WAS REMOVED AND BECAME A CITY COUNCIL MEMBER BECAUSE OF IT. DIVESTMENT FROM ISRAEL APARTHEID DIDN'T HAPPEN IN 2015, BUT NOW TEN YEARS LATER MANY THOUSANDS OF PEOPLE MURDERED, MARTYRED BY ISRAEL, YOU HAVE AN OPPORTUNITY TO PUT YOURSELVES ON THE RIGHT SIDE OF HERSTORY/HISTORY. BERKELEY DECLARED A CLIMATE EMERGENCY BECAUSE OF MY LEGISLATION AND FOSSIL-FUEL FREE RESOLUTION IN 2018 AND PUT BERKELEY CITY COUNCIL ON THE WORLD MAP. HAVE AN OPPORTUNITY TO DO THIS RIGHT NOW. YOU COULD BE STANDING UP FOR JUSTICE, STANDING UP TO SAVE INNOCENT HUMAN BEINGS, STANDING UP FOR MOTHER EARTH, STANDING UP FOR THE LIVES OF THOSE LIVING THROUGH A HOLOCAUST, THROUGH A GENOCIDE, THROUGH EXPULSION, THROUGH ETHNIC CLEANSING AND ALL THE ATROCITIES THAT ITS NOT REAL HAS PRESENTED TO THE PALESTINIANS. IT'S NOT ANTI-SEMITIC, IT'S NOT DIVISIVE, IT'S AN OPPORTUNITY TO CHANGE THE TRAJECTORY FOR HUMANS THAT ARE BEING MURDERED WITH YOUR TAX DOLLARS.

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EVERYONE'S TAX DOLLARS IN THIS ROOM. BERKELEY BECAME THE THIRD IN THE WORLD TO PASS A CLIMATE EMERGENCY. AND 23 GOVERNMENTS AROUND THE WORLD DID AFTER. SO WHAT BERKELEY DOES HAS A DOMINO EFFECT AROUND THE WORLD. YOU HAVE AN OPPORTUNITY TO CHANGE THE HISTORY. YOU NEED TO PASS THIS RESOLUTION. AN ARMS EMBARGO, A CEASE-FIRE, HOW MANY PEOPLE HAVE TO DIE, CHILDREN ARE DYING, YOU HAVE CHILDREN, BEN. I DON'T KNOW WHO ELSE HAS CHILDREN ON THIS COUNCIL, BUT, YOU KNOW, CHILDREN ARE BEING SHOT. SHOT TO KILL. WOMEN, PREGNANT WOMEN ARE BEING SHOT TO KILL. SENIORS ARE BEING SHOT TO KILL. YOU HAVE AN OPPORTUNITY TO MAKE A DIFFERENCE. TO GET OTHER PEOPLE AROUND THE WORLD AND AROUND THIS COUNTRY TO STAND UP AND HAVE AN ARMS EMBARGO AND A CEASE-FIRE. I DON'T KNOW WHAT NEEDS TO HAPPEN FOR YOU, YOU TALK ABOUT TAKING A FEW BREATHS TO GET COMPOSURE? PALESTINIANS HAVE BEEN DEALING WITH THIS, GENERATIONS. AND THEY ARE KILLING WHOLE FREAKIN' GENERATIONS OF FAMILIES. NO ONE IS LEFT. THERE ARE CHILDREN THAT DON'T HAVE ANY PARENTS LEFT. NO FAMILIES, AND THERE'S AN ACRONYM, WHICH I CAN'T THINK OF RIGHT NOW. BUT YOU HAVE AN OPPORTUNITY TO DO SOMETHING TO MAKE YOU STAND OUT TO THE REST THE WORLD AND CHANGE THINGS. YOU CAN DO IT. YOU KNOW, I KNOW SOME OF YOU ARE BOUGHT BY APAC, YOU DON'T HAVE TO BE. YOU DON'T HAVE TO BE BOUGHT, SOLD AND DELIVERED TO THE ZIONIST REGIME. YOU CAN MAKE A DIFFERENCE. ZIONISM IS RACISM, NO MATTER HOW YOU DEAL

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WITH IT. IF YOU ARE TAKING A JAPANESE COMMUNITY, A BLACK COMMUNITY, AN IRISH COMMUNITY AND KILLING THEM ALL, THAT'S GENOCIDE.

>> MAYOR ISHII: YOUR TIME IS UP.

>> PERIOD! [CHEERS AND APPLAUSE]

>> MAYOR ISHII: YOUR TIME IS UP. PLEASE ALLOW OTHER PEOPLE TO SPEAK. THERE ARE MANY PEOPLE WHO HAVE LEFT TO SPEAK. PLEASE COME UP. SO, FOLKS WE DID A COUNT OF FOLKS, OF PEOPLE IN LINE. SO I JUST WANT FOLKS TO KNOW, HOW MUCH TIME DO WE HAVE LEFT, MARK?

>> CITY CLERK: ONE HOUR, 57 MINUTES.

>> MAYOR ISHII: OF TOTAL TIME?

>> CITY CLERK: OF TOTAL TIME.

>> MAYOR ISHII: WE ARE LEAVING ONE HOUR FOR FOLKS ON ZOOM, SO BE AWARE IF OUR COMMENT PERIOD GOES A LONG TIME WE MAY NOT BE ABLE TO HEAR FROM EVERYONE IN LINE. I WANT TO SET THAT EXPECTATION NOW. BE RESPECTFUL SO WE CAN HEAR FROM AS MANY IN THE ROOM. GO AHEAD.

>> CITY COUNCIL, YOUR PLATITUDES WON'T DUE. LET US BE DIVISIVE TONIGHT, THE THAT DIVISIVENESS THAT DEFINED THE MORALS OF THIS TOWN. IT WAS ONCE DIVISIVE TO SUPPORT THE FREE SPEECH AND CIVIL RIGHTS MOVEMENT. TONIGHT SOME SEE IT AS DIVISIVE TO SUPPORT A CEASE-FIRE AND ARMS EMBARGO TO THIS MONSTROUS GENOCIDE TO PALESTINIAN. THERE'S A RIGHT AND WRONG SIDE TO THIS MEETING

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TONIGHT. THOSE WHO STAND WITH PALESTINIAN ARE THE MAJORITY, BECAUSE WE STAND ON BASIC MORAL BEDROCK, JUSTICE, FREEDOM, AND TAP DANCING MINORITY WHO DO NOT CARE ABOUT THE MASS MURDER OF PALESTINIANS, CANNOT BE CENTERED. LET US HAVE NO PATIENCE FOR RACIST, GENOCIDAL IDEOLOGY. BERKELEY IS ANTI GENOCIDE; ANTI-WEAPONS AND IT'S PASTIME THE CITY COUNCIL ADDS OUR UNAMENDED VOICE TO THE SUPPORT OF PALESTINE.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. GEORGE, COME UP. GO AHEAD.

>> GOOD EVENING, FRIENDS. I HAVE A FEW FOLKS IN THE AUDIENCE WHO HAVE PLEDGED THEIR TIME.

>> MAYOR ISHII: WHO IS GIVING TIME?

>> DIANA BOEHM, PLUM NEWMAN.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THEY'VE GOT TO BE HERE, GEORGE, I'M SORRY.

>> PLUM NEWMAN.

>> MAYOR ISHII: SHE'S GOT TO BE HERE.

>> AND JOHN KINNE. AND ONLINE.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THERE IS SOMEONE HERE GIVING YOU -- I CAN'T SEE THAT THIRD PERSON. PLEASE SIT DOWN, I HAVE THREE PEOPLE HERE IN PERSON. GO AHEAD, GEORGE.

>> FORMER MEMBER OF THE PEACE AND JUSTICE COMMISSION. I WANT TO TALK ABOUT MILITARISM, AND I WANT TO TALK ABOUT OUR COUNTRY. I THINK THIS IS WHAT THIS IS REALLY ABOUT. IT'S ABOUT THE PROBABLY 200,000 PEOPLE THAT HAVE BEEN KILLED. 99% OF THEM BY ISRAEL

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DIRECTLY OR INDIRECTLY THROUGH STARVATION AND DISEASE. BUT FOR US IT'S REALLY ABOUT THE HEART AND SOUL OF OUR COUNTRY AND WHAT KIND OF COUNTRY DO WE WANT TO BE? AND FOR BERKELEY, IT BREAKS MY HEART TO THINK HERE WE GO AGAIN. SOME AMONG US HAD THE HONOR TO LIVE THROUGH THE FORMATIVE TIMES OF BERKELEY IN THE 60S AND 70S AND TO SEE WHAT MODERN WAR DOES TO THE FABRIC OF OUR SOCIETY. I CAN TELL YOU THAT THIS COUNTRY BARELY SURVIVED THAT CALAMITY. I REMEMBER THE NAPALM CHILDREN, THE BURNED VILLAGES, THE RAPE OF WOMEN AS ARMY POLICY. THE DEHUMANIZATION. THE TRAINING OF OUR SONS TO BE KILLERS AND THEN TO BRING BACK THEIR MORAL SICKNESS TO THE HOME FRONT, WHERE IT LED TO A SURGE IN VIOLENCE AGAINST WOMEN. THE WASTE OF HUNDREDS OF BILLIONS OF DOLLARS ON WEAPONS OF DESTRUCTION THAT DESTROYED THE ECONOMY OF THIS COUNTRY IN THE 1970S ,Z AS WELL AS LIFE CHANCES OF MILLIONS OF PEOPLE OF COLOR IN THE U.S. AT THE COMMISSION WE ALWAYS REMEMBER THE QUOTE BY MARTIN LUTHER KING JUNIOR, THE BOMBS WE DROP IN VIETNAM ARE EXPLODING IN THE GHETTOS AND BARRIOS OF THIS COUNTRY. THE PEACE AND JUSTICE RESOLUTION EXPLAINS THE MANY REASONS IT'S APPROPRIATE FOR THE CITY OF BERKELEY TO SPEAK UP FOR CUTTING OFF THE WEAPONS OF WAR. SUFFICE IT TO SAY, WE CAN DISAGREE ABOUT MANY THINGS, THE HISTORY OF THE PEOPLES OF THE REGIONS AND THE INSULT TO INJURY TO THE MEMORY OF THOSE COMMUNITIES IN BERKELEY. BUT EVERYONE HERE SHOULD BE ABLE TO AGREE THAT WE ARE DONE WITH

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WAR AS A SOLUTION FOR THE WORLD'S PROBLEMS. IF WE CANNOT, I HAVE TO ASK WHAT WAS THE POINT OF ALL WE SUFFERED THROUGH FOR ALL THOSE YEARS? WHAT REALLY HAVE WE LEARNED? THE PROBLEM WITH TRUMP AS PRESIDENT IS NOT ONLY HIS DESTRUCTION OF THE U.S. ECONOMY, THE THREAT HE POSES TO THE ECONOMY OF OUR LOCAL MUNICIPALITIES, THE GRANTS FOR LOCAL SERVICES, HE THREATENS THE PROMOTION OF AN OUT OF CONTROL MILITARY, DESTRUCTION OF THE CLIMATE AND THE END OF CONSTRUCTIVE DIPLOMACY WITH THE REST OF THE WORLD. I SYMPATHIZE WITH YOUR ATTEMPT, MAYOR, AND COUNCILMEMBERS, TO CRAFT A RESOLUTION THAT CAN PASS THE COUNCIL. I REALLY DO. BUT SIMPLY TO SAY ISRAEL SHOULD ABIDE BY INTERNATIONAL LAW IGNORES THE REALITY THAT WE, OUR GOVERNMENT, AND LITERALLY, WE IN BERKELEY THROUGH OUR MILLIONS IN FEDERAL TAXES WE PAY ARE AT WAR, WE ARE AT WAR WITH THE PEOPLE OF PALESTINE. PLEASE, BE PART OF THE MOVEMENT. LET'S END THIS WAR BY ADDING A CALL, OKAY, WE WANT TO BE PART OF A MOVEMENT THAT WILL END THIS WAR BY ADDING A CALL FOR NO MORE GUNS TO KILL GAZANS, THANK YOU VERY MUCH.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. PLEASE COME UP. [APPLAUSE]

>> HELLO, MY NAME IS CASEY MUKAI, I'M A U.C. BERKELEY ALUM, STAFF MEMBER AND I'M A BOARD MEMBER OF THE BERKELEY BUDDHIST TEMPLE. I, AS WELL AS A GROUP OF OTHER JAPANESE AMERICANS ARE DESCENDANTS OF THE WORLD WAR II INCARCERATION CAMPS, A HISTORY, MAYOR ISHII SHARE. I ALSO AM A DESCENDANT OF HIROSHIMA. IT'S THE

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80TH ANNIVERSARY OF THE CLOSING OF THE CAMPS AND DROPPING OF THE BOMBS THAT KILLED 215,000 PEOPLE. I ALONG WITH OTHERS STAND IN SOLIDARITY WITH PALESTINE, OUR CONSCIENCE DEMANDS IT, OUR HISTORY DEMANDS IT BECAUSE WE KNOW WHAT VIOLENCE LOOKS LIKE, AND THIS IS STATE VIOLENCE IN ITS WORSE FORM. IF WE STAY VIOLENT WE ARE NO BETTER THAN THE OPPRESSORS. ARMS EMBARGO NOW, THANK YOU. [CHEERS AND APPLAUSE]

>> HELLO, MY NAME IS BETTY CANO, I'M ALSO A JAPANESE AMERICAN THAT CASEY SPOKE SO BRILLIANTLY ABOUT. I WANT TO SAY THERE'S NO ISSUE MORE IMPORTANT TO OUR OWN WELFARE THAN STOPPING U.S. MILITARY ISM IN THE WORLD. ISRAEL RECEIVES MORE MILITARY AID FROM THE UNITED STATES THAN ANY OTHER COUNTRY. AND OUR TAX DOLLARS ARE USED TO KILL, MAIM, SLAUGHTER AND DEVASTATE GAZA AND THE PALESTINIAN PEOPLE. WHY ARE WE SPENDING SO MUCH TO DESTROY WOMEN, CHILDREN, WHOLE FAMILIES OF DOZENS OF PEOPLE, WHY IS OUR EXAMPLE TO THE WORLD ONE OF MAYHEM RATHER THAN HUMANITY? IS KILLING MORE IMPORTANT THAN CARING? I'M SO IMPRESSED WITH THE YOUNG PEOPLE WHO HAVE SPOKEN AND HAVE KIND OF CROSSED A CERTAIN LINE IN TERMS OF THEIR PRESENTATION. THEY ARE REALLY, REALLY STRONG. AND I FEEL THAT'S THE FUTURE OF OUR ENERGY WE ARE GETTING STRONGER IN TERMS OF OUR DEVASTATION.

>> MAYOR ISHII: PLEASE GO AHEAD.

>> MY NAME IS MARLENE; I WAS BORN IN 1946. I GREW UP WITH

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PARENTS THAT HAVE COMED BACK FROM THE INCARCERATION CAMPS SO I WAS VERY FORTUNATE THAT THEY SENSITIZED ME TO ALL OF THE ISSUES OF INJUSTICE THAT I GREW UP WITH, AS A CHILD, BORN IN 1946. SO COMING TO THE STAND HERE TODAY IS SOMETHING THAT MY PARENTS WOULD HAVE DONE AS WELL. AND SO I JUST WANT TO EXPRESS THAT, I WANT TO REINFORCE THAT MANY AROUND TOWN HAVE SAID THAT THE GAZA, ISRAELI WAR IS AN INTERNATIONAL ISSUE AND OUR CITY GOVERNMENT SHOULDN'T TAKE ANY POSITION, THEY ARE DEAD WRONG. I WAS IN PALESTINE IN 2022, AND I SAW AN OVERWHELMING AMERICAN PRESENCE THERE. U.S. WEAPONS EVERYWHERE. AND THE U.S. SUPPORTED SETTLEMENTS THAT HOVER OVER AND IMPOSE AND HARASS THE ADJACENT LONG-ESTABLISHED PALESTINIAN CITIES WAS ABOMINABLE. THEY HAD TO COVER THEIR STREETS WITH HEAVY PLASTIC AWNING BECAUSE BOTTLES AND GLASS AND METALS WOULD BE THROWN INTO THEIR LITTLE SHOPPING DISTRICTS. THIS IS IN HEBRON. SO PLEASE, CITY OF BERKELEY, WE CANNOT BE COMPLICIT, THE U.S. HAS BEEN COMPLICIT, IT WAS VERY EVIDENT AND OBVIOUS. PLEASE, STAND UP FOR CEASE FIRE AND ARMS EMBARGO BECAUSE YOU ARE STANDING UP AGAINST THE U.S. COMPLICITY AND ABOMINATION OF APARTHEID AND GENOCIDE.

>> MAYOR ISHII: YOUR TIME IS UP. THANK YOU. [CHEERS AND APPLAUSE]

>> HELLO, THANK YOU VERY MUCH. MY NAME IS NANCY UKAI, I'M A THIRD GENERATION BERKELEYAN, DISTRICT *6 RESIDENT, MY

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GRANDFATHER AN IMMIGRANT, MY GRANDMOTHER GREW UP ON 6TH STREET. I'M CO PRESIDENT OF THE JAPANESE AMERICAN CITIZEN'S LEAGUE AND A MEMBER, ALSO PRESENTING TO YOU ON BEHALF OF THE PEACE AND JUSTICE COMMISSION A PETITION WITH THE NAMES OF 60 AMERICAN JAPANESE IN BERKELEY WHO SUPPORT THE PEACE AND JUSTICE COMMISSION PROPOSAL. I ALSO SUPPORT THE ORIGINAL PEACE AND JUSTICE COMMISSION RESOLUTION WITH AN ARMS EMBARGO. 13 OF MY RELATIVES WERE INCARCERATED IN AMERICAN CONCENTRATION CAMPS SO I KNOW WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE TO BE ETHNICALLY CLEANSED FROM THEIR HOMES. PEOPLE TALKED ABOUT FOREIGN POLICY IN BERKELEY, BUT WHEN AMERICANS ARE DISAPPEARING OFF THE STREETS IT'S NO LONGER FOREIGN POLICY, IT'S AMERICAN POLICY. [CHEERS AND APPLAUSE] THIS PEACE CRANE I BRING TO YOU AS A SYMBOL OF THE PEACE CHILDREN IN HIROSHIMA WANT AND WE WANT.

>> MAYOR ISHII: SORRY, YOUR TIME IS UP. THANK YOU. FOLKS, JUST A REMINDER, IF YOU ARE CLAPPING, THAT'S FINE, BUT THEIR TIME IS RUNNING OUT.

>> MAYOR AND CITY COUNCIL, THANK YOU, PAOLA LAVERDE, DISTRICT FIVE CONSTITUENT. I'M URGING YOU TO PLEASE VOTE FOR THE PEACE AND JUSTICE COMMISSION RESOLUTION. IT CALLS FOR AN END TO MILITARY AID TO ISRAEL NOW. WE WANT OUR TAX DOLLARS TO BE INVESTED IN OUR COMMUNITIES NOT SPENT ON FOREIGN MILITARY COMMITTING WAR CRIMES AGAINST HUMANITY, AS OBSERVED BY

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INTERNATIONAL LAW. MAYOR ISHII, I APPRECIATE YOUR RESOLUTION BUT IT HAS NO TEETH, IT JUST DOESN'T DO ANYTHING. IT TALKS HERE ABOUT URGING THE U.S. GOVERNMENT TO ENSURE THAT THE AMERICAN SUPPORT FOR THE GOVERNMENT OF ISRAEL AND ANY ALLY COMPLIES WITH INTERNATIONAL HUMANITARIAN LAW, WELL, TODAY AT THE U.N. AT THE INTERNATIONAL COURT OF JUSTICE, THEY BEGAN A HEARING OF THE SEVERE RESTRICTIONS OF THE WORK OF U.N. AND OTHER INTERNATIONAL ORGANIZATIONS IN GAZA AND OTHER TERRITORIES. THEY DIDN'T SHOW UP. THE ISRAELIS DIDN'T SHOW UP. WE NEED YOU TO BE OUR VOICE, TO RAISE OUR VOICES. THE MAJORITY OF THE PEOPLE HERE ARE ASKING FOR IT.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. APPRECIATE YOUR COMMENTS.

>> LAUREN CLARK AND SARAH ELS CEDE THEIR TIME FOR ME. TOTAL OF THREE MINUTES.

>> MAYOR ISHII: SORRY, WHO ARE THESE PEOPLE? THANK YOU.

>> GOOD EVENING, I SHOULD BE A 9-1-1 PARAMEDIC IN ALAMEDA COUNTY BUT I WAS WRONGFULLY TERMINATED FOR ANTI GENOCIDE WORK. THIS IS A RISK WE ARE TAKING, AS A PARAMEDIC MEANS NOTHING IF I DON'T SPEAK UP ABOUT THE HARMS AND ATROCITIES THAT PALESTINIANS SPEAK OUT FOR LAST HUNDRED OF YEARS OF ISRAEL INDIANA UNITED STATES OF AMERICA. YOU HAVE HAD 18 TIMES TO ACT AND IN THAT TIME GAZA HAS BECOME A GRAVEYARD. 52,000 PALESTINIANS KILLED; 13,000 CHILDREN TURNED TO DUST BEFORE THEIR 10TH BIRTHDAY. 90% OF GAZA PUSHED

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OUT OF THEIR HOMES. STAFFED STARVED AS THEY BEGGED, BURIED ALIVE. IT'S IMPORTANT TO KNOW OPPRESSION, APARTHEID, ETHNIC CLEANSING BEGAN LONG BEFORE OCTOBER 7TH. THIS IS NO LONGER SIMPLY A GENOCIDE BY DEFINITION, IT'S OFFICIALLY BECOME A HOLOCAUST. GENOCIDE IS INTENTIONAL DESTRUCTION IN WHOLE OR PART OF INTERNATIONAL, NATIONAL, ETHNIC -- BUT A HOLOCAUST GOES FURTHER, AS U.N. GENOCIDE CONVENTION OF 1948 TOTAL INDUSTRIAL SCALE, EXTERMINATION OF A PEOPLE, NOT THROUGH VIOLENCE, BUT STARVATION, DESTRUCTION OF THEIR MEANS OF SURVIVAL. MARCH 23RD, 2025, RAFA, ISRAELI FORCES FIRED ON A U.N. VEHICLE. EIGHT WORKERS, FIVE CIVIL DEFENSE AND ONE U.N. STAFFER WERE MURDERED. AUTOPSIES REVEALED GUNSHOT WOUNDS TO THE HEAD AND CHEST SUGGESTING EXECUTION-STYLE KILLINGS, SOME WERE FOUND WITH HANDS BOUND IN MASS GRAVES, REPORTEDLY BULLDOZED BY ISRAELI TROOPS. THEY SHOT MY COLLEAGUES. CAN YOU IMAGINE TARGETING AMBULANCES HERE EVERY SINGLE DAY THEY GO OUT TO THEIR JOBS? BECAUSE THAT'S EXACTLY WHAT ISRAEL IS DOING TO THE PALESTINIAN SOCIETY TO MY FELLOW COLLEAGUES. WE WILL NO LONGER BEG FOR YOUR MORALITY BECAUSE WE KNOW YOU SERVE MONEY. AND I HOPE THAT ONE DAY THAT WE WILL BE REMEMBERED AS THE GENERATION THAT IS SO SICK AND TIRED OF BEING SICK AND TIRED THAT WE -- [READING RAPIDLY] IT ENDS WITH US. WARFARE ENDS WITH US, WE NEED TO BE DONE FIGHTING OUR CONFLICTS THROUGH IS MISSILES AND BOMBS AND GUNS, AND IT NEEDS

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TO END FOR EVERYBODY, INCLUDING THE UNITED STATES. SO PLEASE VOTE A WAVERING YES ON THE PEACE AND JUSTICE COMMISSION ARMS EMBARGO RESOLUTION SO YOU WILL BE REMEMBERED AS FUTURE GENERATION THAT ENDS WAR NOW.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. [CHEERS AND APPLAUSE]

>> MAYOR ISHII: FOLKS, PLEASE. YOU ARE CUTTING INTO THE TIME HERE. COME ON, PLEASE. PLEASE BE RESPECTFUL. THANK YOU.

>> I'M KEN LORETTO, I LIVE IN DISTRICT ONE. BIDEN, TRUMP, HARRIS, VANCE, RUBIO, "NEW YORK TIMES", FOX NEWS, THEY MAY HAVE THEIR DIFFERENCES BUT ALL ARE IN LOCK STEP WHEN IT COMES TO ISRAELI EXCEPTION. THE PALESTINIAN EXCEPTION. IRON CLAD SUPPORT FOR ISRAEL, NO DAYLIGHT BETWEEN ISRAEL AND THE UNITED STATES AND IN SPOUTING TALKING POINTS DEHUMANIZATION OF THE PALESTINIAN PEOPLE. AS IF THAT WERE POSSIBLE TO DEHUMANIZE THE PALESTINIAN PEOPLE. WE ARE THE PEOPLE WHO DEHUMANIZE OURSELVES, THE PEOPLE WHO WOULD DEFEND THE DEFENSIBLE, THE PEOPLE WHO JUSTIFY DAILY ENDLESS ATROCITIES, THE PEOPLE WHO STAY SILENT, WHO DO NOTHING, WHO SIP FAIR TRADE COFFEE AND MAKE RESPONSIBLE CONSUMER CHOICES. JUST ANOTHER BORING DAY IN PARADISE. WE ARE THE PEOPLE WHO MUST RECOVER OUR OWN HUMANITY AND STAND FOR SOMETHING.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU.

>> THANK YOU. [APPLAUSE]

>> MAYOR ISHII: GO AHEAD. THANK YOU, FOLKS FOR STICKING TO YOUR

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TIME. GO AHEAD.

>> MY NAME IS DAVID; I'M A BERKELEY RESIDENT IN DISTRICT 3. I WAS EXCITED TO MOVE HERE IN 2023 BUT I CAN SAY WITHOUT A DOUBT THIS IS THE FIRST CITY I'VE LIVED IN I'VE BEEN MADE TO FEEL UNSAFE AND UNWELCOME. IF I KNEW RESIDENTS HAD AN UNHEALTHY OBSESSION WITH THE JEWISH HOMELAND I NEVER WOULD HAVE MOVED HERE. MANY WOULD LIKE YOU TO BELIEVE IN PEACE IN BERKELEY, ISRAEL, AND PALESTINE. SIGN THAT SAYS FUCK ISRAEL IS NOT PEACEFUL. ARCHITECT OF THE OCTOBER 7TH ATTACKS WORN BY SOMEONE HERE. DO I WANT IT TO END? ABSOLUTELY I DO, DO I BELIEVE PEOPLE HAVE A RIGHT TO PROTEST? YES, DOES BERKELEY HAVE ANY BUSINESS PASSING A RESOLUTION RELATED TO THIS WAR? NO, ABSOLUTELY NOT. I URGE THE COUNCIL TO FOCUS ON THE DEFICIT AND OTHER ISSUES THAT AFFECT CITY OF BERKELEY. COUNCILMEMBER TAPLIN'S RESOLUTION IS THE BEST OF THE THREE RESOLUTIONS.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU.

>> MAHTI, CAN I HAVE A MINUTE FROM YOU, PLEASE? THANK YOU, TWO MINUTES, PLEASE, MAYOR.

>> MAYOR ISHII: TWO MINUTES. FOLKS, PLEASE, COME ON.

>> GOOD EVENING, MY NAME IS JONATHAN MINZER, PROUD TO SERVE AT THE LARGEST COLLECTIVE VOICE, WE REPRESENT 70 SYNAGOGUES IN THE REGION INCLUDING FIVE IN BERKELEY. TONIGHT I'M ASKING TO AVOID ADOPTING ANY RESOLUTION ABOUT THE HAMAS WAR OR ANY OTHER

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GEOPOLITICAL ISSUE. SINCE THE OCTOBER 7TH TERRORIST ATTACKS BY HAMAS, WE HAVE ASKED GOVERNMENTS TO AVOID NON BINDING RESOLUTIONS ABOUT THE WAR, BECAUSE REGARDLESS OF THE WORDS THEY WILL FLAME TENSIONS AND TRAUMATIZE COMMUNITIES ASSOCIATED WITH THE CONFLICT. WE ARE SEEING AND HEARING THIS TONIGHT IN OUR CHAMBERS.

>> MAYOR ISHII: FOLKS, HANG ON ONE SECOND. CAN YOU PAUSE HIS TIME? I'M GOING TO WAIT UNTIL THE ROOM IS CALMED DOWN. FOLKS? FOLKS? ALL RIGHT, EVERYONE, LET'S HAVE ORDER, PLEASE. EXCUSE ME, EXCUSE ME? EXCUSE ME? THIS FOLKS, THIS MEETING IS BEING RECORDED, CAN WATCH THE COMMENTS LATER. PLEASE ALLOW THIS GENTLEMAN TO FINISH HIS SPEECH. FOLKS, PLEASE. I'M NOT GOING TO REMOVE HER. I'M ASKING THAT YOU PLEASE GIVE QUIET. THIS IS ALL IMPACTING OUR COMMENT TIME. PLEASE, I'M TRYING TO HEAR FROM AS MANY FOLKS AS POSSIBLE.

>> LET HIM START AGAIN.

>> MAYOR ISHII: I'M NOT GOING TO LET HIM START AGAIN, BUT HE CAN FINISH, THERE ARE THREE MINUTES ADDITIONAL.

>> IT DIDN'T HAVE TO BE LIKE THIS. I WROTE FIVE DAYS AFTER THE OCTOBER 7TH TRAGEDIES WHEN YOU BRING FOREIGN AFFAIRS INTO LOCAL GOVERNMENT THIS IS WHAT HAPPENS. THIS IS WHAT I WARNED ABOUT. MY FRIEND MAHTI WHO CEDED ME THE TIME, WAS ASSAULTED OUTSIDE, HIS SHIRT IS RIPPED BECAUSE OF IT.

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>> MAYOR ISHII: FOLKS, PLEASE, COME ON. LET HIM FINISH. STOP, LET HIM FINISH HIS SPEECH, PLEASE. LET HIM FINISH HIS TIME.

>> AS I WAS SAYING --

>> MAYOR ISHII: HE IS ENTITLED TO FINISH HIS TIME, PLEASE ALLOW HIM, YOU NEED TO BE RESPECTFUL. NEED TO BE RESPECTFUL OF HIM. HE IS TRYING TO SPEAK.

>> THIS WAS THE WAR NAME. WE HAD MONEY THROWN AT JEWISH COUNCILMEMBERS AT PAST MEETINGS, HOLOCAUST SURVIVORS HECKLED. WE HAVE HAD TRUE HOPES INVOKED LIKE YOU HEAR BEHIND ME, MAYOR, IT DIDN'T HAVE TO BE LIKE THIS. I'M ASKING YOU TO MOVE PAST THE HATE, DIVISION, HANGER, TENSIONS EVERYONE IN THIS ROOM IS FEELING AND MOVE TOWARD A PLACE OF UNDERSTANDING AND UNITY. ESPECIALLY DURING THESE DIFFICULT POLITICAL TIMES OUR ELECTED LEADERS MUST BRING EVERYONE TOGETHER AND MAKE SURE EVERYONE FEELS WELCOME AND SAFE. I'M ASKING YOU TO VOTE NO AND PLEASE BRING US TOGETHER TO HEAL, THIS IS NOT THE WAY FORWARD, THANK YOU SO MUCH FOR THE TIME. [APPLAUSE]

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. HEY, ORDER, COME ON, PLEASE. PLEASE STOP YELLING. ALLOW PEOPLE TO SPEAK. GO AHEAD.

>> I HAVE A MINUTE FROM ARIEL AND EXTRA MINUTE FROM ALLISON SCOTT ON ZOOM.

>> MAYOR ISHII: I NEED TO IDENTIFY THE SECOND PERSON. BUT I WILL ALLOW YOU TO HAVE AT LEAST TWO, WHEN THEY COME UP, IF WE CAN

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FIND THEM, WE WILL ALLOW IT.

>> MY NAME IS TAHLA, MY FAMILY LIVED IN DISTRICT 5 SINCE THE 40S. MY FAMILY FORCED TO FLEE EGYPT FOR BEING JEWISH. MY GRANDFATHER WATCHED HIS PARENTS AND SISTERS BE SENT TO THE GAS CHAMBERS, THE ONLY PLACE HE WAS WELCOMED TO AS A JEWISH CHILD WAS ISRAEL, NOW AS A PROUD ZIONIST JEWISH FAMILY WE LOVE HOW DIVERSE AND WELCOMING THE BERKELEY COMMUNITY IS, OR SHOULD I SAY WAS. I HAVE NEVER EXPERIENCED SO MUCH ANTI-SEMITISM UNTIL OCTOBER 2023, I'M ASKING YOU TO OPPOSE ANY RESOLUTION ABOUT THE ISRAEL HAMAS WAR, NOT BECAUSE I DON'T WANT AN END TO ALL OF THIS. I DO NOT WANT WAR. I HAVE PERSONALLY HIDDEN IN FIELDS FROM ROCKETS IN BEERSHEBA, SLEPT IN BOMB SHELTERS NEAR THE GAZA STRIP AND MY COUSIN WAS NEARLY KILLED. NEEDLESS TO SAY MY FAMILY, LIKE THE MAJORITY OF PEOPLE HERE DOESN'T WANT THIS WAR TO CONTINUE. THOUGH, LET'S BE REAL, THIS IS A WASTE OF TIME, RICHMOND PASSED 18 MONTHS AGO, THE WAR IS STILL HAPPENING, ISN'T IT? OAKLAND PASSED A SIMILAR RESOLUTION 17 MONTHS AGO, DID HAMAS AND ISRAEL REALLY CARE? SAN FRANCISCO PASSED. HOW SUCCESSFUL WERE THEY? NOT GOING TO PUT AN END TO CONFLICT OVER 7,000 MILES A WAY AND THAT BERKELEY IS ALREADY ON THE CURRENT ADMINISTRATION'S RADAR, I DOUBT YOU WANT TO DRAW MORE NATIONAL ATTENTION.

>> MAYOR ISHII: FOLKS, PLEASE ALLOW HER TO FINISH. I WILL KEEP GIVING HER MORE TIME IF YOU KEEP INTERRUPTING.

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>> BERKELEY HAS A $14 MILLION DEFICIT. WE KNOW THIS RESOLUTION WILL NOT END THE CONFLICT OR BRING PEACE TO THE MIDDLE EAST OR OUR COMMUNITY. LET'S FOCUS ON THE MANY ISSUES INSTEAD OF DRIVING HATE AND DIVIDING US FURTHER.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU FOR YOUR COMMENT. FOLKS, NO NAME CALLING. IT'S COMPLETELY INAPPROPRIATE. WE ARE TRYING TO GIVE EVERYONE A CHANCE TO SPEAK. EVERYONE IS ENTITLED TO SHARE THEIR OPINION.

>> [OFF MIC]

>> MAYOR ISHII: WE ABSOLUTELY DID. WE ARE TRYING TO BE RESPECTFUL OF THAT, THE LONGER SPEAK, FORMER COUNCILMEMBER DAVILA, THE LESS TIME PEOPLE HAVE TO SPEAK.

>> I'M DAVID AND LIVED AND WORKED IN BERKELEY ON AND OFF FOR OVER 30 YEARS. I'M A MEMBER OF THE JEWISH COALITION OF BERKELEY. I'M THE SON OF A HOLOCAUST SURVIVOR AND AN ISRAELI CITIZEN. I'M HERE TO VOICE SUPPORT FOR THE RESOLUTION THAT RECOGNIZES ALL COMMUNITY MEMBERS' RIGHTS TO LIVE FREE FROM DISCRIMINATION AND HATE. YOU ARE BEING ASKED TODAY TO SUPPORT THOSE WHO SHOUT OR HECKLE LOUDEST AGAINST THOSE WHO LIKE MYSELF WISH TO LIVE IN FREEDOM AND PEACE. HOWEVER, LOUD OR PASSIONATE HATE AND DISCRIMINATION VOICES ITSELF, HOWEVER WELL IT COVERS ITSELF WITH FIG LEAVES OR SMOKE SCREENS IT'S WRONG AND HAS NO PLACE HERE IN BERKELEY. THIS BODY HAS NO SAY OVER U.S. FOREIGN POLICY BUT HAS

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A SAY IN THE LIVES OF PEOPLE IN BERKELEY. I ASK YOU VOTE FOR THE DIGNITY OF ALL BY SUPPORTING TERRY TAPLIN'S RESOLUTION. THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. [APPLAUSE]

>> CITY CLERK: AND MAYOR, WE HAVE 30 MINUTES REMAINING FOR IN-PERSON COMMENTS.

>> MAYOR ISHII: OKAY, GO AHEAD.

>> I'VE BEEN GIFTED TWO MINUTES BY AVA DIAZ AND MARTHA SILVA.

>> MAYOR ISHII: I SEE ONE, WHERE IS THE OTHER? SORRY, ANOTHER HAND HERE. OKAY, PLEASE PUT YOUR SIGN DOWN SO WE CAN SEE, EVERYONE CAN SEE. GO AHEAD.

>> MAYOR, COUNCIL, I WOULD LIKE TO POINT OUT THAT TOMORROW, APRIL 29TH IS THE 80TH ANNIVERSARY OF THE LIBERATION OF DACHAU BY AMERICAN ARMY UNITS. AMONG THEM WAS A LOVED ONE IN MY FAMILY, UNCLE MAX. HE WAS ONE OF HUNDREDS OF THOUSANDS OF AMERICANS WHO SACRIFICED A TREMENDOUS AMOUNT TO DEFEAT NAZIS AND PUT AN END TO THEIR GENOCIDE. I KNOW, I ALWAYS ADMIRED UNCLE MAX AND HIS GENERATION FOR THEIR BRAVERY, I WATCHED NAZIS ON MOVIES AND TVS, THEY CONFRONTED THEM AND MANY LOST THEIR LIVES, THERE WERE 100,000 THAT DIDN'T MAKE IT BACK. I BROUGHT THIS AMERICAN FLAG TO OFFER AN AMERICAN PERSPECTIVE. MY UNCLE MAX WOULD BE ROLLING IN HIS GRAVE IF HE KNEW THAT OUR GOVERNMENT WERE NOW SUPPORTING, ENABLING, ABETTING A GENOCIDE AND THE KILLING OF PEOPLE THAT HE

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FOUGHT AGAINST. NAZIS KILLED JOURNALISTS AND THEY EXECUTED PEOPLE AND PUT THEM IN MASS GRAVES. THAT'S WHAT ISRAELIS ARE DOING NOW WITH AMERICAN MONEY. I FEEL THIS IS A DESECRATION OF THE GRAVES OF HUNDREDS OF THOUSANDS OF AMERICAN SERVICE PEOPLE. SOME OF WHOM DIDN'T MAKE IT BACK, BUT EVEN THOSE WHO MADE IT BACK, OR THE FAMILIES, THIS IS A DESECRATION TO THEIR GRAVES. THIS IS NOT WHAT AMERICA STANDS FOR. WHEN I WAS AT COLLEGE AT CAL AND THERE WERE DEMONSTRATIONS AGAINST APARTHEID, WE HAD A CONGRESSMAN, RON DELLUMS, HE INTRODUCED LEGISLATION WHICH HAD STRONG SANCTIONS, STRONG ALLY OF ISRAEL. AND HIS LEGISLATION INCLUDED AN ARMS EMBARGO AGAINST APARTHEID SOUTH AFRICA BECAUSE HE KNEW IF YOU CONTINUE GIVING ARMS TO RACIST BULLIES THEY WILL KEEP USING THEM AGAINST THE VICTIMS OF THEIR RACISM, IT HAPPENED IN SOUTH AFRICA, IT'S HAPPENING IN ISRAEL. THAT'S WHY THE ARMS EMBARGO IS ESSENTIAL. MAYOR, I APPRECIATE SO MANY PROVISIONS OF YOUR AND COUNCILMEMBER BARTLETT'S PROPOSAL BUT WITHOUT THE ARMS EMBARGO, IT'S REALLY LACKING. IT'S SORT OF LIKE SAYING WE CONDEMN THE K.K.K., WE CONDEMN THEIR TERRORISM, AND KILLING OF BLACK PEOPLE, HOWEVER, WE AREN'T GOING TO DO ANYTHING ABOUT THE WEAPON SHIPMENTS WE ARE SHIPPING TO THE K. K. TO CARRY OUT THIS BRUTALITY. SO THAT IS WHY I'M ASKING YOU TO PLEASE INCLUDE THE WEAPONS EMBARGO, BECAUSE THAT IS OUR TAX MONEY TOO. DROPPING 2,000 DO BOMBS ON APARTMENT BUILDINGS OF PALESTINIAN FAMILIES

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DOESN'T HELP US, WE CAN USE THAT ON OUR INFRASTRUCTURE. THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. [APPLAUSE]

>> MAYOR ISHII: GO AHEAD.

>> MY NAME IS DAN BROWNSON, IT WAS ANGLICIZED A LONG TIME AGO. LAST YEAR I ATTENDED ONE OF MY BEST FRIEND'S WEDDINGS. HIS FAMILY HAS BEEN IN PALESTINE FOR LITERALLY THOUSANDS YEARS BEFORE ISLAM EXISTED, BEFORE CHRISTIANITY EXISTED. TODAY THEY ARE MUSLIM, THEY WERE ONCE JEWISH 2,000 YEARS AGO. LET'S NOT PRETEND THE LAST 2,000 YEARS DIDN'T HAPPEN. I'M CEDING THE REST OF MY TIME TO VAL.

>> I'M A HEBREW INSTRUCTOR, I'VE BEEN A HALLEL STUDENT. YOU HAVE TO PASS THE ARMS EMBARGO. I WAS HERE LAST YEAR WHEN WE WERE CALLING FOR A CEASE-FIRE. WE WERE ALL SAYING THE SAME THING, MORE ON THE POINT OF JEWISH SAFETY, WHETHER OR NOT YOU PASS AN ARMS EMBARGO, THIS IS SOMETHING WE HAVE TO DEAL WITH, WHILE WE ARE ON THE TOPIC OF JEWISH SAFETY, I'VE BEEN ASSAULTED BY ZIONISTS AT LEAST A DOZEN TIMES THIS YEAR ALONE. WHEN WE ARE TALKING ABOUT COMMUNITY ISSUES, LET'S TALK ABOUT WHAT AN ARMS EMBARGO RESOLUTION ACTUALLY MEANS, MY FAMILY IS UKRAINIAN. I HAVE FAMILY THERE. YOU PASSED A RESOLUTION THERE, SO QUICK, ONLY TOOK A COUPLE MONTHS. AND THE WAR IS STILL GOING, RIGHT? BUT IT STILL MATTERED THAT YOU MADE THAT DECISION. BECAUSE NOW WHEN I'M

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HERE WITH MY FAMILY I KNOW AT LEAST THIS CITY CARES ABOUT WHAT HAPPENS TO MY FAMILY, RIGHT? THIS ISN'T A CITY THAT SAYS I THINK WE SHOULD START SENDING MONEY AND WEAPONS TO RUSSIA SO THEY CAN ERASE UKRAINIAN PEOPLE, SO THEY CAN DROP BOMBS ON UKRAINIANS AND TRY TO ERASE UKRAINIAN LANGUAGE IN STATE HOOD. I TRY TO THINK OF WHAT IT IS LIKE FOR MY PALESTINIAN CLASSMATES AND FRIENDS WHO ARE WATCHING THE CITY COUNCIL DO THAT VERY THING RIGHT NOW. SO PLEASE, DON'T LISTEN TO THE MEMBERS OF MY JEWISH COMMUNITY WHO SAY WHAT YOU DO DOESN'T MAKE A DIFFERENCE, BECAUSE IT REALLY DOES.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. [APPLAUSE]

>> HELLO, MY NAME IS JEANETTE MCNEILL AND I'VE LIVED IN BERKELEY FOR 54 YEARS, I'M JEWISH, A DISTRICT 2 VOTER AND CURRENT PEACE AND JUSTICE COMMISSIONER WHO HELPED PASS THE RESOLUTION. I'M SO DISAPPOINTED IN HOW THIS MAYOR AND COUNCIL HAVE HANDLED THIS RESOLUTION. FIRST, IT IS RIDICULOUS THAT THE MAYOR OF THE CITY CAN'T OR DIDN'T PROCURE A SPACE LARGE ENOUGH FOR THIS MEETING. SECOND, THE TIME, 5:00 IS EARLY FOR WORKING PEOPLE. IT IS ESPECIALLY DIFFICULT IF PEOPLE HAVE TO WAIT IN LINE TO EVEN GET IN THE MEETING. THAT DISPROPORTIONATELY AFFECTS THE ELDERLY AND DISABLED. AFTER MONTHS OF NOTHING YOU NOW WANT TO BRING RESOLUTIONS? NOW, TO THE RESOLUTION, PASS THE P.J.C. RESOLUTION, WE DEMAND OUR TAX DOLLARS GO TO FUND HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES,

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NOT BILLIONS TO FUND ISRAEL'S GENOCIDE. ANY RESOLUTION MUST INCLUDE A DIRECTIVE FOR AN ARMS EMBARGO.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK, YOUR TIME IS UP. THANK YOU.

>> HELLO, I'VE BEEN WAITING A LONG TIME. WE VIEW ISRAEL AS A CRUCIAL ALLY TO MAINTAIN CONTROL IN THE MIDDLE EAST. ALTHOUGH THE HISTORY OF ZIONISM HAS INVOLVED A MULTITUDE OF COMPLEX FACTORS, THE ACHIEVEMENT OF THE ZIONIST PROGRAM SINCE 1948 HAS REQUIRED THE SYSTEMATIC ETHNIC CLEANSING OF PALESTINIAN LAND. THE RELENTLESS SUBJUGATION OF THE PALESTINIAN PEOPLE AND OBLITERATION OF HISTORICAL, ECOLOGICAL AND CURRENT RECORDS OF CURRENT EVENTS THROUGH INTENSE CAMPAIGNS OF PROPAGANDA, VIOLENCE, RIGHT NOW WE SEE IT IN A GENOCIDE. FRIENDS SAY SOMETIMES PEOPLE HOLD A CORE BELIEF THAT IS VERY STRONG. WHEN THE NEW EVIDENCE CANNOT BE ACCEPTED. IT WOULD CREATE A FEELING THAT IS EXTREMELY UNCOMFORTABLE. THIS IS CALLED COGNITIVE DISSONANCE.

>> MAYOR ISHII: PLEASE, THERE ARE FOLKS THAT ARE COMING. I WOULD LIKE PEOPLE TO SPEAK. PLEASE, GO AHEAD. [APPLAUSE]

>> I WANT TO USE MY ARABIC LANGUAGE, IS THAT OKAY? THANK YOU SO MUCH. I HAVE THREE MINUTES, I THINK. I HAVE THREE MINUTES. YOU WANT TO DONATE? FOUR.

>> MAYOR ISHII: IT LOOKS LIKE YOU HAVE FOUR, BECAUSE YOU HAVE YOURS PLUS THREE PEOPLE.

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>> MY NAME IS? (?) I'M WORKING WITH ALLIANCE BASED IN BERKELEY. THIS ORGANIZATION STATED 37 YEARS AGO. AND STILL WORKING IN THE MIDDLE EAST IN IRAQ, LEBANON, AND PALESTINE. I'M WORKING AT THIS ORGANIZATION WHILE MY COLLEAGUES, OUR STAFF MEMBERS THEY ARE ALREADY RIGHT NOW IN GAZA. AND THEY ARE DELIVERING SUPPORT TO THE PEOPLE OF GAZA. AND THE SUPPORT COMING FROM THE BERKELEY PEOPLE AND FOR MANY OTHER PEOPLE, THERE ARE ALL OVER UNITED STATES. WE SEE THE WEAPONS THAT THE GOVERNMENT DELIVERED TO ISRAEL, BUT LUCKILY WE HAVE PEOPLE HERE.

>> MAYOR ISHII: CAN YOU PAUSE FOR A SECOND? CAN YOU JUST ALLOW HER TO SIT DOWN, PLEASE. THE IDEA HERE WHERE YOU STAND WITH JUSTICE. AND IF YOU ARE THINKING YOU WANT TO BE NEUTRAL, YOU ARE WRONG. I'M SO SORRY TO SAY IT. THERE'S NO NEUTRAL BETWEEN JUSTICE AND INJUSTICE. AND THIS IS HOW IT IS FOR US. THE PREVIOUS DIRECTOR OF OUR BOARD, THE EX MAYOR OF BERKELEY, GUS NEWBERG, I DON'T KNOW IF YOU KNOW HIM, HE IS SOMEONE VERY FAMOUS AND TOOK THE STAND TOWARD SOUTH AFRICA. WE ARE COUNTING ON YOU BECAUSE WE NEED TO HOLD OUR SELF ACCOUNTABLE, EVERY ONE OF US, BECAUSE WE ARE RESPONSIBLE ABOUT THIS ONGOING GENOCIDE. AND WHEN I SPEAK ABOUT THAT NEXT MONTH, FOR ME, IT'S LIKE, IF I SEE A REFUGEE WE COMMEMORATE OUR 77 YEARS OF THE CATASTROPHE. AND THIS IS ONGOING FOR US. AND ALL THESE KIND OF, I'M SO SORRY, SOMETIME WHEN YOU HEAR ALL THIS HYPOCRASY, WHY YOU WANT TO INTERFERE WITH

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A COUNTRY 6,000, BERKELEY TOOK A STAND WITH SOUTH AFRICA FARTHER THAN PALESTINE AND THEY TOOK THIS KIND OF STAND. THIS IS SOCIAL JUSTICE ISSUE. FOR US, NEXT MONTH WE WILL COMMEMORATE THE CATASTROPHE. WHATEVER YOU DECIDE WE HOPE YOU TAKE A STRONG STAND, THIS IS A MOVEMENT, IT'S GROWING, BE PART OF IT, STOP SUPPORTING ISRAEL AT EVERY LEVEL. THE WEAPONS THAT THE UNITED STATES IS SENDING THERE IS KILLING OUR CHILDREN. WE HAVE OVER 17,000 CHILDREN KILLED INSIDE GAZA. THIS IS PART OF OUR WORK, I KNOW WHAT I'M TALKING ABOUT. AND WE ARE STILL TRYING TO SAVE LIVES THERE INSIDE GAZA, ESPECIALLY CHILDREN INSIDE GAZA. SO WE ARE HOPING FROM PEOPLE LIKE YOU TAKING A STAND AGAINST THE ISSUE AND TO BE ON THE RIGHT SIDE OF HISTORY. BECAUSE NO MATTER WHERE WILL BE, WE REMEMBER WHAT YOU DID FOR SOUTH AFRICA, BERKELEY CITY WHAT THEY DID FOR SOUTH AFRICA, LET US REMEMBER YOU. YOU TAKE A STRONG DECISION AND RESOLUTION TO STAND WITH JUSTICE AND TO STOP SUPPORTING ISRAEL WITH WEAPONS AND TO TAKE A STRONG IN THIS MOMENT. THANK YOU SO MUCH. [APPLAUSE]

>> I'M GETTING ANOTHER MINUTE FROM ROHAN.

>> MAYOR ISHII: WHO ARE YOU GETTING YOUR MINUTE FROM? FROM THAT PERSON, THANK YOU.

>> MY NAME IS ANASTACIA; I'M A MUSLIM 8TH GRADER AT WOOLLY MIDDLE SCHOOL. A YEAR AGO I STARTED THIS CLUB WITH MY FRIENDS CALLED THE WATERMELON SOCIETY, A PEACEFUL CLUB TO RAISE

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AWARENESS OF WHAT'S GOING ON IN PALESTINE RIGHT NOW. ALL THE PEOPLE SAYING A CEASE-FIRE IS VIOLENT AND NON-PEACEFUL ARE OUT OF THEIR MIND. EVERY TIME I HAVE SAID, ASKED FOR A CEASE-FIRE I HAVE BEEN CALLED A BOMBER, A TERRORIST, I'VE EVEN BEEN SPIT AT BY A FULL-GROWN ADULT. DO YOU UNDERSTAND HOW CRAZY THAT IS, TO BE SPIT AT BY AN ADULT. WHO IN THEIR RIGHT MIND WOULD THINK THAT? THERE'S CHILDREN OUT THERE DYING. 3-YEAR-OLDS, BABIES, NEWBORNS AND YOU THINK THAT'S OKAY? A BIG MISSILE, 50 POUND MISSILE, WHATEVER IT IS, TARGETED AT A CHILD. WHO IN THEIR RIGHT MIND WOULD THINK THAT'S OKAY? IT'S NOT. AND EVERYONE OVER HERE TRYING TO SIDE WITH THEM AND SAY IT'S OKAY WHAT THEY ARE DOING, IT'S PROTECTION. HOW DO YOU PROTECT YOURSELF FROM A NEWBORN, THAT DOESN'T MAKE SENSE. WHAT DID IT DO TO YOU? NOTHING, OKAY, NOTHING. NOTHING IN THE WORLD CAN DEFEND THAT. SO HANDS ON EMBARGO AND FREE PALESTINE AND A CEASE-FIRE FOREVER. [CHEERS AND APPLAUSE]

>> MAYOR ISHII: MARK, SORRY, I JUST WANT TO CHECK IN ON THE TIME.

>> CITY CLERK: WE'RE AT ONE HOUR 15 MINUTES REMAINING.

>> MAYOR ISHII: ONE HOUR 15 TOTAL.

>> CITY CLERK: YES.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THAT MEANS 15 MINUTES LEFT OF IN-PERSON PUBLIC COMMENT?

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>> CITY CLERK: YES.

>> MAYOR ISHII: OKAY.

>> HI, SO WE HEARD THE WORD SAFETY. AND A LOT OF MY JEWISH NEIGHBORS HAVE SAID THEY DON'T FEEL SAFE. AND I UNDERSTAND BECAUSE I'M JEWISH, I WAS RAISED A ZIONIST. AND OUR ANCESTORS WERE VICTIMIZED OVER THE COURSE OF MILLENNIA, SO IT IS IN OURSELVES, IT CAN BE HEALED AND WE MUST BREAK THE CYCLE OF VICTIM OPPRESSOR. SO WHEN YOU SEE SOMETHING THAT MAKES YOU FEEL UNCOMFORTABLE AND YOU FEEL UNSAFE, IS IT A TIGER? ARE YOU GOING TO GET HARMED? OR IS IT EMOTIONAL HARM? SO WE GOT TO LOOK INSIDE. I USED TO LOOK AT A KAFFIYEH, THE PALESTINIAN FLAG, I'M TALKING TO MY JEWISH NEIGHBORS AND YOU, IGOR, AND TO -- SO YOU FEEL UNCOMFORTABLE. [AUDIO CUTTING OUT]

>> MAYOR ISHII: YOUR TIME IS UP.

>> MY BODY INVOLUNTARILY REACTS LIKE THIS. INSTEAD OF TRYING TO MAKE PEOPLE CHANGE OUT THERE, WE MUST DO THE WORK. AND THAT'S HOW WE ARE GOING TO BRIDGE THE FISHERS IN OUR JEWISH COMMUNITY. THAT'S NOT WHAT YOU ARE DOING HERE. YOU NEED TO TAKE A STAND. WHEN IS IT YOUR TURN TO SAY ENOUGH IS ENOUGH? WHERE IS YOUR LINE? COURAGE, LIKE -- [AUDIO CUTTING OUT] [NO AUDIO] [AUDIO DIFFICULTY]

>> CITY CLERK: IS THE AUDIO OKAY? MAX? AND NED, CAN HEAR?

>> YEAH, OKAY.

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>> CITY CLERK: YES, WE CAN HEAR IN HERE, IT'S ON ZOOM THAT'S THE QUESTION.

>> HELLO, HELLO, HELLO.

>> CITY CLERK: MAX OR NED, IS IT OKAY? IT'S OKAY? ALL RIGHT. YES, I'M GETTING TEXT THAT IT'S BACK. OKAY. OKAY. WE CAN PROCEED.

>> GOOD EVENING, I'M NOT HERE TO SPEAK ABOUT THE IMPORTANCE OF THIS RESOLUTION. MY COMRADES IN THE ROOM HAVE DONE AN EXCELLENT JOB ARTICULATING THAT. I'M HERE TO FULFILL AN OBLIGATION AND PROMISE I MADE TO MY FRIEND OMAR WHO ASKED ME NOT TO USE HIS LAST NAME OUT OF FEAR OF BEING THREATENED. THE TESTIMONY I'M ABOUT TO READ THAT HE PUBLISHED ON JANUARY 5TH WAS UP FOR 24 HOURS AND RECEIVED THOUSANDS OF REPOSTS BEFORE HE TOOK IT DOWN. WHEN I ASKED HIM, HE SAID HE HAD BEEN THREATENED BY COUNTLESS ISRAELI SOLDIERS TRACKING HIM VIA HIS SOLDIERS AND TELLING HIM THEY KNEW WHERE HE WAS GETTING INTERNET AND WOULD TRACK HIM DOWN AND KILL HIM IF HE DIDN'T STOP. THESE ARE HIS WORDS. I'M NOT WRITING THIS TESTIMONY TO MOVE YOU OR MAKE YOU AWARE OF THE TRUTH, I'M WRITING IT BECAUSE I HAD DEEPLY REGRETTED MUCH IN MY LIFE. CLAIMING TO DEMAND FREEDOM AND DESIRING TO LIVE IN PEACE WHILE NEVER CARRYING A WEAPON. IF I COULD WRITE THIS TESTIMONY IN MY OWN BLOOD I COULD, BUT MY TEARS PROCEED ME. TODAY I SAT BY A WOMAN WHO HAD BEEN TRAPPED IN A HOSPITAL IN GAZA. SHE TOLD ME

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ABOUT THE BRUTALITY OF THE EVENTS THAT TOOK PLACE. SHE SAID, I QUOTE "THE ISRAELI ARMY STORMED IN, SAVAGE AND THIRSTY FOR BLOOD AND MURDER, THEY SEPARATED THE WOMEN TO ONE SIDE AND THE MEN TO THE OTHER. THEY FORCED THE WOMEN TO STRIP COMPLETELY AND MADE THEIR HUSBANDS WATCH. IF ANY MAN DARED TO AVERT THEIR GAZE THEY BEAT HIM OR KILLED THEM. THEN THEY BECAME RAPING US ONE AFTER ANOTHER, WHEN THEY FINISHED WITH ONE WOMAN THEY -- COMPLETELY AND SIGNIFYING SHE HAD BEEN RAPED. SOME WOMEN WERE KILLED AFTER BEING RAPED AND WERE THROWN ON TOP OF EACH OTHER. WHAT WAS EVEN MORE BRUTAL THAN THE RAPE WAS FORCING OUR MEN TO WATCH. MANY MEN COULDN'T BEAR TO LOOK AND WERE SHOT IN THE HEAD. MY HUSBAND WAS VERY STUBBORN, THEY RAPED ME IN FRONT OF HIM AND KILLED HIM BEFORE MY EYES. SHE SPOKE WITH ANGUISH, CRYING UNCONTROLLABLY. OMAR ASKS, HAVE YOU CRIED OR ARE YOU WAITING FOR ME TO PLAY SAD MUSIC FOR YOU? CAN YOU SLEEP -- [AUDIO CUTTING OUT] DO YOU THINK YOU CAN CONTINUE LIVING COMFORTABLY WITHOUT DEFENDING THE OPPRESSED IN THIS WORLD? OMAR, GAZA CITY, STILL SURVIVING, 17 MONTHS OF GENOCIDE. THANK YOU. [APPLAUSE]

>> MAYOR ISHII: FOLKS, CAN WE FIX THE CHAIRS IN THE FRONT ROW? I DON'T KNOW WHAT'S HAPPENING OVER HERE. CAN WE GET TO GO BACK INTO ROWS? I DON'T KNOW WHAT'S -- [AUDIO CUTTING OUT]

>> WHILE THEY ARE DOING THAT -- [AUDIO CUTTING OUT]

>> WE'RE NOT LOSING TIME ARE WE?

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>> MAYOR ISHII: WE'RE NOT LOSING TIME. BUT FOLKS, PLEASE. THANK YOU, MARK. WE WANT TO MAKE SURE THERE'S ACCESS. MONI HAS FOUR MINUTES.

>> I WANTED OTHER PEOPLE TO BE ABLE TO SPEAK AS WELL. DOES THE LAW MATTER? THE LAW HAS BEEN VIOLATED BY THE NETANYAHU MILITARY. THERE ARE THREE LAWYERS ON THE DAIS, I SPEAK TO YOU AS A FELLOW LAWYER, CAL ALUM, STUDENT OF JUSTICE SINCE I WAS IN THE SIXTH GRADE FIGHTING AGAINST THE VIETNAM WAR PEACEFULLY, LATER AGAINST THE IRAQ WAR, AGAINST SAINTS WAS A GROUP IN BERKELEY WE HAD STUDENTS AGAINST INTERVENTION EL SALVADOR. JESUS SAID WHAT YOU DO TO THE LEAST OF THESE, REFERRING TO CHILDREN, YOU DO UNTO ME. DO CHILDREN MATTER? DO LOCAL ACTIONS MATTER? SOME WOULD SAY NOT. I INTERVIEWED ONE OF THE COUNCILMEMBERS MOTHER ON THE DAIS, SHE TOLD ME THAT AFTER EXECUTIVE ORDER 9066 SENT A LOT OF HER JAPANESE NEIGHBORS INTO INTERMENT CAMPS THE BLACK FAMILIES IN THE NEIGHBORHOOD IN SOUTH BERKELEY NOW GENTRIFIED TO VERY FEW BLACK PEOPLE LEFT STOOD UP FOR THEM AND LOOKED AFTER THEIR HOMES. DOES THE LOCAL GOVERNMENT MATTER? SHOULD WE JUST FOCUS ON BERKELEY? THAT'S WHAT THE SIGN SAYS BEHIND ME IN THE AUDIENCE. BUT WE LOSE MONEY TO FOOD AND HOUSING AND MENTAL HEALTH SERVICES AND OTHER CARE WHILE WE ARE PAYING FOR BOMBS. $20 BILLION DOLLARS. SENATOR BERNIE SANDERS AND OTHER IN CONGRESS AND OTHER COUNTRIES HAVE CEASED TO GIVE ANY WEAPONS MONEY TO ISRAEL SINCE

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OCTOBER 7TH, 2023. ITALY, SPAIN, COLUMBIA, NETHERLANDS, AND BELGIUM. LOCAL VOICES DO MATTER. I WANT TO JUST GIVE A FEW EXAMPLES THAT, I THINK I HAVE TWO MINUTES LEFT, THANK GOD. HISTORY HAS SHOWN THE IMPACT OF LOCAL GOVERNMENTS AND SMALLER GROUPS MAKING A DIFFERENCE IN GLOBAL MATTERS. ABOLITIONISTS AGAINST SLAVERY. SUFFRAGISTS. DID IT HAPPEN OVERNIGHT? NO, YEARS LATER. SIT-INS, TEACH-INS, ARRESTS, PEACEFUL ACTIONS, MARCHES, FINALLY THESE THINGS WERE PASSED. GANDHI AND DR. KING. SOME IN THIS ROOM, RAISE YOUR HANDS FOUGHT FOR BERKELEY RIGHTS INCLUDING THE RIGHT TO VOTE. WE HELD SIT-INS AND TEACH-INS FOR FREE SPEECH. WHERE ARE WE THE HOME OF, WAR AND WEAPONS OR FREE SPEECH. DIVESTMENT FROM SOUTH AFRICA, NELSON MANDELA THANKED THE STUDENTS OF BERKELEY FOR ENDING APARTHEID. I KNOW PEOPLE WHO MET HIM AT THE AIRPORT AND HE SAID THANK YOU U.C. BERKELEY AND ALL THE STUDENTS AND PEOPLE OF BERKELEY FOR ENDING DECADES OF APARTHEID FOR GENERATIONS. PLEASE PASS A RESOLUTION FOR PEACE. WE CANNOT BOMB PALESTINE TO A PEACEFUL SOLUTION. INSTEAD THE WELL-CRAFTED AND RESEARCHED MEASURE BEFORE YOU FROM YOUR PEACE AND JUSTICE COMMISSION TONIGHT COULD BE A RIPPLE THAT TURNS INTO A WAVE FOR CHANGE. RELEASE FOR ALL HOSTAGES, DIPLOMAT -- HAS BEEN DESTROYED BY OUR BOMBS. IT DIDN'T HAPPEN MAGICALLY; PEOPLE AREN'T BURIED UNDER THE RUBBLE BECAUSE IT JUST HAPPENED IT'S BECAUSE OF THE BOMBS WE SENT THERE; WE ARE PAYING FOR WAR AND WE

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SHOULD NOT. THANK, PLEASE PASS THE MEASURE GIVEN TO YOU BY THE PEACE AND JUSTICE COMMISSION. I WILL GIVE MY 30, 20 SECONDS LEFT TO THE NEXT PERSON. THANK YOU. [APPLAUSE]

>> MAYOR ISHII: YOU ARE GIVEN 17 SECONDS FROM MONI.

>> OKAY, PLUS I HAVE MY OWN ONE MINUTE AND [INDISCERNIBLE] WILL GIVE HIS MINUTE.

>> MAYOR ISHII: I'LL GIVE YOU THE EXTRA 3. OUR CLOCK ISN'T VERY, OKAY, A THIRD MINUTE. [AUDIO CUTTING OUT]

>> MAYOR ISHII: THREE MINUTES AND 17 SECONDS, I WILL MAKE SURE YOU GET THEM IN CASE YOU NEED IT. SORRY IF THAT MADE THAT CONFUSING.

>> MY NAME IS GAIL MCLAUGHLIN, I'M A FORMER MAYOR OF RICHMOND, TOGETHER WITH RICHMOND'S CURRENT MAYOR EDUARDO MARTINEZ WHO YOU HEARD OF A WHILE AGO I WAS A CO-SPONSOR OF THE PRO-PALESTINIAN RESOLUTION WE PASSED AS THE FIRST IN THE NATION ON OCTOBER 24, 2023. SO WE WERE ON TOP OF THIS VERY EARLY. I WANT TO SAY BEFORE I BEGIN JUST A SHORT SET OF REMARKS, WHEN WE PASSED OUR RESOLUTION IN RICHMOND, WE HAD HUNDREDS OF SPEAKERS AND WE LET EVERY SPEAKER SPEAK, REGARDLESS OF THE TIME. SO I WOULD LIKE TO ASK YOU, MAYOR, TO RE-THINK AND GIVE EVERYONE A CHANCE TO TALK. I MEAN, I THINK THAT'S IMPORTANT. THAT'S WHAT DEMOCRACY IS ALL ABOUT. FOR ME, THIS ISSUE IS MORE THAN TAKING A STAND ON FOREIGN POLICY. IT IS ALSO TAKING A STAND FOR HUMANITY'S FUTURE. IF WE

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LET THESE ACTS OF HORRIFIC VIOLENCE STAND AGAINST A POPULATION THAT HAS BEEN LIVING UNDER OCCUPATION IN WHAT HAS BEEN OFTEN CALLED AN OPEN-AIR PRISON FOR DECADES WE ARE TURNING OUR BACKS ON OUR OVERALL HUMAN STRUGGLE. CLOSING OUR EYES TO INJUSTICE IS NOT AN OPTION. WE CANNOT BE INDIFFERENT TO THE WAY 2.2 MILLION PEOPLE IN THE GAZA STRIP CONTINUE TO BE TREATED BY THE STATE OF ISRAEL. A WORLD WHERE ALL PEOPLE FROM PALESTINE, ISRAEL, TO THE U.S. LIVE IN FREEDOM, JUSTICE, EQUALITY AND DIGNITY. I SUPPORT THE PEACE AND JUSTICE COMMISSION RESOLUTION THAT HAS BEEN PRESENTED TO YOU, INCLUDING THE CALL FOR AN ARMS EMBARGO. RICHMOND'S RESOLUTION HAS A CLAUSE IN IT THAT SAYS END ALL CURRENT AND FUTURE MILITARY AID. SO WE ARE TOTALLY ONBOARD WITH THIS. I HOPE BERKELEY DECIDES TO SHOW THE LEVEL OF COURAGE, STRENGTH AND DETERMINATION THAT IS IN YOUR HISTORY AS A CITY. WE HOPE BERKELEY STANDS SIDE-BY-SIDE WITH RICHMOND, ALONG WITH OTHER PROGRESSIVE CITIES AND MAKE OUR UNITED CALL HEARD LOUD AND CLEAR FOR AN END TO THE ATROCITIES AND WAR CRIMES BEING FOISTED UPON THE PALESTINIAN PEOPLE WITH OUR TAX DOLLARS. IF WE STAND FOR LIBERATION OF ALL, WHICH WE SHOULD, WE NEED TO STAND FOR THE LIBERATION OF THE PALESTINIAN PEOPLE. LET'S END THIS MADNESS AND THE GENOCIDE AND THE OCCUPATION. LET'S CALL FOR AN ARMS EMBARGO. [AUDIO CUTTING OUT] [CHEERS AND APPLAUSE]

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU.

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>> I URGE YOU TO VOTE YES ON THE ORIGINAL PEACE AND JUSTICE COMMISSION'S ARMS EMBARGO RESOLUTION, IT'S NOT MERELY ENOUGH TO NAME LIFE IN PALESTINE, JEWISH TRADITION TEACHES US YOU MUST NOT STAND IDLY BY THE BLOOD OF YOUR NEIGHBOR. YOU MUST NOT STAND IDLY BY. AS LEADERS OF OUR COMMUNITY HAVE THE OPPORTUNITY RIGHT NOW TO CALL FOR AN ARMS EMBARGO TO MATERIALLY DISRUPT THE GENOCIDE AND OCCUPATION, CONTRARY TO WHAT COUNCILMEMBER TAPLIN SUGGESTED YOUR VOICES ACTUALLY DO MATTER. WHEN I SAY FREE PALESTINE I'M CALLING FOR A WORLD WHERE PALESTINIAN HUMAN BEINGS HAVE A FUTURE AND RIGHT TO EVERY HUMAN DIGNITY, AND I'M ALSO CALLING FOR A WORLD WHERE BOTH PALESTINIANS AND JEWS CAN BE FREE BECAUSE I KNOW NONE OF US CAN BE FREE WHEN ANY OF US ARE DEHUMANIZED THIS WAY AND CERTAINLY CAN'T BE FREE WHEN DEHUMANIZING OTHERS. ARMS EMBARGO NOW. [APPLAUSE]

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU.

>> HELLO, COUNCILMEMBERS AND MY FELLOW BERKELEY RESIDENTS. MY NAME IS MARCIA FINE -- I HAVE BEEN LIVING IN BERKELEY SINCE 1983 AND A JEW SINCE 1949 WHEN I WAS BORN. I DO NOT FEEL THREATENED BY ANTI-SEMITISM IN BERKELEY. BUT WHAT KEEPS ME UP AT NIGHT IS ALL OF THAT DEVASTATION, DESTRUCTION, BOMBING, NO FOOD. I MEAN WHAT'S GOING ON IN GAZA KEEPS ME UP AT NIGHT. IF YOU WANT TO HELP THIS OLD LADY SLEEP AT NIGHT, PASS THE RESOLUTION FROM THE PEACE AND JUSTICE COMMISSION. AND THESE OTHER RESOLUTIONS TO ME

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LOOK LIKE OBFUSCATION, THEY LOOK LIKE AVOIDING THE ISSUE ENTIRELY, THEY ARE NOT GOING TO HELP AND THEY AREN'T GOING TO BRING UNITY TO US. BUT THERE'S ONE GOOD THING IN THERE, THAT IS YOUR CALL FOR ALLOWING FREE SPEECH ON CAMPUSES. SO THAT THESE STUDENTS WHO SUPPORT THE PALESTINIANS CAN SPEAK AND NOT GET ARRESTED.

>> MAYOR ISHII: SORRY, YOUR TIME IS UP.

>> MAKE IT A SEPARATE RESOLUTION.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANKS, YOUR TIME IS UP. THANK YOU. [APPLAUSE]

>> I HAVE SANDY AS WELL GIVING -- SANDY.

>> MAYOR ISHII: SORRY, SAY AGAIN?

>> SANDY.

>> MAYOR ISHII: SANDY?

>> MICHELLE ALSO TO GIVE UP TIME. AND THEN DART NEXT TO THEM.

>> MAYOR ISHII: I WILL TAKE THIS PERSON IN THE BACK. THAT'S TWO.

>> OKAY. I'M HERE SPEAKING AS A BERKELEY RESIDENT AND STUDENT AT U.C. BERKELEY TO URGE YOU TO VOTE YES ON THE PEACE AND JUSTICE COMMISSION ARMS EMBARGO WITH NO AMENDMENTS OR DELAYS. I WANT TO MAKE IT CLEAR THE LANGUAGE IS NOTHING MORE THAN WEAPONIZATION OF THE LANGUAGE FACED BY STUDENT ORGANIZERS. THEY HAVE BEEN PUTTING US ON THE LINE, NOT FOR FREE SPEECH. IT'S THE LACK OF LEADERSHIP, THE LEVELS OF GOVERNMENT, EVERY LEVEL OF GOVERNMENT THAT'S PUT STUDENTS ON THE FRONT LINES. FAILURES EVERYONE IN

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THIS ROOM HAS BEEN SEEING 570 DAYS FROM EACH AND EVERY SINGLE ONE OF YOU. AS THE TRUMP ADMINISTRATION ROLLS OUT THE -- [READING RAPIDLY] REJECTING REPRESSION WITHOUT ENGAGING OUR CHORDEE MANDS AND CONTINUING TO SILENCE US THEMSELVES. BERKELEY CAN BE THE FIRST TO DIVEST. STOP TOKENIZING US TO DO THE BARE MINIMUM TODAY. IF YOU DO NOT INCLUDE THE CALL FOR ARMS EMBARGO YOU HAVE LEAD TO MAHMOUD BEING DEPORTED AND ARRESTED. I WANT TO SAY HOW DISGUSTED I FEEL TALKING ABOUT -- IT'S BEING FUNDED BY EVERY ONE OF OUR TAX DOLLARS AND ALL OF US HAVE SAT COMPLICIT DOING NOTHING, IN THIS ROOM TIME AND TIME AGAIN. I HAVE HAD FRIENDS SPEAKING ABOUT THEIR FAMILY MEMBERS DYING, MANY OF YOU LOOKING AWAY, HAVEN'T BEEN MAKING EYE CONTACT, DOING THINGS ON YOUR PHONES AND COMPUTER. THIS ARMS EMBARGO IS THE ABSOLUTE BARE MINIMUM THAT COULD BE DONE. FREE PALESTINE AND PLEASE PASS IT WITHOUT ANY FURTHER AMENDMENTS, THANK YOU. [APPLAUSE]

>> MAYOR ISHII: OKAY.

>> [INDISCERNIBLE] HAS OFFED OFFERED TO GIVE ME A MINUTE OF TIME.

>> MAYOR ISHII: REAL QUICK, JUST CHECKING ON OUR TIME.

>> CITY CLERK: WE ARE AT ONE HOUR.

>> MAYOR ISHII: WE ARE AT ONE HOUR RIGHT NOW.

>> THE VIETNAM WAR WHICH WAS GENOCIDE --

>> MAYOR ISHII: HOLD ON. WE ARE ACTUALLY GOING OVER INTO OUR

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ZOOM TIME. BUT I FEEL LIKE BECAUSE YOU HAVE WALKED --

>> [OFF MIC]

>> MAYOR ISHII: EXCUSE ME. WOULD YOU LIKE TO HEAR WHAT I HAVE TO SAY, I WOULD LIKE TO GIVE HIM HIS TIME TO SPEAK. SORRY, WHAT I WAS GOING TO SAY IS I'M GOING TO GIVE YOU YOUR TIME SINCE YOU ALREADY STOOD UP AND YOU ARE AT THE MIC. THAT WILL EAT INTO THE ZOOM TIME. AND THEN WE ARE GOING TO TAKE A BREAK. GO AHEAD.

>> AS A VETERAN OF THE VIETNAM WAR, WHICH WAS A GENOCIDE IN ITS OWN WAY, KILLING TWO MILLION CIVILIANS, ONE MILLION SOLDIERS ON BOTH SIDES OF THAT WAR, AN ANALOGY I CAN USE IS WHAT HAPPENED TO THE U.S.S. LIBERTY WHEN IT WAS ATTACKED BY THE ZIONIST ENTITY ON JUNE 8, 1967? THE ANALOGY NAL THEY HAD FOUR 50 CALIBER MACHINE GUNS TO DEFEND THEMSELVES. OVERWHELMINGLY ZIONIST AIRPLANES, TORPEDOES, EVERYTHING LIKE THAT. I BRING IT BACK WHEN I JOINED THE VIETNAM VETERANS AGAINST THE WAR AFTER I GOT RELEASED. I CARRIED AN N.L.F. FLAG. NATIONAL LIBERATION FRONT WHEN I WAS PROTESTING WITH VIETNAM VETERANS AGAINST THE WAR. LIKE A CARRY A PALESTINIAN FLAG NOW PROTESTING THE GENOCIDE GOING ON IN GAZA. YES IT'S ME THAT WORE THAT SHIRT, I RESPECT HIM, HE WAS A FAMILY MAN AND STRATEGIST. HE RESISTED THE ZIONIST OPPRESSION FOR 77 YEARS. HE HAS BEEN RESISTING IT AND HE WAS MURDERED. THIS HAS GOT TO STOP. IT WILL STOP, IT HAS TO STOP. IT HAS TO BEGIN SOMEWHERE. AND THE COWARDS THAT DIDN'T SHOW UP, THE ZIONISTS

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THAT DIDN'T SHOW UP FOR THE MEETING, I APPLAUD YOU FOR BEING HERE IN PERSON. BUT THERE ARE ZIONISTS AND COWARDS THAT STAYED AT HOME THROUGH THE ZOOM, I DON'T RESPECT AT ALL. I RESPECT YOU FOR STAYING AND LISTENING TO THIS. BUT REMEMBER, GAZA AND VIETNAM ARE THE SAME THING. SAME DAMN THING, GOING ON AND ON AND ON. IT WENT ON AND ON AND ON. YOU JUST GOT OVER MY STUFF THAT I CARRIED AROUND, JUST GOT OVER IT RECENTLY, YOU KNOW. WE LEARNED HOW TO KILL PEOPLE. WE LEARNED HOW TO MURDER PEOPLE. I WAS ON A NUCLEAR WEAPONS LOADING TEAM FOR CRYING OUT LOUD. IF WE HAD BEEN ORDERED TO DO IT, WE WOULD HAVE DONE IT. THAT'S HOW BRAIN WASHED WE WERE. THAT'S HOW BRAIN WASHED THE PEOPLE ARE. PLEASE, DO NOT CONTRIBUTE TO THAT. IF YOU HAVE NEVER BEEN IN THE MILITARY, YOU HAVE NO IDEA. WE WENT IN WITH A GREAT IDEA PROTECTING EVERYBODY, WE WERE LIED TO, WE WERE CHEATED, WE WERE ROBBED OF OUR YOUTH. AND YOU KNOW, CEASE-FIRE AND THE ARMS EMBARGO NOW, THANK YOU. [APPLAUSE]

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU FOR YOUR COMMENT. WE ARE GOING TO TAKE A 10-MINUTE BREAK RIGHT NOW. [RECORDING STOPPED] [BREAK] [BREAK]

>> MAYOR ISHII: ALL RIGHT, FOLKS. HELLO. THANK YOU FOR YOUR PATIENCE. WE ARE ENDING OUR BREAK. FOLKS, PLEASE HAVE A SEAT. [RECORDING IN PROGRESS]

>> MAYOR ISHII: FOLK S, PLEASE HAVE A SEAT, THANK YOU. THANK YOU. OKAY, FOLKS ONLINE, COUNCILMEMBERS, ARE YOU THERE?

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COUNCILMEMBER TREGUB, TAPLIN, KESARWANI. THANK YOU VERY MUCH, I APPRECIATE YOU ALL. THANK YOU VERY MUCH FOR YOUR PATIENCE.

>> C. LUNAPARRA: THANK YOU, I WOULD LIKE TO MAKE A MOTION TO EXTEND THE TIME TO SPEAK FOR AN HOUR LONGER FOR PUBLIC COMMENT. [APPLAUSE]

>> MAYOR ISHII: I'M GOING TO SECOND THAT. AND I WANT TO ASK THE BODY HOW THEY ARE FEELING. DO YOU HAVE THOUGHTS?

>> T. TAPLIN: NO.

>> MAYOR ISHII: SORRY.

>> B. BARTLETT: THIS IS AMERICA.

>> S. O'KEEFE: I THINK THIS IS IMPORTANT AND I WOULD LIKE TO HEAR FROM MORE PEOPLE WHO CAME TO SPEAK.

>> B. BLACKABY: I WOULD SUPPORT THAT AS WELL.

>> MAYOR ISHII: I WANT TO GET SENSE OF THE BODY. LET'S TAKE A VOTE.

>> CITY CLERK: TO EXTEND THE PUBLIC COMMENT PERIOD FOR ONE HOUR. COUNCILMEMBER KESARWANI?

>> R. KESARWANI: YES.

>> CITY CLERK: TAPLIN?

>> T. TAPLIN: NO.

>> CITY CLERK: BARTLETT?

>> B. BARTLETT: YES.

>> CITY CLERK: TREGUB?

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>> I. TREGUB: AYE.

>> CITY CLERK: O'KEEFE?

>> S. O'KEEFE: YES.

>> CITY CLERK: BLACKABY?

>>

>> B. BLACKABY: YES.

>> CITY CLERK: LUNAPARRA?

>> C. LUNAPARRA: YES.

>> CITY CLERK: HUMBERT?

>> M. HUMBERT: ABSTAIN.

>> CITY CLERK: AND ISHII?

>> MAYOR ISHII: YES. OKAY, FOR THE HOUR, ACTUALLY, CAN WE --

>> T. TAPLIN: CAN I GET CLARITY, IS THIS AN HOUR FOR IN-PERSON OR IN ZOOM?

>> MAYOR ISHII: THAT'S WHAT I WAS JUST GOING TO SAY, I WAS GOING TO ASK IF YOU HAD A CLARIFICATION, IF YOU HAD THOUGHTS. I CAN CHOOSE TO SEPARATE, I BELIEVE.

>> C. LUNAPARRA: WE CAN DO HALF A PERSON IN PERSON, HALF AN HOUR ONLINE.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THAT WOULD ALLOW FOR 30 MORE MINUTES IN PERSON. THERE'S AN HOUR LEFT SO AN HOUR AND A HALF WOULD BE FOR ZOOM AND HALF HOUR HERE. I WOULD LIKE TO RECOMMEND MAYBE 45 --

>> C. LUNAPARRA: I KNOW OF PEOPLE THAT ARE ONLINE THAT WANT --

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>> MAYOR ISHII: FOLKS.

>> C. LUNAPARRA: I KNOW PEOPLE RAISING HAND ONLINE THEIR GOAL WAS TO CEDE THEIR TIME TO ANOTHER PERSON.

>> MAYOR ISHII: I WOULD LIKE TO RECOMMEND WE USE 45 MINUTES FOR IN PERSON AND ADD THE EXTRA 15 MINUTES ONLINE. WE WILL DO 45 MINUTES MORE IN PERSON AND I WILL LET THIS PERSON HERE START.

>> T. TAPLIN: SORRY, POINT OF CLARITY. I WOULD LIKE CLARITY HOW THE PEOPLE ON ZOOM ARE ACCEPTING TIME CEDED FROM PEOPLE ON ZOOM.

>> MAYOR ISHII: SO FAR I HAVEN'T ACCEPTED PEOPLE ON ZOOM BECAUSE THERE'S BEEN ENOUGH PEOPLE IN PERSON.

>> T. TAPLIN: THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR ISHII: GO AHEAD.

>> I MOVED TO BERKELEY 55 YEARS AGO BECAUSE IT STOOD UP FOR JUSTICE AND ALL THE GREAT VALUES, THAT'S WHY I CAME HERE. AND I DON'T THINK IT'S AN EITHER/OR THAT WE ONLY DO LOCAL OR DO FOREIGN POLICY. BUT I WANT TO SAY THAT THE ARMS EMBARGO THING IS IMPORTANT BECAUSE NETANYAHU IS GOING TO KEEP DOING WHAT HE IS DOING. IT'S PRETTY OBVIOUS. HE IS GOING ALONG WITH THE IDEA OF COMPLETELY MOVING THE POPULATION OUT OF GAZA. LOOK AT WHAT'S GOING ON IN THE WEST BANK, AS LONG AS HAS THE WEAPONS AND THE BACKING OF THE U.S. WITH WEAPONS, HE'S GOING TO KEEP DOING THE SAME THING. AND THERE'S NO WAY TO STOP IT EXCEPT REALLY DOING SOMETHING DRAMATIC, NAMELY, STOP GIVING HIM ARMS. AND THE PEACE

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AND JUSTICE COMMISSION REMINDS US THERE'S NO PEACE WITHOUT JUSTICE.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. [APPLAUSE]

>> I'M JUST AN ORDINARY PERSON. BUT ME AND 25 OTHER ORDINARY PEOPLE TOOK AN EXTRAORDINARY ACTION LAST APRIL. COLLECTIVELY KNOWN AS GOLDEN GATE 26. [CHEERS AND APPLAUSE] AND WE ALLEGEDLY STOOD ON THE BRIDGE TO MAKE A STATEMENT FOR A CEASE-FIRE IN GAZA. YOU, AS A BODY, CAN TAKE AN EXTRAORDINARY ACTION BY PASSING THIS ARMS EMBARGO. THANK YOU. [APPLAUSE]

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. NEXT PERSON? HURRY. WE HAVE OUR 45 MINUTES. THANK YOU.

>> I THINK I HAVE TIME FROM GAIL ALACOQUE.

>> MAYOR ISHII: GAIL?

>> AND HUGO. YUKO. I'M A NURSE WHO WATCHED MY COLLEAGUES BE TARGETED, TORTURED, DISAPPEARED AND OVER 1300 OF THEM MARTYRED FOR DOING THEIR JOB. WE LIVE IN A SOCIETY WHERE SAYING BOMBING HOSPITALS IS WRONG AND IT GETS YOU DOXED, FIRED OR DEPORTED. SHAME. OUR LIVES ARE DETERMINED BY THE CHOICES WE MAKE OAR THE CHOICES AND DECISIONS WE DO NOT MAKE. WHEN THOSE IN POW HE HAD AN OPPORTUNITY TO MAKE A STAND FOR HUMANITY. THIS IS YOUR COLLECTIVE OPPORTUNITY. CEMENTS ACKNOWLEDGMENT THE POWER YOU HAVE WILL NOT CONCEDE TO THE WEAPONIZATION OF ANTI-SEMITISM CURRENTLY BEING USED TO SHUT DOWN DECISIONS AROUND A GENOCIDE.

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HISTORY HAS BEEN CO OPTED BY THOSE WHO WIELD SUPREMACY, DISCRIMINATION AND RACISM TO KEEP PEOPLE OF COLOR OPPRESSED. IF YOU KEEP ARGUING YOUR SAFETY DEPENDS ON THE GENOCIDE OF THE PALESTINIAN PEOPLE, NEED TO LOOK INTO THE MIRROR AND ASK WHERE DID YOUR HUMANITY GO. TO DARE TO STAND ON OHLONE LANDS AND CONTROL THE NARRATIVE COLONIAL VIOLENCE IS DISGUSTING AND DISGRACEFUL. THE SAME WAY YOU GO AFTER ETHNIC STUDIES TO CONTROL PEOPLE OF COLOR'S VOICE. WE NEED A YES-VOTE ON WHAT YOU CAN SEE BY THE AMOUNT OF PEOPLE HERE THAT HAVE SHOWN UP IN THE MIDST OF A LIVE STREAM GENOCIDE, TO REFLECT THE WISHES OF THE PEOPLE OF BERKELEY. VOTE YES ON ETHICAL INVESTMENT, END MILITARY AID TO ISRAEL NOW, NO MONEY FOR WARS, INVEST TAX DOLLARS INTO COMMUNITY AND THOSE AT RISK IN THE MIDST OF A FASCIST GOVERNMENT THAT'S TARGETED ALL OF US. TAKE A STAND AGAINST WAR CRIMES. THERE ARE MANY PEOPLE IN THIS ROOM SPEAKING UP DESPITE THE UGLY ATTEMPTS BY OTHERS IN THIS ROOM TO DOX US JUST FOR SPEAKING UP NOR JUSTICE AND HUMANITY. DOXING IS ANOTHER TOOL USED BY WHITE SUPREMACY TO SILENCE AND CENSURE PEOPLE OF COLOR. PLEASE DO THE RIGHT THING. [APPLAUSE]

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. NEXT SPEAKER, PLEASE. SPEAKERS, FOLKS IN LINE.

>> I CEDE MY MINUTE TO THE NEXT PERSON.

>> MAYOR ISHII: FOLKS IN LINE?

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>> WILL SOMEONE IN THE AUDIENCE NAMED MAGNUS IS CEDING THEIR TIME, THEY ARE HERE IN PERSON.

>> MAYOR ISHII: KEEP IN MIND, THAT MEANS FEWER PEOPLE WILL GET TO SPEAK IN PERSON. IT'S 2:40. I DON'T KNOW IF YOU CAN DO THAT. IF YOU CAN'T DO 40, I CAN KEEP TRACK. OKAY, THANK YOU.

>> MY TAX DOLLARS WERE USED TO KILL MY FAMILY IN GAZA OVER A YEAR AGO. I STAND HERE BEFORE YOU AS A PALESTINIAN WHO LIVES IN BERKELEY, UTTERLY HEARTBROKEN AND WITNESSING TIME AND TIME AGAIN, DAY AFTER DAY, THE EVIL, THE PURE FUCKIN EVIL ISRAEL IS BACKED BY AMERICA. PASS AN ARMS EMBARGO, THAT'S THE BARE FREAKIN' MINIMUM. WE SHOULD HAVE PASSED A CEASE-FIRE; WE ARE SO DAMN TIRED TO COME INTO THIS ROOM AND BEG YOU TO SEE THE HUMANITY IN US. BEGGING FOR YOU TO UNDERSTAND HOW WRONG IT IS FOR US TO SEE OUR FAMILIES BEING OBLITERATED. SEEING VIDEOS, I WAKE UP IN THE MORNING, YOU KNOW WHAT WE SEE? WE SEE BODIES BOMBED INTO THE FUCKING AIR. THOSE ARE INNOCENT PEOPLE WHO HAVE FAMILIES, WHO HAVE DREAMS. WHO HAVE BABIES. THESE ARE PREGNANT WOMEN. THESE ARE CHILDREN THAT I DON'T EVEN KNOW HOW MANY BABIES WITH THE AGE ZERO HAVE BEEN MARTYRED, RUTHLESSLY MUR DID HEED BECAUSE THE LIST IS SO FUCKING LONG. I STAND BEFORE YOU SAYING ARMS EMBARGO IS THE ABSOLUTE MINIMUM. WE NEED AN ARMS EMBARGO BAR NOW; WE NEED THE PEACE AND JUSTICE COMMISSION RESOLUTION SIX MONTHS AGO. HOW MANY PEOPLE HAVE DIED WHEN WE COULD HAVE DONE

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SOMETHING AS A CITY. I'M SICK OF OUR TAX DOLLARS BEING USED TO BOMB BABIES. COULD GO TO SO MANY THINGS HERE IN BERKELEY, WE COULD HELP THE HOMELESS COMMUNITY. WE COULD PROVIDE FREE OR SUPPORTIVE THINGS FOR SUPPORTIVE SOCIAL SERVICES FOR OUR COMMUNITY. I WAS ASSAULTED A YEAR AGO BY AN UNHOUSED COMMUNITY MEMBER AND YOU KNOW WHAT, I WOULD HAVE LOVED TO BE ABLE TO CALL SOMEONE AND SAY PLEASE HELP HIM. AND SAID NO THERE'S NOTHING THERE, INSTEAD OUR TAX DOLLARS ARE BEING USED TO BOMB BABIES, TO BOMB MY FAMILY AND BOMB COUNTLESS OTHER FAMILIES. EVERY SINGLE PALESTINIAN PERSON I KNOW, THEIR FAMILIES HAVE BEEN KILLED RUTHLESSLY. EVERY SINGLE PERSON. THIS IS PURE FUCKING EVIL. THIS ARMS EMBARGO RESOLUTION IS THE LEAST WE CAN DO, PLEASE PASS IT, PLEASE. [APPLAUSE]

>> HI, I BELIEVE MAE IN PERSON IS CEDING THEIR TIME. THANK YOU. SILENCE IS VIOLENCE. NON-ACTION IS AN ACTION. ALL OF THE EVIDENCE HAS BEEN LAID OUT IN FRONT OF YOU AND MADE ABUNDANTLY CLEAR, THE RAPE, THE ABUSE, THE KILLING, IT'S IN FRONT OF YOU. THERE'S IMAGES, EVIDENCE, YOU CAN SEE IT. ANY ACTION, ANYTHING PASSED ON THE DAIS TONIGHT WILL INTO THE BE ENOUGH, CANNOT BE ENOUGH, EVEN THE PEACE AND JUSTICE COMMISSION PROPOSAL WILL NOT BE ENOUGH. WHEN YOU GO HOME TONIGHT YOU MAY SAY I VOTED FOR BIPARTISAN SHIP OR ANYTHING, BUT YOU WILL KNOW IN THE BACK OF YOUR HEAD YOU HAVE HAD ALL THIS EVIDENCE, ALL THESE PERSONAL

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TESTIMONIES LAID IN FRONT OF YOU PERSONALLY, PEOPLE OPENING THEIR SOULS TO YOU, AND YOU WILL KNOW THAT YOU HAVE IGNORED IT IN FAVOR OF SOME FAKE BIPARTISAN SHIP. SOME REFUSAL TO TAKE A STANCE OVER A CONTROVERSIAL ISSUE, WHY IS THAT? WHEN YOU GO HOME, THINK TO YOURSELF, WHY DID I MAKE THAT CHOICE? AM I OKAY WITH THE FACT THAT I HAVE MADE THIS MY VERY PUBLIC STANCE? EVERYONE IS WATCHING. EVERYONE IN THIS ROOM IS WATCHING. ALL THE FUCKING VIOLENCE AND I KNOW THERE ARE PEOPLE ON THE DAIS WHO ALREADY HAVE THEIR MINDS MADE UP, AS THEY HAVE GLASS EYES THEY WATCH PEOPLE POUR OUT THEIR SOULS. THEY ALREADY HAVE THEIR MINDS SET. THEY DON'T WANT TO LISTEN TO PEOPLE OR CONTEND WITH THE FACT THERE'S A POSSIBILITY THERE'S VIOLENCE THEY MAY HAVE HAD A HAND IN OR CONTEND WITH THE FACT NON-ACTION IS AN ACTION CONDONING VIOLENCE, BECAUSE THAT'S UNCOMFORTABLE. BUT AS A PUBLIC SERVICE MEMBER YOU CHOOSE TO BE HERE, AND YOU CHOOSE TO HAVE TO MAKE THESE UNCOMFORTABLE DECISIONS. SO I KNOW THERE ARE SOME PEOPLE TONIGHT WHO WILL NOTE VOTE THE RIGHT WAY AND WILL HAVE TO LIVE WITH THAT. [APPLAUSE]

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU.

>> I HAVE A MINUTE FROM LARRY.

>> MAYOR ISHII: LARRY?

>> THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR ISHII: ONE MINUTE FROM THIS PERSON OVER HERE. GO AHEAD.

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>> HI, MY NAME IS JOSLYN, I THINK A LOT OF YOU KNOW ME, BERKELEY MEMBER, SIEU MEMBER, JEWISH MEMBER, I WORK HERE IN BERKELEY. I WANT TO THANK THOSE OF YOU, WHO HAVE TAKEN THE TIME TO MEET WITH ME AND OTHER 1021 MEMBERS. THE REASON WE TAKE SO MUCH TIME AND THOUGHT AND LOVE AND CARE AND HEARTBREAK AND PUT IT INTO THIS IS BECAUSE WE REALLY CARE. SEIU 1021 IS A BIG UNION, WE SPAN FROM CENTRAL VALLEY TO THE OREGON COAST. WE HAVE BEEN ABLE TO HAVE THESE HARD CONVERSATIONS INTERNALLY AND CHOSE TO MAKE A PRINCIPLED STANCE. NOT ONLY TO CALL FOR A CEASE-FIRE AND END TO THE OCCUPATION AND EVEN DIVESTMENT. PART OF OUR RESOLUTION, I JUST KEEP REPEATING THE SAME THING OVER AND OVER AGAIN, AFTER A LONG DAY OF WORKING FOR THIS COMMUNITY, I'M SO TIRED. SICK AND TIRED OF THIS. AS WORKERS FROM A UNION THAT HAS TAKEN A PRINCIPLED STANCE WE ARE MANDATED TO CALL ON YOU TO JOIN US. THIS IS A LOCAL ISSUE AND A LABOR ISSUE. YOU SEE PEOPLE LIKE MY UNION SIBLING, SEIU 590 SNATCHED OFF THE STREET GESTAPO-STYLE WITH NO DUE PROCESS. YOU SEE WHAT HAPPENS TO SO MANY STUDENTS HERE IN BERKELEY. IF YOU THINK THIS IS A REMOTE ABSTRACT ISSUE YOU CAN DANCE AROUND AND THREAD THE NEEDLE ON, THIS IS HERE NOW IN BERKELEY. THIS IS REAL, THIS IS AFFECTING WORKERS, THIS IS AFFECTING STUDENTS. I THINK THAT IF YOU PASS THE RESOLUTION WITHOUT -- DOES ANYBODY WANT TO CEDE ANOTHER MINUTE TO ME?

>> PEOPLE ONLINE WILL CEDE.

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>> MAYOR ISHII: I'M SORRY, FOLKS, WE ARE REALLY TRYING TO MAKE SURE THAT EVERYONE GETS A CHANCE TO SPEAK HERE. THE REQUEST IS WE ALLOW FOLKS TO SPEAK IN THE ROOM. I THINK WE NEED TO BE RESPECTFUL OF THAT. SOMEONE ELSE IS CEDING A MINUTE TO YOU, GO AHEAD.

>> THANK YOU. I JUST REALLY WANT TO ASK YOU TO PLEASE LISTEN TO ME, WE ARE CO-WORKERS. WE WORK TOGETHER. I WANT TO WORK TOGETHER WITH YOU. IF YOU PASS A RESOLUTION THAT DOESN'T, AT THE VERY BARE MINIMUM CALL FOR AN ARMS EMBARGO THAT IS GOING TO SAY SO MUCH MORE ABOUT YOU THAN IT DOES ABOUT THE GENOCIDE. IF YOU CAN'T SAY THE WORDS GENOCIDE, APARTHEID AND PLEASE, ARMS EMBARGO, WHAT THAT SAYS TO THE PEOPLE OF BERKELEY, I'M REALLY SORRY TO SAY THIS, BECAUSE WE ARE CO-WORKERS BUT WE DESERVE BETTER. I STAND TO PUT MYSELF AT SO MUCH RISK AS A BERKELEY WORKER. IF YOU CAN'T READY, GET READY FOR A LEFT LABOR COALITION THAT WILL RUN A GOOD CANDIDATE FROM EVERY DISTRICT AND GET OUR COUNCIL BACK. I REALLY WANT YOU TO BE THERE WITH ME.

>> MAYOR ISHII: YOUR TIME IS UP.

>> ONE CITY, ONE TEAM.

>> MAYOR ISHII: YOU HAVE BEEN GIVEN ANOTHER MINUTE, PLEASE. THANK YOU. [APPLAUSE]

>> AM I AUDIBLE? ALL RIGHT, GREAT. MY NAME IS GORDON GILMORE, I WANT TO START BY SAYING I'M IN FULL SUPPORT OF THE PEACE AND

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JUSTICE COMMISSION'S FORM OF RESOLUTION. BUT I WANTED TO TALK ABOUT A COMMON TALKING POINT I HAVE HEARD MULTIPLE TIMES ON THE PART OF THOSE OPPOSING A CEASE FIRE RESOLUTION IS ANTI ZIONISM IS ANTI-SEMITIC; THIS IS A HARMFUL EQUIVOCATION FOR OUR COMMUNITY. AS MANY OF MY FRIENDS IN THE JEWISH COMMUNITY ARE ANTI-ZIONIST, EMBRACE THEIR JEWISH CULTURE AND PEOPLE WHICH IS INTO THE A CONTRADICTION. TO THIS END, DR. DANIEL -- FROM WHOM I RECEIVED HIS BLESSING TO QUOTE HIS WORK IN MY PUBLIC COMMENT. I CATEGORICALLY REJECT THE NATION STATE SOLUTION TO CONTINUITY OF JEWISH CULTURE IN SUPPORT OF NATIONALISM THAT OFFERS NOT THE PROMISE OF SECURITY BUT RATHER THE HIGHLY CONTINGENT POSSIBILITY OF HIGHLY COLLECTIVE EXISTENCE.

>> MAYOR ISHII: SORRY, THANK YOU. [APPLAUSE] MANY PEOPLE HAVE ALREADY GIVEN THEIR MINUTE, I'M SORRY, GO AHEAD.

>> HI, THERE, I HAVE TWO PEOPLE OFFERING TO CEDE TIME, RITHIKA, AND ANJA.

>> MAYOR ISHII: RITHIKA AND ANJA HERE? I HAVEN'T BEEN TAKING PEOPLE'S TIME. I WANT TO BE CONSISTENT. AND IT'S VERY HARD FOR US TO FIND AND IT TAKES MORE TIME. THIS PERSON HERE WILL GIVE A MINUTE. THAT GIVES YOU TWO, GO AHEAD.

>> MY NAME IS SINGH; I'M A BERKELEY NATIVE --

>> MAYOR ISHII: YOU MIGHT WANT TO PULL THE MIC CLOSER.

>> I'M A BERKELEY NATIVE AND MEMBER OF THE BERKELEY STUDENT

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COMMUNITY AS WELL AS SIKH AND PALESTINIAN. I'M HERE TODAY TO CALL UPON THE BERKELEY CITY COUNCIL TO VOTE YES ON THE PEACE AND JUSTICE ARMS EMBARGO, TO TAKE THE FIRST STEP AND BECOME THE FIRST CITY IN OUR NATION TO PASS AN ARMS EMBARGO AGAINST THE GENOCIDAL ISRAELI REGIME, NOT PRESENT WATERED DOWN RESOLUTIONS LIKE THOSE OF MAYOR ISHII OR TAPLIN OR CAST CROCODILE TEARS LIKE YOU CARE ABOUT THE PALESTINIANS INSTEAD OF WHERE YOUR LOYALTIES REALLY LIE, THE PEOPLE LINING YOUR POCKETS. AS A MEMBER OF THE SIKH COMMUNITY, I KNOW GENOCIDE. I KNOW WHAT IT'S LIKE TO HAVE A STATE POLITICIZE YOUR EXISTENCE, RIGHT TO SELF-DETERMINATION, PRACTICE YOUR RELIGION, SPEAK YOUR LANGUAGES AND RIGHT TO LIFE. IN JUNE AND NOVEMBER 1984, THE INDIAN STATE PARTICIPATED IN ORGANIZED VIOLENCE AGAINST THE SIKH COMMUNITY FOR TRYING TO EXERCISE THEIR RIGHT TO LIVE IN THEIR OWN STATE. FROM USING TANKS TO BOMB, THE GOLDEN TEMPLE, THE HOLIEST SITE OF SIKH RELIGION, WOMEN WERE RAPED AND MEN LIT ON FIRE ALIVE. AND NOW THESE ATROCITIES HAVE TRAVELED ACROSS THE WORLD FROM THE PUNJAB TO THE LAND OF PALESTINE. I STAND HERE URGING THE BERKELEY CITY COUNCIL TO FIND THEIR HUMANITY, TO STAND AGAINST THE WAR CRIMES AND HUMAN RIGHTS VIOLATIONS COMMITTED BY THE ISRAELI STATE TO STAND AGAINST 76 YEARS OF OPPRESSION AND APARTHEID AND STAND AGAINST THE ELIMINATION AND STARVATION OF 231,000 CIVILIANS ALMOST TWICE THE POPULATION OF THE CITY OF BERKELEY. [SPEAKING

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NATIVE LANGUAGE]

>> MAYOR ISHII: SO THE PERSON IN GRAY ISN'T SURPRISED, YOU KNOW CEDED YOUR MINUTE TO SOMEONE EARLIER, TO SOMEONE ELSE. UNLESS HAVE SOMEONE TO CEDE THEIR MINUTE. DOESN'T GET TIME UNLESS SOMEONE ELSE GIVES HIM A MINUTE. PLEASE ALLOW THE SPEAKER TO SPEAK. THANK YOU.

>> MY NAME IS KATE LAUER. I WILL TRY TO BE BRIEF, THIS WAR AND HORRORS ARE KNOWN BY EVERYONE HERE, WE ALL WANT A CEASE FIRE AND RELEASE OF THE HOSTAGES, WE DON'T AGREE HOW TO MAKE A CLEAR STATEMENT. IT'S NOT SIMPLE. I WANT TO TALK ABOUT THE HATRED HERE IN BERKELEY. THE HATRED OF ISRAELIS, THE HATRED OF PEOPLE WHO BELIEVE IN THE EXISTENCE OF ISRAEL. I HAVE H & HEARD TONIGHT PEOPLE OPENLY STATE COMFORTABLY, THERE ARE TOO MANY ZIONISTS HERE. THEY ARE MAGGOTS, THEY ARE MAGGOTS. WHAT COMES NEXT? WILL WE BE PUSHED OUT? WILL IT HAPPEN? HOW? THESE ARE REAL QUESTIONS FOR ME AND MY FAMILY. I'M VERY GLAD, I HAVE TREMENDOUS RELIEF WE DON'T HAVE OPEN CARRY HERE.

>> MAYOR ISHII: STOP, FOLKS, PLEASE. I'M GIVING HER MORE SECONDS.

>> PLEASE PASS THIS RESOLUTION. [APPLAUSE]

>> MAYOR ISHII: COUNCILMEMBER DAVILA, DOES SOMEONE HAVE TIME? THIS PERSON IS GIVING YOU TIME TO SPEAK. COUNCILMEMBER DAVILA, FORMER COUNCILMEMBER, FORMER COUNCILMEMBER, THIS PERSON HAS

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GIVEN HIM A MINUTE AND HE IS GOING TO BE ABLE TO SPEAK. AND NOW TWO MINUTES, ANOTHER MINUTE FROM THIS PERSON SITTING BEHIND YOU. COUNCILMEMBER? COUNCILMEMBER? COUNCILMEMBER? YOU NEED TO STOP. YOU ARE BEING VERY RUDE AND YOU ARE NOT ALLOWING US TO FINISH HERE. GO AHEAD.

>> [OFF MIC]

>> MAYOR ISHII: SO THERE IS -- ALL RIGHT. SO FOR OUR PERSON, THERE'S TWO MINUTES. GO AHEAD.

>> ABOUT A WEEK AGO I ATTENDED A TALK BY TWO WOMEN, A PALESTINIAN WOMAN AND ISRAELI WOMAN. THEY ARE PART OF AN ORGANIZATION CALLED THE BEREAVED FAMILY CIRCLE. THEY WERE SITTING IN SAN FRANCISCO TALKING IN A TALK MODERATED BY A PALESTINIAN AND AN ISRAELI FROM SAN FRANCISCO. THEY WERE TALKING ABOUT HOW THEY FIND THEIR HUMANITY IN ORDER TO BRING PEACE AND UNDERSTANDING TO THE LAND OF ISRAEL AND PALESTINE. TOMORROW, THERE'S GOING TO BE THE LARGEST MEMORIAL CEREMONY IN ISRAEL AND AROUND THE WORLD BY AN ORGANIZATION CAED THE BEREAVED FAMILY AND COMBATANTS FOR PEACE. PALESTINIANS AND ISRAELIS COMMEMORATING TOGETHER THEIR DEAD AND THEIR SUFFERING FROM THIS DECADES-LONG WAR. PEOPLE IN ISRAEL ARE TRYING, ARE FIGHTING WITH THEIR LIVES TO FIND UNDERSTANDING AND CO-EXISTENCE TOGETHER. YET, PEOPLE HERE IN THIS ROOM ARE WEAPONIZING THE PALESTINIAN GRIEF AND PAIN TO PROMOTE HATRED. YOU ARE NOT HELPING --

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>> MAYOR ISHII: PLEASE STOP. I WILL GIVE HIM MORE TIME BECAUSE YOU ARE SPEAKING OVER HIM. GO AHEAD.

>> PEOPLE IN THIS ROOM AND AROUND THIS COUNTRY HAVE BEEN WEAPONIZING THE PALESTINIAN PAIN AND SUFFERING AND ISRAELI PAIN AND SUFFERING IN ORDER TO PROMOTE DIVISION AND HATE. WHY DOES THE PEACE AND JUSTICE RESOLUTION WE ARE A CITY OF PEACE AFTER ALL, AREN'T WE? PEACE, DIGNITY, SELF-DETERMINATION TO ISRAELI AND PALESTINIANS. WOULD SAY THAT SENTENCE, JUST THAT SENTENCE AND YOU WOULD SLEEP WELL FOR THE REST OF YOUR LIFE. BECAUSE THAT'S WHAT ALL MORAL PEOPLE SHOULD BE SEEKING. THANK YOU.

>> [OFF MIC]

>> MAYOR ISHII: PLEASE. FOLKS? [APPLAUSE] GO AHEAD.

>> HI, MY NAME IS LADAWN, I LIVE IN DISTRICT 2. I KNOW NO MATTER HOW YOU VOTE TONIGHT YOU WILL UPSET SOME PEOPLE; I REALLY ENCOURAGE YOU TO VOTE YOUR CONSCIENCE. I DON'T NEED TO TELL YOU ABOUT THE HORRORS OF WHAT PEOPLE ARE EXPERIENCING IN GAZA. THIS IS NOT A CONFLICT BETWEEN TWO EQUAL SIDES AND WE AS AMERICANS ARE NOT MERE BY STANDERS. OUR TAX DOLLARS HAVE FOR DECADES BEEN SUPPORTING THE OPPRESSION. TODAY WHOLESALE DESTRUCTION OF GAZA AND ELIMINATION OF ITS PEOPLE. THE HORRIFIC ATTACK BY HAMAS ON OCTOBER 7TH 2023 WAS A GIFT TO NETANYAHU AND ISRAELI RIGHT WHO HAVE LONG WANTED A RIGHT TO ANNEX GAZA. THERE ARE BANNERS THAT SAY THE WINNING PICTURE IS GAZA WITH ZERO PEOPLE. HOW MANY MORE

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PALESTINIANS NEED TO DIE BEFORE THE CITY COUNCIL TAKES A STAND AGAINST GENOCIDE? I'M NOT ASKING YOU TO TAKE A PRO-PALESTINIAN VOTE, I'M ASKING YOU TO VOTE FOR THE RIGHTS OF ALL PEOPLE.

>> MAYOR ISHII: I'M SORRY, YOUR TIME IS UP, THANK YOU. [APPLAUSE] IF YOU HAVE ALREADY SPOKEN, COULD YOU PLEASE SIT DOWN FOR THE OTHER FOLKS, NOT YOU. I KNOW NOT YOU. JUST TO KEEP TRACK OF WHO IS THERE. THANK YOU.

>> I'M A DISTRICT 5 RESIDENT, PARENT OF THREE B.U.S.D. STUDENTS. MY CONNECTION TO ISRAEL IS PERSONAL AND CORE PART OF MY IDENTITY. I'M HERE TO URGE AND PLEAD WITH YOU TO REJECT ANY RESOLUTION ON THE CONFLICT WITH ISRAEL AND HAMAS, IT'S ENTIRELY OUTSIDE OF YOUR PURVIEW. VOTE FOR TERRY TAPLIN'S ALTERNATE RESOLUTION THAT FOCUSES ON UNITING BERKELEY RESIDENTS AROUND CHERISHED ASPIRATIONS. ENOUGH. THOUGHTFUL DEBATE ABOUT REAL LOCAL ISSUES BUT SINCE OCTOBER 2023 I HAVE WATCHED THIS CHAMBER TRANSFORM INTO SOMETHING ELSE. OUTLET FOR ANTI-SEMITIC DISGUISED AS POLITICAL DEBATE ABOUT THE HAMAS WAR. IT'S UNACCEPTABLE. ON MY WAY IN I WAS VERBALLY ASSAULTED BY SOMEONE, WHILE WAITING OUTSIDE MAHTA WAS PHYSICALLY ASSAULTED BY SOMEONE. WHAT GOOD IS THIS RESOLUTION EVEN BRINGING? MEANWHILE PRO-PALESTINE ACTIVISTS --

>> MAYOR ISHII: SORRY, YOUR TIME IS UP. THANK YOU. I'M SORRY, THANK YOU. FOLKS, I'M KEEPING TIME. GO AHEAD.

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>> HELLO.

>> MAYOR ISHII: HAS NOT SPOKEN.

>> THE RULING POWER IN GAZA MADE THE CHOICE TO FUNNEL BILLIONS OF DOLLARS TO TUNNEL -- ROCKETS AND THEN TRIED TO COORDINATE AN UNPRECEDENTED TERRORIST ASSAULT TOGETHER WITH HEZBOLLAH AND IRANIAN REVOLUTIONARY GUARD. UNFORTUNATELY, BUT VERY PREDICTABLY THAT LED TO A HORRIFIC TRAGEDY, FIRST AND FOREMOST FOR THE PALESTINIAN PEOPLE. THE PAIN THAT PEOPLE IN THIS ROOM ARE EXPRESSING IS ABSOLUTELY REAL. UNFORTUNATELY, THAT PAIN IS PART OF HAMAS'S WAR STRATEGY. IN FACT, IT IS THE ONLY REMAINING PART OF HAMAS'S WAR STRATEGY TO GET PEOPLE WHO ARE WELL-MEANING TO COME SPEAK OUT FOR AN ARMS EMBARGO AGAINST THE STATE OF ISRAEL. I URGE THE CITY COUNCIL TO STAY ABOVE THAT FRAY, FOCUS ON ATTEMPTING TO UNITE US, MAKING THE CLEAR MORAL POSITION FOR PEACE, FOR DIGNITY, FOR HUMAN RIGHTS FOR ALL. SUPPORT TERRY TAPLIN'S RESOLUTION, THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. FOLKS.

>> HELLO, I HAVE ONE MINUTE FROM ZANAB IN PERSON.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU, GO AHEAD.

>> GOOD EVENING, MAYOR AND COUNCILMEMBERS, I'M AVERY, A RESIDENT OF BERKELEY, JEWISH VOICE FOR PEACE, BERKELEY TENANT'S UNIT AND DEMOCRATIC RENEWAL CLUB. AT THE BEGINNING OF LAST SUMMER, AROUND THIS TIME LAST YEAR, I SPENT 20 DAYS IN PASSOVER AT BERKELEY

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GAZA SOLIDARITY ENCAMPMENT WHERE I AND THOUSANDS OF OTHER STUDENTS CALLED FOR AN ARMS EMBARGO AND END TO THE GENOCIDE IN PALESTINE. TODAY WE ARE CALLING ON YOU TO JOIN US IN CALLING FOR THE SAME. WHILE I UNDERSTAND MAYOR ISHII'S DESIRE TO REACH COMPROMISE, WE MUST TONIGHT PASS A RESOLUTION THAT CLEARLY CALLS FOR AN ARMS EMBARGO AND FOR THE FREE SPEECH RIGHTS OF ACTIVISTS. SO I ASK FOR YOU, PLEASE PASS EITHER THE PEACE AND JUSTICE RESOLUTION OR A SUFFICIENTLY-AMENDED VERSION OF MAYOR ISHII'S RESOLUTION THAT CALLS FOR AN ARMS EMBARGO AND CONDEMNS THE TRUMP ADMINISTRATION'S ATTACKS ON OUR RIGHTS AS ACTIVISTS. THANK YOU FOR YOUR TIME AND ATTENTION. GOODBYE.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. FOLKS, COULD YOU PLEASE LOWER YOUR SIGNS SO THAT FOLKS CAN SEE BEHIND YOU. CAN YOU JUST HOLD YOUR SIGN LOWER, PLEASE? THE PERSON WHO IS STANDING IN THE CORNER, LOWER YOUR SIGN PLEASE, SO EVERYONE CAN SEE. GO AHEAD.

>> HI. MY NAME IS NAT, I'M A LESBIAN PALESTINIAN [AUDIO CUTTING OUT] I'VE BEEN WATCHING MY PEOPLE IN PALESTINE GET MURDERED EVERY DAY SINCE THE LATEST CHAPTER IN THE GENOCIDE AND NOW WE ARE WATCHING PEOPLE HERE ON STOLEN LAND GET REPRESSED AND KIDNAPPED. I GO TO WORK EVERY DAY AND WONDER WHOSE DEATH MY LABOR IS FUNDING. I'M URGING YOU TO PLEASE PASS THIS ARMS EMBARGO RESOLUTION AND REJECT ANY WATERED-DOWN VERSIONS OF IT. BERKELEY RESIDENTS APTED THE MAJORITY OF AMERICANS DO NOT WANT

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OUR TAX DOLLARS TO FUND WAR CRIMES AND GENOCIDE. OUR TAX DOLLARS SHOULD UP LIFT OUR COMMUNITIES. IF YOU VOTE AGAINST AN ARMS EMBARGO YOU ARE TELLING YOUR CONSTITUENTS YOU WOULD RATHER SEE OUR TAX DOLLARS CONTINUE TO FUND A GENOCIDE AND MILITARY OCCUPATION RATHER THAN SUPPORT OUR COMMUNITY AND PROVIDE HOUSING, FOOD, ACCESS TO HEALTH CARE. I'M URGING YOU TO INVEST OUR TAX DOLLARS IN OUR COMMUNITIES NOT GENOCIDE. THANK YOU.

[APPLAUSE]

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. [AUDIO CUTTING OUT]

>> MAYOR ISHII: GO AHEAD.

>> SORRY?

>> MAYOR ISHII: PLEASE GO AHEAD.

>> THANK YOU, MAYOR ISHII. I'M THE DAUGHTER OF A SURVIVOR OF A HOLOCAUST THAT ISN'T EVEN RECOGNIZED AS A HOLOCAUST. THE JAPANESE OCCUPATION OF CHINA IN WORLD WAR II. MY MOTHER IS THE FIRST ASIAN AMERICAN CITY COUNCIL MEMBER IN BERKELEY, YANG LI, I KNOW BOTH WOULD HAVE THEIR HEARTS WITH GAZA RIGHT NOW. I HEARD A LOT FROM MY MOTHER ABOUT THIS, I NEEDED TO SAY THAT. WE DO HAVE THE LOVELY STAFF FROM "BERKELEYSIDE" AND THE DAILY CAL. I WANTED TO TALK TO YOU BRIEFLY ABOUT HOW IRRESPONSIBLE THESE PUBLICATIONS HAVE BEEN IN COVERING THE INFLUENCE OF NOT APAC BUT THE JEWISH COMMUNITY RELATIONS COUNCIL WHOSE DIRECTOR, JONATHAN MINZER YOU HEARD FROM TODAY, I HAVE BEEN COVERING THIS AT MARINA

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CONFIDENTIAL SUB STACK. IF I COULD GET ONE --

>> MAYOR ISHII: CAN I PAUSE REAL QUICK. CAN I SEE THAT PERSON? HAVE YOU SPOKEN BEFORE? I DON'T RECOGNIZE YOU.

>> THANK YOU. I HAVE RUN AN ENORMOUS NUMBER OF C.P.R.A.'S AND TRACKED A LOT OF WHAT THE J.C.R.C. HAS BEEN DOING BEHIND THE SCENES, HELPING TO FUNNEL STATE EDUCATIONAL DOLLARS THROUGH THE MARIN COUNTY OFFICE OF EDUCATION INTO A PRIVATE N.P.O., THE JEWISH FAMILY AND CHILDREN SERVICES FOR A BOGUS GENOCIDE AND HOLOCAUST EDUCATION PROGRAM THAT DOESN'T MENTION PALESTINIANS. IT'S AKIN TO WHAT WE SAW WITH THE J.C.R.C. HIJACKING THE DEMOCRATIC DELEGATE POLLING THAT TOOK PLACE IN FEBRUARY IN BERKELEY. THE ONLY NON-SECULAR POLLING SITE IN ALL OF NORTHERN CALIFORNIA WAS CHOSEN FOR THE MOST PRO-CEASE-FIRE, PRO PALESTINIAN IN PERHAPS ALL OF CALIFORNIA. I'VE BEEN COVERING THAT AT MARIN COUNTY CONFIDENTIAL SUB STACK.COM. I GOT AN INTERESTING COMMENT FROM YOUR COMMISSIONER TODAY I WILL BE INCLUDING THAT.

>> MAYOR ISHII: SORRY. THANK YOU. [APPLAUSE]

>> MAYOR ISHII: NEXT SPEAKER. THANK YOU.

>> [AUDIO CUTTING OUT]

>> I WAS ATTACKED WHILE WAITING TO ENTER TODAY.

>> MAYOR ISHII: SORRY, IS THERE ANYONE WHO IS WILLING TO GIVE HER AN EXTRA MINUTE? NO, CAROL -- [AUDIO CUTTING OUT]

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>> MAYOR ISHII: SORRY, I HAVEN'T BEEN DOING THAT CONSISTENTLY, SO I DON'T WANT TO CHANGE THAT NOW. GO AHEAD.

>> I'M STILL SHAKING FROM BEING SHOVED AND RIDICULED STANDING OUTSIDE AND SEEING THE MAN NEXT TO ME WHO CAME TO MY AID PUNCHED AND THROTTLED AND HEARING THE GROUP OF ANTI-ISRAEL, ANTI-JEWISH PEOPLE YELLING OH HE STARTED IT, HE STARTED IT. [AUDIO CUTTING OUT] FULL RECONCILIATION, BRINGING THE COMMUNITY TOGETHER. IS THIS HOW YOU HOPED THIS MEETING WOULD GO, MAYOR? [AUDIO CUTTING OUT] PULLED HER OUT OF HER WHEELCHAIR, TIED HER WITH WIRE.

>> MAYOR ISHII: YOU HAVE TO SPEAK IN THE MIC, WE CAN'T HEAR YOU. I WILL GIVE YOU FOUR EXTRA SECONDS. GO AHEAD.

>> THEY KILLED ALL THESE PEOPLE.

>> MAYOR ISHII: I'M SORRY, YOUR TIME IS UP.

>> I ASK YOU --

>> MAYOR ISHII: I'M SORRY, YOUR TIME IS UP. THANK YOU FOR YOUR COMMENT. HEY, COME ON.

>> CAN I HAVE AN EXTRA MINUTE?

>> MAYOR ISHII: NO, I'M SO SORRY. [AUDIO CUTTING OUT] PLEASE FOLKS, MAKE SURE YOU SPEAK INTO THE MIC SO WE CAN HEAR YOU CLEARLY.

>> [INDISCERNIBLE] IS GIVING ME ONE MINUTE. TWO ACTUALLY.

>> MAYOR ISHII: WHO IS THE SECOND PERSON? GO AHEAD.

>> THANK YOU FOR YOUR TIME. I'M JOLINE -- LONG TIME BERKELEY

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RESIDENT AND PEDIATRICIAN IN BERKELEY. A FEW YEARS AGO I WAS VERY PROUD OF THE CITY OF BERKELEY. ACTUALLY, TERRY TAPLIN AND IGOR TREGUB HELPED ME PASS A RESOLUTION FOR HUMAN RIGHTS AND POLITICAL RELEASE OF POLITICAL PRISONERS. SO IT'S JUST COMPLETELY SURPRISING TO ME THAT I HEAR TERRY TAPLIN AND IGOR TREGUB ARE NOT IN SUPPORT OF THE PEACE AND JUSTICE RESOLUTION, WHICH IS ASKING FOR A STOP TO GENOCIDE AND THE ARMS EMBARGO. IT DOESN'T MAKE SENSE TO ME TO HAVE PEOPLE OPPOSE KILLING KIDS. I MEAN, IT JUST DOESN'T MAKE SENSE TO ME. I CANNOT BELIEVE THAT THE CITY OF BERKELEY DID NOT PASS THIS RESOLUTION MORE THAN A YEAR AGO WHEN IT FIRST STARTED. GENOCIDE SHOULD BE CONDEMNED BY ALL OF US. IT SHOULD BE CONDEMNED BY THE CITY OF BERKELEY WHICH STANDS UP FOR JUSTICE. IT SHOULD BE CONDEMNED BY THE HOLOCAUST SURVIVORS. I'M JUST SURPRISED THAT IT'S NOT. AT THIS JUSTICE AND PEACE MEETING, I SENT YOU GUYS, THE CITY COUNCIL A VIDEO OF THE DOCTORS WHO ARE IN GAZA AND WHAT THEY ARE SEEING. AND I DON'T THINK ANYONE OF YOU HAS SEEN THAT. IF YOU HAD, THERE WOULDN'T BE A CONVERSATION HERE. SO PLEASE TAKE A LOOK AT THAT VIDEO. AND PLEASE REPRESENT THE CITY OF BERKELEY. BERKELEY WANTS AN ARMS EMBARGO; WE WANT TO STOP THE GENOCIDE. AND INSTEAD THAT MONEY CAN GO TO MY PATIENTS WHO ARE GOING TO LOSE INSURANCE BECAUSE MEDI-CAL IS GOING TO BE CUT. THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. [APPLAUSE] COUNCILMEMBERS ON ZOOM, I

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WANT TO MAKE SURE YOU CAN HEAR PEOPLE. CAN YOU GIVE ME A THUMB'S UP. BECAUSE WE HAVE SOME BAD MIC PROBLEMS SOMETIMES. I JUST WANT TO MAKE SURE. GO AHEAD.

>> MY NAME IS BELLA BERANI, RESIDENT OF BERKELEY. IN 20 50 5, ISRAEL GAVE GAZA BACK TO THE PALESTINIAN PEOPLE.

>> MAYOR ISHII: CAN YOU SPEAK IN THE MIC?

>> HAMAS, A TERRORIST ORGANIZATION THREW THE PALESTINIANS OFF THE ROOF AND HAVE BEEN OPPRESSING PALESTINIANS OF SINCE. THEY PUT WEAPONS IN THEIR HOSPITALS, IN THEIR SCHOOLS AND BUILT TUNNELS IN ORDER TO SHOOT INTO ISRAEL. OCTOBER 7 WAS A MAJOR EVASION BY HAMAS INTO ISRAEL. ISRAEL NEEDS TO DEFEND ITSELF. IT'S THE ONLY COUNTRY IN THE WORLD WE HAVE. PLEASE PASS COUNCILMEMBER TAPLIN'S RESOLUTION. THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK FOR YOUR COMMENTS. GO AHEAD. NEXT PERSON. I'M SORRY, IF YOU HAVE MADE YOUR COMMENT, CAN YOU PLEASE SIT BACK DOWN? THIS WOMAN, NOT YOU, NOT YOU, I'M SORRY, THE OTHER WOMAN.

>> I'M TRYING TO FIND A SEAT.

>> MAYOR ISHII: YEAH, YEAH, I KNOW. GO AHEAD.

>> GOOD EVENING, CITY COUNCIL MEMBERS, MY NAME IS [INDISCERNIBLE], AMERICAN BORN AND RAISED IN BERKELEY. I'M HERE TO ASK TO PASS THE RESOLUTION WITHOUT ANY WATT HE HAD DOWN RESOLUTIONS, HOW MANY BABIES, MOTHERS, FATHERS HAVE TO BE KILLED

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IN PLAIN SIDE BEFORE THIS COUNCIL TAKES ACTION. HOW MANY MERE JOURNALISTS HAVE TO BE DEAD AND MUR TERED IN PLAIN SIGHT. I'M SURPRISED MAYOR ARREGUIN, OUR LAST MAYOR DID NOTHING, TOOK NO ACTION, AND DIDN'T STAND FOR THE PEOPLE OF PALESTINE AND PEOPLE OF GAZA. I'M URGING THIS CITY COUNCIL TO THINK ABOUT THE DECISION WISELY, MAKE A SMART DECISION AND VOTE ON THEIR CONSCIENCE. THANK YOU. [APPLAUSE]

>> GOOD EVENING, MEMBERS OF THE BERKELEY CITY COUNCIL. I STAND BEFORE YOU TODAY NOT JUST AS A CONCERNED RESIDENT BUT AS A PALESTINIAN WITNESSING THE ONGOING GENOCIDE AGAINST MY PEOPLE. BERKELEY HAS ALWAYS BEEN A CITY THAT STANDS FOR CIVIL RIGHTS, JUSTICE AND HUMAN DIGNITY, FOR THE FREE SPEECH MOVEMENT AND RACIAL EQUALITY, NOW WE MUST EXTEND THAT LEGACY TO STOP THE U.S. FUNDING OF A FOREIGN MILITARY COMMITTING WAR CRIMES AND VIOLATING INTERNATIONAL LAW. OUR TAX DOLLARS SHOULD BE INVESTED IN OUR COMMUNITIES, ON HOUSING, EDUCATION, JOBS, AND HEALTH CARE. NOT IN PERPETUATING VIOLENCE AND OPPRESSION ABROAD. AS A PALESTINIAN, I SEE FIRSTHAND THE DEVASTATION CAUSED BY U.S.'S FINANCIAL AND MILITARY SUPPORT. THIS IS NOT JUST A DISTANT CONFLICT. IT IS A CRISIS IMPACTING REAL LIVES, INCLUDING MY OWN. IT'S CRUCIAL THAT YOU LISTEN TO YOUR CONSTITUENTS TONIGHT. NOT YOUR DONORS.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU FOR YOUR COMMENTS. [APPLAUSE]

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>> HELLO, TO SPEAK FURTHER ON WHAT THE COMRADE BEFORE ME SAID, WE ARE IN AN UNPRECEDENTED MODE OF FASCISM IN THIS KUHN TRY COUNTRY AND ONLY ONE SIDE IS ON THE SIDE OF FASCISM, ONLY ONE SIDE HAS THE SUPPORT OF THE CURRENT FASCIST IN CHIEF. WHICH SIDE IS THE SO-CALLED LIBERAL AND PROGRESSIVE CITY OF BERKELEY GOING TO STAND ON? THE SIDE OF DEMOCRACY, FREEDOM, ANTI FASCISM THE HUMAN SPIRIT OR SIDE THE FASCISM, THE SIDE OF OPPRESSION, THE SIDE OF SILENCING. TERRY TAPLIN, YOU, AND I USED TO DO DRUGS TOGETHER, NOW YOU ARE ON THE SIDE OF NAZIS, YOU MOTHER FUCKER. [APPLAUSE]

>> MAYOR ISHII: IS THAT THE -- CAN I JUST -- MARK? CAN I CHECK IN ON THE TIME? FOLKS, PLEASE. CALM DOWN, PLEASE. SETTLE DOWN. I'M SORRY, WHAT WERE YOU --

>> CITY CLERK: ONE HOUR 19 MINUTES.

>> MAYOR ISHII: SO THAT MEANS THERE'S FOUR MINUTES LEFT OF IN-PERSON PUBLIC COMMENT. I'M SORRY, I KNOW YOU ALL THINK I'M JOKING BUT I CAN'T SEE BEHIND THE SIGNS. ARE THERE PEOPLE BACK THERE. IS THERE ANYONE HERE ALONG THE WALL GIVING PUBLIC COMMENT STILL? I'M SORRY FOR BEING SHORT, IT'S NOT MY FAULT. GO AHEAD. ALL RIGHT WILL BE OUR LAST IN-PERSON PUBLIC COMMENT. YOU ARE GOING TO CEDE HIM A MINUTE. OKAY, THANK YOU, SHEILA IS CEDING YOU A MINUTE. YOU HAVE TWO. OH, A THIRD HERE.

>> CITY CLERK: IT WILL PICK IT UP, DON'T WORRY.

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>> MAYOR ISHII: GO AHEAD. YOU SHOULD HAVE THREE MINUTES ON THE TIME. GO AHEAD, PLEASE.

>> CITY CLERK: PEOPLE ON ZOOM.

>> TONIGHT THE PEOPLE OF BERKELEY COME OUT NOT ASKING FOR THE IMPOSSIBLE. BUT DEMANDING THE BARE MINIMUM. THAT OUR TAX DOLLARS DO NOT FUND ATROCITIES. WE HAVE SEEN FIRSTHAND WHAT A CEASE FIRE MEANS WITHOUT AN ARMS EMBARGO. IT MEANS MORE GENOCIDE. FUNDED IN OUR NAME, FOR MONEY THAT COULD BE SPENT HERE AT HOME. YOU ARE ELECTED TO REPRESENT US, NOT TO DELAY. NOT TO EQUIVOCATE, NOT TO BEAT AROUND THE BUSH. BUT TO ACT WITH COURAGE WHEN IT MATTERS MOST. NO JUST CAUSE IN THIS COUNTRY OR ANYWHERE HAS EVER BEEN WON WITHOUT OPPOSITION. YOU HAVE TO MAKE THE DECISION ON WHICH SIDE YOU WANT TO BE ON. HISTORY IS WATCHING. THE PEOPLE OF BERKELEY ARE WATCHING. YOU WANTED TO TAKE A STAND FOR THE PEOPLE OF BERKELEY. THE PEOPLE HAVE SPOKEN! [CHEERS AND APPLAUSE] I YIELD MY REMAINING TIME.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. WE HAVE TIME ONLINE FOR THE SPEAKERS OB LINE. WE ARE GOING TO BE HEARING FROM PEOPLE ONLINE NOW.

>> CITY CLERK: OKAY. MOVING TO PEOPLE ON ZOOM. AND WE HAVE ONE HOUR AND 16 MINUTES FOR PEOPLE ON ZOOM. THE FIRST SPEAKER IS BERKELEY.

>> I WILL QUOTE A FAMILY MEMBER FROM PALESTINIAN WHO LOST FAMILY MEMBERS IN THIS WAR. THERE'S A LOT MORE TO BEING PRO-PALESTINIAN

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THAN SIMPLY ANTI ISRAEL. TO PLACE MAXIMUM PRESSURE ON MEDIA AND POLITICAL PRESSURE ON THEIR RESPECTIVE GOVERNMENTS TO GET ISRAEL TO STOP. IT IS INDISPUTABLE THAT HAMAS SPILLED PALESTINIAN BLOOD AS NECESSARY TO SHOW US, AS VICTIMS TO SHOW THEM THE BLOODIED PALESTINIAN BODIES AND FORCE THE INTERNATIONAL COMMUNITY TO REACT AGAINST ISRAEL. HOPING THAT PEOPLE WOULD FORGET THE DISASTER THAT WAS HAMAS'S RISE TO POLITICAL POWER AND CONTROL OF GAZANS FOR THE PAST 18 YEARS. I URGE THE COUNCIL TO HONOR AHMED.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU, YOUR TIME IS UP.

>> AND PASS TERRY TAPLIN'S RESOLUTION.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU.

>> CITY CLERK: NEXT IS CHRISTINA HARB.

>> I'M A PALESTINIAN AMERICAN AND I'M A TEACHER IN THE CITY OF BERKELEY, I URGE YOU TO ADOPT THE PEACE AND JUSTICE COMMISSION CALLING FOR AN END TO AID TO ISRAEL. THIS IS THE ONLY RESOLUTION THAT HAS POPULAR SUPPORT. THE ONLY RESOLUTION THAT WAS BOURNE FROM COMMUNITY ORGANIZING, IT'S THE ONLY ONE THAT CENTERS THE VOICES OF THE MOST IMPACTED PEOPLE RIGHT NOW, WHICH WHO ARE THE PALESTINIANS, WHO ARE BEING MASSACRED AND ANNIHILATED BY ISRAELI SOLDIERS AND AMERICAN WEAPONS. IT'S THE ONLY RESOLUTION THAT REFLECTS THE VALUES OF THE CITY AND HONORS THE LEGACY LEFT TO US BY GUS NEWPORT AND STUDENTS OF APARTHEID AND FREE SPEECH MOVEMENTS. EVERY ONE OF US AS AMERICAN TAXPAYERS ARE FUNDING THE

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BULLETS THAT ENDED THE LIVES OF CHILDREN AND ENTIRE FAMILIES. IT'S OUR MORAL IMPERATIVE TO DO THIS. THE OTHER RESOLUTIONS ARE UNACCEPTABLE. THEY ASK US TO --

>> CITY CLERK: THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU FOR YOUR COMMENTS.

>> CITY CLERK: NEXT IS DAVID SHERE.

>> HI. I WANT TO ENCOURAGE YOU TO REJECT THE COMMISSION'S RESOLUTION TONIGHT. I VEHEMENTLY OPPOSE ISRAEL'S ACTIONS IN GAZA WHICH ARE NOT JUSTIFIED AND CANNOT BE JUSTIFIED BY THE EVENTS OF OCTOBER 7TH. IT’S A STRONGLY WORDED LETTER; PEOPLE'S FEELS DON'T CHANGE THAT. CITY COUNCIL MEMBERS DON'T HAVE A CIVIL OR MORAL OBLIGATION TO PASS IT. IT DOESN'T MOVE A SINGLE DOLLAR OR STOP A SINGLE BULLET. LET'S REMEMBER THAT SOUTH AFRICAN DIVESTMENT WAS NOT A STRONGLY WORDED LETTER, IT WAS DIVESTMENT, A MATERIAL POLICY. SOUTH AFRICAN DIVESTMENT WAS ALSO DECIDED AT THE BALLOT BOX, NOT CITY COUNCIL. THIS HAS NOTHING TO DO WITH GAZA AND EVERYTHING TO DO WITH BERKELEY AND WE NEED TO THINK OF WHAT KIND OF POLITICS WE WOULD BE ENDORSING BY MOVING FORWARD WITH THE RESOLUTION. THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. I WANT, REAL QUICK, I JUST WANT TO REMIND FOLKS TO ADDRESS THE COUNCIL AS A BODY AND NOT AS ANY MEMBER IN PARTICULAR. GO AHEAD.

>> CITY CLERK: NEXT IS ESTHER BRASS-CHORIN.

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>> I'M A LONG-TIME BERKELEY RESIDENT AND URGE THE CITY COUNCIL TO VOTE NO ON BIASED PEACE AND JUSTICE COMMISSION WHICH BARELY PASSED THE COMMISSION ITSELF. IT ERASES THAT HAMAS'S ATROCITIES BROKE AN EXISTING CEASE FIRE, KILLED FAMILIES, BABIES, RAPED AND MUTILATED WOMEN. TO HUNT AND KILL ISRAEL YEAS AND JEWS AND MARTYR ITS PEOPLE AND DOESN'T TAKE INTO ACCOUNT THE EMBARGO MEANS MORE DEAD PEOPLE AND MAIMED CHILDREN, BOTH ISRAELI AND PALESTINIAN. I URGE YOU TO PASS COUNCILMEMBER TAPLIN'S RESOLUTION AND THANK COUNCILMEMBER TAPLIN FOR GIVING BERKELEY A MODEL FOR COMPASSION COMING TOGETHER. PLEASE FOCUS ON THE MANY ISSUES FACING BERKELEY, PARTICULARLY NOW WHEN POLITICAL THREATS LOOM AND DIMINISHING FUNDS TRANSLATE INTO HARDER TIMES FOR OUR CITY. ESPECIALLY FOR THE MOST IN NEED.

>> MAYOR ISHII: YOUR TIME IS UP. [AUDIO CUTTING OUT]

>> CITY CLERK: FEROZE SIDHWA AND SHIRLEY KIRSTEN. FIRST IS FEROZE.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU.

>> HI, I BELIEVE I HAD TIME CEDED TO ME BY JAIME, SHERIDAN, AND YOON.

>> MAYOR ISHII: CAN YOU PUT JAIME ON SO WE CAN CONFIRM THAT, PLEASE. SORRY. AND YOON.

>> HI, YES, THIS IS JAIME, I'M CONFIRMING.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU.

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>> CITY CLERK: AND YOON?

>> I CONFIRM.

>> MAYOR ISHII: OKAY, THANK YOU.

>> CITY

>> AND SHERIDAN WAS THE THIRD PERSON.

>> CITY CLERK: IS THAT THE FIRST PERSON OR LAST NAME?

>> MAYOR ISHII: SHERIDAN EGGERS. IS IT SHERIDAN EGGERS?

>> CITY CLERK: OKAY.

>> YES, I'M HERE.

>> CITY CLERK: ARE YOU CEDING YOUR TIME TO FEROZE?

>> YES.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU.

>> CITY CLERK: FEROZE HAS FOUR MINUTES.

>> THANK YOU, I'M A TRAUMA AND GENERAL SURGEON AT SAN JOAQUIN GENERAL HOSPITAL AND NORTHERN CALIFORNIA V.A. SYSTEM. I SERVE THE POOREST IN OUR STATE AND OUR VETERANS. I WORKED THREE TIMES IN UKRAINE SINCE THE RUSSIAN INVASION AND TWICE IN GAZA SINCE THE 2023 HAMAS ATTACKS ON ISRAEL. THE LAST WAS MARCH TO APRIL THIS YEAR. I PERSONALLY HAVE NO ETHNIC OR RELIGIOUS CONNECTION TO THE MIDDLE EAST. I'VE BEEN ON INTERNATIONAL TELEVISION, WRITTEN FOR THE "NEW YORK TIMES" AND POLITICO. I HAVE SOME EXPERIENCE WITH THESE MATTERS. I WANT TO TELL YOU ABOUT A CHILD I TOOK CARE OF THE LAST TIME I WAS IN GAZA. MARCH 18TH, THE

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MAJOR BOMBING CAMPAIGN RESUMED. THAT DAY I PERFORMED ABOUT NINE LIFE SAVING OPERATIONS, THE LAST OF WHICH WAS A 16-YEAR-OLD BOY NAMED IBRAHIM. HAD INJURIES IN HIS COLON AND RECTUM FROM SHRAPNEL AFTER HIS TENT WAS BOMBED. HE WAS DOING WELL, BECAUSE HE WAS GOING TO BE DISCHARGED AFTER DINNER AROUND 8:30 AT NIGHT. I WENT TO CHANGE HIS DRESSINGS AND EXPLAIN TO HIS FAMILY ONE LAST TIME HOW TO CARE FOR HIM. AS I LEFT OUR LIVING QUARTERS I PASSED BY THE I.C.U. AND WAS PULLED INTO IT BY A PALESTINIAN CRITICAL CARE DOCTOR WHO ASKED FOR MY HELP FOR A PATIENT TRANSFERRED FROM ANOTHER HOSPITAL AND WAS BLEEDING. HIS NAME WAS MOHAMMED, HE NEEDED TO GO TO THE OPERATING ROOM OR HE WAS GOING TO BLEED TO DEATH. I HEADED DOWN TO CHANGE IBRAHIM'S DRESSING, AS I EXISTED THE I.C.U., IBRAHIM'S ROOM ON THE SECOND FLOOR EXPLODED. ISRAEL BOMBED THE HOSPITAL TO KILL AN INJURED MAN THEY SAID WAS HAMAS. I CAN ATTEST THIS MAN WAS SIMPLY A WOUNDED PATIENT RECEIVING TREATMENT AT THE HOSPITAL, NOTHING ELSE. WHETHER HE WAS IN HAMAS OR NOT WAS IRRELEVANT. THE HOSPITAL WENT INTO LOCKDOWN FOR ABOUT AN HOUR, I WENT TO THE EMERGENCY ROOM TO SEE IF ANYONE NEEDED AN OPERATION. AS I WAS LOOKING THROUGH THE E.R., THREE YOUNG MEN RAN DOWN THE HOSPITAL STAIRS WITH A BODY WRAPPED IN A SHEET. I DIRECTED THEM TO THE TRAUMA BAY, WHEN I PULLED THE SHEET OFF I RECOGNIZED THAT THE PATIENT THEY BROUGHT DOWN WAS IBRAHIM, THE 16-YEAR-OLD BOY. HE HAD BEEN E VISCERATED,

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HIS ABDOMINAL CONTENTS SPILLING OUT AND QUITE DEAD. THIS WAS A TRIPLE CRIME. ILLEGAL TO KILL A WOUNDED MAN, UNDER THE CODES OF ISRAELI AND ARMED FORCES. IT WAS ILLEGAL TO LAUNCH MUNITIONS AT A HOSPITAL, AND A CHILD BECAUSE HE WAS DISTANTLY RELATED TO SOMEONE THEY DIDN'T LIKE. A FEW DAYS LATER I WAS ALMOST KILLED BY AN AMERICAN ALLY BY AMERICAN-SUPPLIED WEAPONS. I COULD TELL YOU STORIES LIKE THIS FOR HOURS BUT OF COURSE THERE'S NO TIME. INSTEAD LET ME MAKE A SIMPLE OBSERVATION. THERE'S NO ISRAELI ATTACK ON GAZA; THERE'S A U.S. ISRAELI ATTACK AON GAZA. NOT A QUESTION OF INFLUENCING AMERICAN FOREIGN POLICY, IT'S STOPPING OUR PARTICIPATION IN MONUMENTAL CRIMES. WE HAVE THE POWER TO END THE ABSOLUTE MADNESS VISITED ON GAZA SOCIETY, HALF OF WHICH IS CHILDREN AND BERKELEY CITY COUNCIL CAN MAKE A MAJOR DIFFERENCE IN THAT REGARD. I FULLY SUPPORT THE P.J.C. RESOLUTION AND I HOPE YOU VOTE IN FAVOR OF IT. THANK YOU. [APPLAUSE]

>> MAYOR ISHII: SO --

>> CITY CLERK: SO THE NEXT THREE SPEAKERS ARE SHIRLEY KIRSTEN.

>> MAYOR ISHII: SORRY, I COULDN'T HEAR YOU, WHAT WERE YOU SAYING?

>> CITY CLERK: NEXT THREE ARE SHIRLEY KIRSTEN, WHITNEY SPARKS AND DANIELLE LEARD.

>> MAYOR ISHII: FOLKS, IF YOU ARE ON ZOOM AND HAVE PEOPLE CEDING TIME, PLEASE BE READY TO GIVE US THEIR NAMES SO WE CAN LOOK FOR

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THEM QUICKLY. THANK YOU.

>> CITY CLERK: OKAY, AND --

>> CAN YOU HEAR ME? CAN YOU HEAR ME? CAN YOU HEAR ME? CAN YOU HEAR ME? I CAN'T HEAR MYSELF. I'M GOING TO CONTINUE. THE MAYOR CAME TO MY DOOR DURING HER MAYORAL CAMPAIGN AS I WAS ABOUT TO TEACH A PIANO STUDENT. I HAD ONE MINUTE TO ASK A QUESTION; WILL YOU SUPPORT A CEASE FIRE RESOLUTION. SHE SAID YES, BUT I REGRET NOT ASKING IF SHE WOULD SUPPORT AN ARMS EMBARGO. WE MUST NOT SHRINK FROM ISRAEL'S STARVATION AND DEPRIVATION OF WATER AND HUMANITARIAN AID. AS A JEW AND MEMBER OF JEWISH VOICES FOR PEACE AND HUMAN BEING, WE MUST NEVER LOOK AGAIN. NEVER AGAIN IS NOW. DO THE RIGHT THING, PASS THE PEACE AND JUSTICE RESOLUTION THAT WILL INCLUDE AN ARMS EMBARGO ON ISRAEL. THANK YOU. [AUDIO CUTTING OUT]

>> HELLO, CAN YOU HEAR ME? THE POWERFUL AND COURAGEOUS IN-PERSON SPEAKERS, THE PALESTINIAN COMMUNITY MEMBERS, ALLEGED -- [AUDIO CUTTING OUT] PEDIATRICIANS, PASTORS, POETS, AND DIRECTOR OF -- MAYORS FROM RICHMOND TRYING TO -- INTO FOLLOWING THEIR COURAGEOUS EXAMPLE AND LISTEN TO YOUR CONSTITUENTS. AND FORMALLY BERKELEY CITY COUNCIL CHERYL DAVILA, AS WELL. THANK YOU, LUNAPARRA FOR ASKING FOR MORE TIME BECAUSE YOU SHOULD LISTEN TO ALL YOUR CONSTITUENTS WE ARE SAYING RESOUNDINGLY, OVERWHELMINGLY TO PASS THE PEACE AND JUSTICE COMMISSION'S ARMS EMBARGO

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RESOLUTION WITH NONE OF YOUR FOOLERY ABOUT THAT. ARMS EMBARGO RESOLUTION AS WAS PRESENTED TONIGHT, THE FIRST ONE THAT WAS PRESENTED. THE ONLY THING ECHOING ANOTHER SPEAKER, THE ONLY THING THAT IS RELEVANT TONIGHT -- [NO AUDIO]

>> CITY CLERK: DANIELLE, YOU SHOULD BE ABLE TO UNMUTE.

>> THANK YOU. MY NAME IS DANIELLE, I'M A UFT U.C. BERKELEY STUDENT AND CONSTITUENT OF DISTRICT 7. I WAS SO EXCITED TO COME TO BERKELEY BECAUSE OF ITS RICH HISTORY BUT I'VE BEEN DISAPPOINTED IN CITY COUNCIL NOT VOTING IN THE CEASE-FIRE RESOLUTION IN 2023. I HOPE TONIGHT IS A DIFFERENT OPPORTUNITY, I'M ALSO A DISABLED AND QUEER MEMBER OF THE COMMUNITY. MAYOR ISHII, I KNOW THE DISABILITY COMMUNITY AND DISABILITY JUSTICE IS VERY IMPORTANT TO YOU, I SAW YOU DO YOUR DEBATE FOR THE CENTER FOR INDEPENDENT LIVING. I THOUGHT IT WAS KIND OF YOU TO SHOW UP TO THE C.I.L. SPACE. TO DO THINGS IN THIS MEETING LIKE HAVE PEOPLE TAKE A MASK, BREATHING IN AND OUT AND MAKING SURE PEOPLE ABLE TO SIT BUT NOT ACKNOWLEDGE THE PALESTINIAN PEOPLE IS LARGELY HYPOCRITICAL. I HOPE THAT GETS AMENDED TONIGHT AND I HOPE YOU PASS THE PEACE AND JUSTICE COMMISSION'S RESOLUTION FOR AN ARMS EMBARGO. [APPLAUSE]

>> CITY CLERK: THE NEXT THREE SPEAKERS ARE LISA, SID, AND DANIEL. LISA, YOU SHOULD BE ABLE TO UNMUTE.

>> HELLO, MY NAME IS LISA. SEVEN YEARS AGO I WENT TO THE GHETTO

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IN THE CZECH REPUBLIC AND FELT THE GHOST OF THE HOLOCAUSTS AND I CRIED. I SWORE I WOULD NEVER BE COMPLICIT; I WOULD TAKE A STAND AGAINST SUCH ATROCITIES. IT LED ME TO TRAVEL TO THE WEST BANK TWICE, WHERE I SAW WITH MY OWN EYES WHAT IS MEANT BY APARTHEID OCCUPYING A STATE COMMITTING GENOCIDE, ETHNIC CLEANSING AND WAR CRIMES. I SAW THIS WITH MY OWN EYES. TO THE ISRAELI APOLOGISTS AND ZIONISTS, IT'S NOT ABOUT YOU BEING JEWISH, THAT YOU ARE STILL CLAIMING THIS TIRED LINE IS ANTI-SEMITIC. IT'S ABOUT YOU SUPPORTING A STATE COMMITTING GENOCIDE. I QUOTE MOSHI FAGAN RUNNING TO BE ISRAEL'S NEXT PRIME MINISTER. ISRAEL'S RULE SHOULD BE RESTORED TO THE PLACE OF OUR COUNTRY. THIS IS ISRAEL. MAYOR AND CITY COUNCIL NOT PASSING THE ORIGINAL ARMS EMBARGO, PUBLIC DECLARATION OF COMPLICITY.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU FOR YOUR COMMENT. THANK YOU.

>> CITY CLERK: SID?

>> YES. I'M HERE TO SUPPORT THE RESOLUTION THIS EVENING AND YOU WOULD LIKE TO CEDE MY TIME TO BRIDGETTE.

>> CITY CLERK: BRIDGETTE?

>> MAYOR ISHII: DO YOU SEE HER, MARK?

>> CITY CLERK: YES. I GUESS WE CAN REMEMBER THAT WHEN BRIDGETTE COMES UP. NEXT SPEAKER WOULD BE DANIEL.

>> MAYOR ISHII: SO JUST SO WE ARE CLEAR. SID GAVE TIME TO BRIDGETTE BUT BRIDGETTE IS LATER IN THE LINE. SO GO AHEAD.

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DANIEL.

>> YEAH, CAN YOU HEAR ME?

>> MAYOR ISHII: YES.

>> I'M A BERKELEY RESIDENT. WE HEARD ABOUT THE MORAL IMPORTANCE OF THE MOMENT. INDEED IT'S IMPORTANT TO STAND UP TO SPEAKERS ARMED WITH HALF TRUTHS TAKING TALKING POINTS FROM A KNOWN TERRORIST ORGANIZATION AS FACT. THE COURAGE TO PUT PERFORMANCE ASIDE AND FAO CUSS ON THE WORK THAT MATTERS HERE. BERKELEY HAS NO SHORTAGE OF ISSUES THAT NEED ATTENTION. WE ELECTED YOU TO WORK ON THOSE, WHAT YOU CAN DO SOMETHING ABOUT. THE ONGOING 2450E TER OF RESOLUTIONS, GOVERNMENTS DICTATING FOREIGN POLICY TAX DOLLARS. WHAT GENOCIDE ACTUALLY MEANS, NONE OF THIS HELPS OUR COMMUNITY HEAL OR MOVES US FORWARD. HAVE THE COURAGE TO DEMAND BETTER TO BERKELEY AND SAY NO TO ALL FOREIGN-POLICY RESOLUTIONS. THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. [APPLAUSE]

>> CITY CLERK: OKAY, NEXT THREE SPEAKERS ARE NAOMI, CC AND RACHEL W. NAOMI SHOULD BE ABLE TO UNMUTE.

>> CAN YOU HEAR ME?

>> CITY CLERK: YES.

>> MAYOR ISHII: YES.

>> OKAY, NAOMI, SUPPORT THE P.J.C. HAITI BROKE ITS CHAINS, AMERICA REFUSED RECOGNITION FOR 60 YEARS. CUBA BROKE ITS CHAINS;

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AMERICA SUFFOCATED THEM FOR HALF A CENTURY. ALGERIA, LIBYA, CONGO, KOREA, VIETNAM, CHAIN AFTER CHAIN, COUNTLESS BOMBS, COUPS, AND SANCTIONS FOR DISHONORING THE DEMOCRATIC WILL OF BOARD ROOMS NOW THEY WANT TO -- PLOWING THROUGH THEIR CAGE WITH OCCUPATION'S BULLDOZERS AND FEEL ANGER NOT WONDER, FEAR NOT RADICAL HOPE. ISRAEL AND THE U.S. WOULD LIKE US TO FORGET THESE IMAGES, WHAT BRINGS US HERE TODAY AND ZIONISTS AND GROWING BELLIGERENCE IS NOT ONLY HORRORS OF WHAT THEY INFLICTED ON GAZA BUT KNOWLEDGE THE VIOLENCE IS A REPRISAL WHICH IS ABOVE ALL A PUNISHMENT, DARING TO STAND UP AND LOOK YOUR OPPRESSOR IN THE EYE.

>> MAYOR ISHII: SORRY, THANK YOU, NAOMI FOR YOUR COMMENT. [APPLAUSE] SO THERE ARE 63 FOLKS LEFT ON HERE, KEEPING IN MIND THAT EXTRA MINUTE FOR BRIDGETTE. BUT WE ARE GOING TO TAKE A TEN-MINUTE BREAK.

>> CITY CLERK: NOW?

>> MAYOR ISHII: YEAH, I THINK WE NEED TO.

>> CITY CLERK: WE HAVE 57 MINUTES LEFT ON --

>> MAYOR ISHII: IT'S ABOUT 9:45 RIGHT NOW. YOU SAID WE HAD 57 MINUTES LEFT?

>> CITY CLERK: YES.

>> MAYOR ISHII: JUST BE AWARE FOR FOLKS ON ZOOM, WE MAY NOT MAKE IT THROUGH ALL OF YOU. [RECORDING STOPPED] [BREAK] [BREAK]

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[RECORDING IN PROGRESS] [NO AUDIO] [NO AUDIO]

>> CAN YOU HEAR ME? WE CAN'T HEAR YOU ONLINE, BY THE WAY, BUT I'M JUST GOING TO TALK *. I'M RA*ICHEL, A JEWISH BERKELEY RESIDENT IN DISTRICT 1, I SUPPORT THE P.J.C.'S TRUE COMMUNITY RESOLUTION AND I THANK THEM FOR THEIR MORAL CLARITY. I MAINLY WANT TO SPEAK TO THE SUGGESTION THAT GLOBAL ISSUES ARE BEYOND THE CITY COUNCIL'S PURVIEW. SOME EXAMPLES, BERKELEY DECLARES ITSELF A SANCTUARY CITY. BERKELEY WAS THE SPEARHEAD OF DIVESTMENT MOVEMENTS AGAINST APARTHEID IN SOUTH AFRICA AND FOSSIL FUELS ACROSS THE NATION AND WORLD. MEANINGFUL CHANGE COMES FROM INDIVIDUALS AND COMMUNITIES SUCH AS OURS, MODELING CLEAR MORAL LEADERSHIP. A RESOLUTION ISN'T EVERYTHING, IT DOESN'T END THE WAR BUT IT DOES MATTER. AS OUR NATIONAL LEADERSHIP DOUBLES DOWN ON MILITARIZATION AND CENSORSHIP, BERKELEY CITY COUNCIL MUST STAND FIRM IN MUTUAL RESPECT AND EQUITY.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. SORRY, YOUR TIME IS UP. [APPLAUSE]

>> CITY CLERK: OKAY. JUST TO DO A -- [AUDIO CUTTING OUT]

>> MAYOR ISHII: OR COUNCILMEMBER -- [NO AUDIO]

>> CITY CLERK: OKAY, LET ME CHECK IN THE CONTROL ROOM.

>> MAYOR ISHII: COUNCILMEMBER TREGUB, CAN YOU HEAR US?

>> I. TREGUB: I CAN NOW.

>> MAYOR ISHII: OKAY. MARK, WE LOST MARK. MARK, COUNCILMEMBER

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TREGUB SAYS HE CAN HEAR US NOW. MARK IS WALKING BACK TO HIS SEAT. THANK YOU. OKAY, START. START. SO WE HAVE HALAH'S -- [AUDIO CUTTING OUT] [NO AUDIO]

>> HELLO? HELLO, I CAN'T HEAR. MY NAME IS BRENNAN ROBINS, I CAN'T HEAR ANYTHING BEING SAID FROM THE CHAMBER RIGHT NOW.

>> CITY CLERK: OKAY, WE WILL KEEP TRYING. [AUDIO CUTTING OUT]

>> HELLO, GOOD EVENING, MY NAME IS BRENNAN ROBBINS, I STILL CAN'T HEAR ANYTHING FROM THE CHAMBER, I'M ASSUMING I HAVE BEEN GIVEN THE OPPORTUNITY TO SPEAK SO I WILL SAY MY PIECE. I'M A RESIDENT OF DISTRICT 5. I'M SPEAKING TO STRONGLY SUPPORT THE RESOLUTION FROM THE PEACE AND JUSTICE COMMISSION. I UNDERSTAND THE IDEA BEHIND TRYING TO FIND A COMPROMISE, I THINK THE TESTIMONY, AT LEAST WHAT I CAN HEAR, MAKES IT CLEAR IT'S NOT WORKING WE WON'T BE ABLE TO GET A COMPROMISE IN THIS. IN THIS SITUATION, WHERE IS JUSTICE, WHERE IS THE CITY OF BERKELEY, THE PEOPLE OF BERKELEY AND I THINK THAT POINTS TO THE TWO ITEMS THAT ARE IN THE CEASE FIRE AND ARMS EMBARGO. WITH THAT IN MIND I CERTAINLY HOPE I'M BEING HEARD IN A LITERAL AND FIGURATIVE SENSE, PLEASE PASS THE PEACE AND JUSTICE COMMISSION RESOLUTION, IT'S AN ISSUE THAT AFFECTS MANY RESIDENTS OF BERKELEY.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. [AUDIO CUTTING OUT]

>> MAYOR ISHII: FOLKS THAT ARE ONLINE ARE TELLING US -- [AUDIO CUTTING OUT] WE ARE AWARE OF THAT. WE CAN HEAR YOU, OH FRICK,

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SORRY. SO THE FOLKS ONLINE, CAN YOU PLEASE JUST READ THE NEXT THREE. BUT THEY CAN'T HEAR US, CAN WE SEND IS TO THEM IN THE CHAT?

>> CITY CLERK: THERE'S NO CHAT.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THERE'S NO CHAT.

>> CITY CLERK: THERE IS NO CHAT.

>> MAYOR ISHII: DO YOU WANT TO BRING THE NEXT PERSON IN? THEY CAN HEAR US NOW. IT KEEPS CUTTING IN AND OUT. LET'S KEEP GOING UNTIL WE GET THE OWL SET UP. WE HAVE LAROIA-NGUYEN.

>> HELLO, MY NAME IS NOAH, CAN YOU HEAR ME?

>> MAYOR ISHII: YES.

>> I'M A TEACHER AT BERKELEY HIGH SCHOOL AND I WOULD URGE YOU TO PLEASE PASS THE PEACE AND JUSTICE COMMISSION'S RESOLUTION FOREARMS EMBARGO FOR MY STUDENTS WHOSE FAMILIES HAVE BEEN KILLED IN PALESTINE. WE CANNOT BE IGNORANT OF THE GENOCIDE IN GAZA AND PASSING THIS RESOLUTION SAYS WE ARE NOT IGNORANT OF THE GENOCIDE IN GAZA. ARMS EMBARGO NOW. [APPLAUSE]

>> CITY CLERK: THANK. NEXT IS MIMI MAIN.

>> HI. MY NAME IS MIMI MAIN, CALLING IN FROM DISTRICT 8. AND I JUST WANT TO SAY THAT ON SUCH A GRAVE BEYOND GOING BEYOND THE PALE EVIL TAKES PLACE LIKE WHAT WE ARE SEEING OVER THE LAST MANY, MANY MONTHS IN GAZA, WE ARE EACH ABSOLUTELY RESPONSIBLE TO DO EVERYTHING IN OUR POW HE TO STOP IT. AND TONIGHT, HERE, NOW,

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THAT MEANS FIGHTING FOR AND VOTING FOR THE PEACE AND JUSTICE'S COMMISSION'S RESOLUTION. I PREVAIL UPON EACH OF YOU, INCLUDING MY COUNCILMEMBER TO VOTE FROM YOUR SENSE OF HUMANITY AND VOTE IN SUPPORT OF THE RESOLUTION. THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR ISHII: FOLLOWED BY FOSSIL FREE CALIFORNIA AND ARLETTE. BE ON DECK.

>> CAN YOU HEAR ME?

>> MAYOR ISHII: YES.

>> MANY PEOPLE WHO SPOKE TONIGHT ASKED YOU TO NOT BE COME COMPLICIT AND GIVING MONEY TO ISRAEL. AMERICAN TAX DOLLARS ARE ALSO GIVEN TO FOREIGN AID AND IN THIS CASE, $1 BILLION DOLLARS OF FOREIGN AID WAS GIVEN TO GAZA. MOST OF THAT MONEY WENT TO BUILD TUNNELS. THE HAMAS OPERATIVES WILL NOT ALLOW THEIR OWN CITIZENS TO USE THOSE TUNNELS FOR REFUGE. INSTEAD, ONLY HAMAS MAY USE THOSE TUNNELS THAT COST US AND OTHER FOREIGN COUNTRIES A BILLION DOLLARS. AS OPPOSED TO UKRAINE, WHEN RUSSIA BOMBS UKRAINE, UKRAINIANS CAN RUN INTO THE SUBWAY AND TAKE REFUGE, BUT HAMAS WILL NOT LET THEIR OWN CITIZENS HAVE ANY PROTECTION IN THOSE BILLION-DOLLAR TUNNELS. [APPLAUSE]

>> CITY CLERK: NEXT IS FOSSIL-FREE CALIFORNIA.

>> HELLO, MY NAME IS QUINN IDE, AND I WANT TO URGE YOU TO SUPPORT THE ARMS EMBARGO AND THE PEACE AND JUSTICE COMMISSION RESOLUTION AND REALLY AFFIRM A LOT OF COMMENTS MANY FOLKS SAID.

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I CEDE MY TIME.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU.

>> HELLO, MY NAME IS ARLETTE, I'M A MEMBER OF SEIU 1021 AND I WORK IN DEVELOPMENTAL DISABILITIES. THIS COMMENT GOES TO MOHAMMED WHO WAS MAULED BY THE ISRAELI ANTI-ZIONIST ENTITY AND HE HAD DOWN SYNDROME, MAY HE REST IN PEACE. I SUPPORT BUT IT NEEDS TO CALL FOR AN ARMS EMBARGO. IT IS SURVIVING AND THRIVING DUE TO AMERICAN FINANCIAL SUPPORT. ARMS EMBARGO IS THE ONLY WAY TO TRULY SUPPORT PALESTINIAN LIBERATION AND LIFE. FOR THE MEMBERS OF CITY COUNCIL, SPECIFICALLY COUNCILMEMBER TAPLIN, IF YOU CANNOT VOTE TO STOP GENOCIDE OR FOR AN ARMS EMBARGO TRUST IN SEIU 1021 MEMBERS WILL ENSURE YOU ARE NOT REELECTED NEXT TERM, WE WILL NOT ENDORSE YOU, ELECT YOU IF YOU CONTINUE TO BE A TRAITOR TO PEACE AND HUMANITY.

>> MAYOR ISHII: EXCUSE ME -- MARK? YOUR TIME IS UP. AND JUST A REMINDER, FOLKS, TO ADDRESS THE COUNCIL AS A BODY AND NOT ANY MEMBER IN PARTICULAR.

>> CITY CLERK: WE HAVE NEXT THREE SPEAKERS ARE NIDA, KELSI AND AYSHA. NIDA, YOU SHOULD BE ABLE TO UNMUTE.

>> ALI IS CEDING THEIR TIME, CAN YOU RESTART MY TIME, PLEASE?

>> CITY CLERK: ALLIE, CAN YOU CONFIRM?

>> YES.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU, NIDA YOU HAVE TWO MINUTES.

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>> I'M LIVING ON STOLEN OHLONE LANDS, I'M STILL WITNESSING THE NUMBNESS AND CONDITION OF THE AMERICAN PUBLIC ESPECIALLY THOSE OF YOU IN POW HE. THIS APARTHEID IS SLAUGHTERING INNOCENT PEOPLE WITH THE MONEY YOU SENT TO THEM. INSTEAD OF SUPPORTING YOUR OWN FAMILIES AND COMMUNITIES RIGHT HERE, TELLING US THAT THERE ISN'T ENOUGH MONEY FOR PROGRAMMING AND SERVICES, TALKING ABOUT DEFICITS THAT BERKELEY HAS. HOWEVER, BERKELEY IS LITERALLY SENDING OUR TAX DOLLARS TO FOREIGN OCCUPATION, TO GENOCIDE. FAMILIES AND COMMUNITIES THERE. ACCORDING TO THE U.S.P.C.R., BERKELEY SENDS $7,616,000 TO THIS WAR CRIMINAL OF A STATE EVERY YEAR, WHEN THERE IS OVER A $14 MILLION DEFICIT IN BERKELEY RIGHT NOW. WHY DO YOU SEND THAT MONEY TO KILL BABIES? AT A TIME WHEN OUR MOST MARGINALIZED COMMUNITIES FIND THEMSELVES FACED WITH THE GOVERNMENT THAT'S KEEN ON STRIPPING AWAY ALL OF OUR CIVIL RIGHTS, BERKELEY NEEDS AND SHOULD JOIN IN THE CALL TO UPHOLD HUMAN RIGHTS FOR ALL. FOR ALL. WE IMPLORE YOU, BERKELEY CITY ELECTED OFFICIALS, PLEASE, PASS THE PEACE AND JUSTICE COMMISSION RESOLUTION. DIVEST $7.6 MILLION FROM GENOCIDE AND IMPLEMENT THE BOYCOTT DIVESTMENT SANCTION GUIDELINES IN YOUR INVESTMENT POLICY IMMEDIATELY. PLEASE DON'T CONTINUE THE NUMBNESS AND CONDITIONING OF YOUR PREDECESSORS. CALL FOR A CEASE FIRE AND ARMS EMBARGO NOW. WE WILL ALL SEE, NOT TODAY, NOT TOMORROW, BUT FROM THE RIVER TO THE SEA, PALESTINE WILL BE LIBERATED. PALESTINE, ONE

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DAY, WILL BE FREE. THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR ISHII: YOUR TIME IS UP. [APPLAUSE]

>> CITY CLERK: NEXT IS KELSI.

>> HI. MY NAME IS KELSI PERTTULA, JEWISH RESIDENT OF DISTRICT 8, PROFESSOR OF PUBLIC HEALTH AND MOTHER OF FOUR. I URGE TO REJECT THE P.J.C. RESOLUTION AND EITHER REFRAIN FROM CONFLICT RESOLUTIONS ALL TOGETHER OR SUPPORT COUNCILMEMBER TAPLIN'S ALTERNATIVE. THE P.J.C. RESOLUTION WOULD DRAG BERKELEY INTO THIS CONFLICT THAT WE CANNOT SOLVE, DEEPEN PAINFUL DIVISIONS WE HAVE SEEN TONIGHT OVER AND OVER AND EXPOSE OUR CITY TO HATEFUL AND ANTI-SEMITIC RHETORIC WHICH AS TO NIGHT'S MEETING HAS KNOWN IS ALREADY RISING. I CRIED ON OCTOBER 7TH NOT ONLY FOR ISRAELI AND PALESTINIANS, ISRAELIS KILLED THAT DAY BUT PALESTINIANS I KNEW WOULD BE KILLED IN THE ENSUING CONFLICT. ANTI ZIONISM IS NOT ALWAYS ANTI-SEMITISM BUT WE OFTEN SEE WHEN IT CROSSES OVER TO THAT. I URGE YOU TO REJECT THIS RESOLUTION THAT OVERSIMPLIFIES THIS CONFLICT. PLEASE CHOOSE UNITY OVER DIVISION.

>> MAYOR ISHII: SORRY, YOUR TIME IS UP. SORRY, I DIDN'T HEAR THE BEEP. DID OUR BEEP GO OFF?

>> CITY CLERK: NEXT IS, WE HAVE AYSHA FOLLOWED BY ANYA KUSHWAHA, THEN VICKI, THEN LINDA WULF. AYSHA?

>> MY NAME IS AYSHA, I'M A COMMUNITY MEMBER AND I URGE THE CITY COUNCIL TO DO THE BARE MINIMUM AND VOTE YES TO THE ARMS EMBARGO.

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TO THOSE WHO SAY KEEP THIS OUT OF CITY COUNCIL, THE ISSUES ARE LINKED. IF YOU REALLY FEEL THAT WAY YOU SHOULD WANT OUR TAX DOLLARS TO BE HERE AND NOT FUND ANOTHER COUNTRY'S GENOCIDE. -- SIMPLY TRYING TO EXIST ON THE LANDS THEY HAVE LIVED ON FOR GENERATIONS. MY COLLEAGUE WAS MURDERED WITH A DIRECT SHOT TO HER HEAD STANDING IN AN OLIVE GROVE AFTER OBSERVING PRAYING, SHE WAS STANDING FAR AWAY FROM THE PROTEST AND WAS DELIBERATELY SHOT IN THE HEAD. U.S. CITIZEN AND MURDERED BY AN ISRAELI ARMED WITH A U.S.-GUN. ARMS EMBARGO NOW.

>> CITY CLERK: ANYA?

>> HI, CAN YOU HEAR ME?

>> CITY CLERK: YES.

>> PERFECT, AWESOME. AFTER HEARING OTHER COMMENTERS, I ASK HOW IS THIS ISSUE OF NO IMPORTANCE TO LOCAL POLITICS I HEAR PEOPLE SAYING WE HAVE A $14 DEFICIT. I'M A SOCIAL WORK STUDENT AT U.C. BERKELEY AND WORKED IN COUNTY HOMELESS SERVICES FOR THE PAST YEAR. AS YOU SEE BERKELEY DISPLACED PEOPLE'S PARK AND BORDER WALL, ISRAEL SIMILARLY DISPLACED ENCLOSED AND MASSACRED PALESTINIANS FOR DECADES. PROVIDE AFFORDABLE HOUSING, HEALTH CARE, EDUCATION, INFRASTRUCTURAL IMPROVEMENTS, SUSTAINABILITY AND PREVENT THESE SENSELESS DEATHS, ON OUR STREETS IN BERKELEY AND GAZA. THE WORLD IS WATCHING AND YOU HAVE THE OPPORTUNITY TO MAKE HISTORY HERE TONIGHT. PASS THE ORIGINAL RESOLUTION FOR THE

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PEACE AND JUSTICE COMMISSION FOR THE ARMS EMBARGO NOW. THANK FOR YOUR TIME. [APPLAUSE]

>> CITY CLERK: VICKI. YOU SHOULD BE ABLE TO UNMUTE.

>> OKAY, CAN YOU HEAR ME?

>> CITY CLERK: YES.

>> OKAY. I'M VICKI, I'VE BEEN LIVING IN DISTRICT ONE FOR THE PAST 40 YEARS, BOTH OF MY PARENTS WERE HOLOCAUST SURVIVORS. PLEASE VOTE FOR TERRY TAPLIN'S ALTERNATE RESOLUTION. REAFFIRMING BERKELEY'S COMMITMENT TO PEACE AT HOME AND ABROAD. WHILE AMERICAN DOLLARS ARE SUPPORTING CONFLICTS AROUND THE WORLD, THE PEACE AND JUSTICE COMMISSION CHOSE TO FOCUS ON ISRAEL WITH NO DEMAND TO RELEASE THE HOSTAGES. -- IT'S THIS COUNCIL'S RESPONSIBILITY TO PROMOTE PEACE IN BERKELEY AND PROTECT ALL BERKELEY CITIZENS FROM HARM AND NOT SUCCUMB TO MOB RULE. COUNCILMEMBER TAPLIN'S RESOLUTION ACKNOWLEDGES THE PAIN FELT ON ALL SIDES AND SPEAKS TO AND PROMOTES VALUES THAT REFLECT OUR BEST SELVES AND FOCUSES ON UNITING BERKELEY RESIDENTS AROUND OUR SHARED ASPIRATIONS FOR PEACE. I URGE THIS COUNCIL TO VOTE FOR TERRY TAPLIN'S ALTERNATE RESOLUTION. THANK YOU VERY MUCH.

>> CITY CLERK: LINDA?

>> MAYOR ISHII: FOLLOWED BY BRET AND RACHEL FACTOR.

>> CITY CLERK: LINDA, SHOULD BE ABLE TO UP MUTE.

>> CAN YOU HEAR ME?

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>> CITY CLERK: YES.

>> I'M A BERKELEY RESIDENT FOR THE LAST 34 YEARS IN BRENT BLACKABY'S DISTRICT. I WOULD LOVE A CEASE FIRE. ISRAEL WOULD GET THE LAST TWO DOZEN, 250 HOSTAGES BACK, STARVED, ELECTROCUTED WITH CAR BATTERIES ACCORDING TO ONE WHO WAS ABLE TO RETURN. THERE WAS A CEASE-FIRE ON OCTOBER 7, 2023, UNTIL HAMAS ATTACKED. THE GROWING NUMBER OF BRAVE GAZANS DEMAND HAMAS GET OUT OF GAZA KNOW THE TRUTH. THE CROWD CALLING FOR THE P.J.C. RESOLUTION HERE TONIGHT MAKES UP A VERY SMALL PROPORTION OF THE BERKELEY COMMUNITY. THEY ARE NOT REPRESENTATIVE OF THE SIT CITIZENS OF BERKELEY. THEY ARE FULL OF HATE AND RANCOR, PLEASE VOTE FOR TERRY TAPLIN'S RESOLUTION WHICH AIMS TO BRING ALL OF BERKELEY TOGETHER.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU FOR YOUR COMMENT. [AUDIO CUTTING OUT] LAST CALL FOR BRETT. ALL RIGHT; WE WILL MAYBE GO BACK. LET'S TRY RACHEL.

>> MAYOR ISHII: RACHEL FACTOR, NATHAN MIZELL AND REBECCA MIRVISH.

>> MAYOR ISHII: RACHEL, CAN YOU HEAR US?

>> YES.

>> MAYOR ISHII: GO AHEAD.

>> I'M GOING TO CEDE MY TIME TO CELINE, WHO IS ALSO ON ZOOM.

>> CITY CLERK: I SEE SELL LINE.

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>> MAYOR ISHII: RACHEL IS CEDING TIME TO CELINE, BUT BRETT, HOPEFULLY YOU CAN HEAR US THIS TIME.

>> CITY CLERK: CELINE, PLUS ONE. OKAY, BRETT. ARE YOU THERE? YOU SHOULD BE ABLE TO UNMUTE. WAIT, IS THE AUDIO STILL GOING? OKAY. OKAY, NO BRETT.

>> MAYOR ISHII: BRETT? MARK, SO WE HAVE A SENSE, HOW MUCH TIME IS LEFT?

>> CITY CLERK: 37 MINUTES. NATHAN MIZELL.

>> MAYOR ISHII: OKAY, THANK YOU.

>> HELLO, MADAM MAYOR, CAN YOU HEAR ME?

>> MAYOR ISHII: YES, WE CAN HEAR YOU.

>> I'M NATHAN MIZELL, RENT BOARD COMMISSIONER. I THINK IT'S PROFOUNDLY UNFORTUNATE WE ARE AT THIS POINT NOW ALMOST MIDWAY THROUGH 2025 WHERE THIS ISSUE PASSING A CEASE FIRE RESOLUTION AND SAYING WE DON'T WANT OUR TAX DOLLARS GOING TOWARDS FRANKLY SOMETHING THAT BREAKS THE LAW, WHICH SHOULD BE ENOUGH, BUT SOMETHING THAT HAS BEEN SO PROFOUNDLY DESTRUCTIVE. IT'S UNFORTUNATE. MY HOPE IS THE COUNCIL WILL FIND IT TO DO THAT AND SUPPORT THE RESOLUTION IN FRONT OF YOU. I SUSPECT THAT MAY BE DIFFICULT, BUT THAT WOULD BE MY ASK. YOU KNOW THE FACTS. I HOPE YOU WILL DO THE RIGHT THING. THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU.

>> CITY CLERK: OKAY, REBECCA MIRVISH.

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>> GOOD EVENING, MY NAME IS REBECCA MIRVISH, I'M A RESIDENT OF D-4. I WILL ECHO WHAT JEWS AND NON-JEWS HAVE SAID ABOUT ENDING THE CEASE FIRE AND ENDING MILITARY AID TO ISRAEL. WE CELEBRATED A BRILLIANT PIECE OF INFRASTRUCTURE THAT PRIORITIZES SAFETY AND SUSTAINABILITY, INCLUDING 4.1 MILLION FROM THE FEDERAL GOVERNMENT. I WOULD MUCH RATHER RESOURCES GO TOWARD INFRASTRUCTURE HERE THAN DESTROYING INFRASTRUCTURE IN GAZA. PLEASE SUPPORT A CEASE FIRE RESOLUTION.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. ARE WE GOING TO TRY BRETT ONE MORE TIME? BRETT, CARY SANDERS, IMTIAZ.

>> CITY CLERK: BRETT, MAYBE TRY LOGGING OFF AND BACK ON. I WILL LOWER BRETT'S HAND. WE HAVE CARY SANDERS.

>> HI, CAN YOU HEAR ME?

>> MAYOR ISHII: YES.

>> GOOD EVENING, CARY SANDERS, 25-YIER RESIDENT OF DISTRICT 3. WANT TO THANK YOU FOR THIS SPECIAL MEETING TONIGHT. I JOINED WITH THE MANY RESIDENTS HERE TODAY URGING YOU TO VOTE IN SUPPORT OF THE PEACE AND JUSTICE'S RESOLUTION FOR A CEASE FIRE AND ARMS EMBARGO. OUR TAX DOLLARS ARE BEING USED TO FUND A DEVASTATING WAR THAT'S ALREADY KILLED OVER 50,000 PALESTINIANS, WHILE BERKELEY WANTS THE HEART OF THE PEACE AND JUSTICE COMMISSION TO STAY SILENT. IF YOU CARE ABOUT UPHOLDING THE MORAL LEADERSHIP OF CITIES LIKE BERKELEY AND OUR INSTITUTION AGAINST A FASCIST

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PRESIDENT AND SUPPORTERS WHO SEEK TO SILENCE DISSENT YOU MUST VOTE FOR THE PEACE AND JUSTICE RESOLUTION TODAY. THANK YOU. [APPLAUSE]

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU.

>> CITY CLERK: OKAY, WE HAVE IMTIAZ, A PHONE NUMBER ENDING IN 324 AND THEN WE HAVE ELEANOR. IMTIAZ, SHOULD BE ABLE TO UNMUTE.

>> CAN YOU HEAR ME?

>> CITY CLERK: YES.

>> I'VE BEEN A BERKELEY RESIDENT FOR OVER 20 YEARS AND BEFORE THAT A U.C. BERKELEY STUDENT. I'VE HEARD OVER AND OVER AGAIN BERKELEY HISTORY BEING CELEBRATED FOR SUPPORTING CIVIL RIGHTS, FREE SPEECH, ANTI-VIETNAM WAR, DIVESTMENT FROM SOUTH AFRICA. AND YOU KNOW, A LOT OF PEOPLE ARE PROUD OF THAT HISTORY. BUT IF WE DON'T TAKE A PRINCIPLED STAND ON A GENOCIDE THAT IS BEING LIVE STREAMED THAT WE ARE WITNESSING EVERY DAY, IT WILL BE A GREAT SOURCE OF SHAME FOR US. FOR OUR SAKE AND YOUR OWN SAKE, PLEASE VOTE YES ON THE PEACE AND JUSTICE COMMISSION'S RESOLUTION. THAT SUPPORTS AN ARMS EMBARGO TO ISRAEL. DO WE ONLY HAVE A HISTORY OF MORAL COURAGE, CLARITY, ARE WE GOING TO CONTINUE TO STAND UP FOR JUSTICE AND EQUAL HUMAN RIGHTS? I HOPE THAT YOU GUYS WILL.

>> MAYOR ISHII: SORRY, YOUR TIME IS UP. THANK YOU. [APPLAUSE]

>> CITY CLERK: WE HAVE PHONE NUMBER ENDING IN 324. SHOULD BE ABLE TO UNMUTE. PRESS *6 TO UNMUTE. PHONE NUMBER ENDING -- THERE

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YOU GO.

>> MAYOR ISHII: WE CAN HEAR YOU NOW.

>> DEAR BERKELEY CITY COUNCIL, I'M A U.C. BERKELEY ALUMNI, LIVED IN BERKELEY, VOLUNTEERED IN THE SCHOOLS, WENT TO SYNAGOGUES WITH MY FAMILY. I PRAISE THE CITY COUNCIL FOR FOCUSING ON LOCAL ISSUES, NOW YOU CAN TAKE THE HIGH GROUND AND CONTINUE TO DO YOUR JOB. RESOLUTION ON ISRAEL PALESTINE IS A DISTRACTION TO SERVING THE CITY AND WOULD ONLY BRING HATE AND DIVISIVENESS. IT WOULD HURT MANY VALUABLE COMMUNITY MEMBERS INCLUDING JEWS, ISRAELIS, AND MANY OTHERS. JUST AS ARAB AND MUSLIM ARE NOT BAD WORDS, ZIONIST IS NOT A BAD WORD EITHER. BERKELEY CITIZENS SHOULD NOT BE GETTING THE MESSAGE FROM THE COUNCIL THAT IT IS. MAYOR ISHII, YOU ALLOW HATEFUL PEOPLE TO REPEATEDLY INTERRUPT, ASSAULT AND INTIMIDATE THOSE EXPRESSING THEIR FREEDOM OF SPEECH TONIGHT IN YOUR CHAMBERS. TO BE A LEAD HE YOU MUST NOT -- KICK THEM OUT.

>> MAYOR ISHII: YOUR TIME IS UP.

>> CITY CLERK: SO WE HAVE NEXT SPEAKERS ARE ELEANOR, SUMAYA AND SELIM. ELEANOR?

>> I'M CEDING MY TIME TO SELIM WHO ALSO HAS A MINUTE FROM RACHEL.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. SUMAYA IS NEXT.

>> CITY CLERK: SUMAYA.

>> HELLO? CAN YOU HEAR ME?

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>> CITY CLERK: YES.

>> OKAY. HI, MY NAME IS SUMAYA, I'M A COMMUNITY MEMBER OF BERKELEY, I HAVE GIVEN PRAYER TO THE -- OF BERKELEY. IN THE QURAN IT SAYS KILLING ONE PERSON IS LIKE KILLING ALL OF MANKIND. I HOPE THE COUNCIL VOTES FOR THE ARMS EMBARGO. THEY SYSTEMATICALLY RAPE AND MURDER AND STARVE CITIZENS. THERE'S BEEN ARGUMENTS THAT BERKELEY HAS NO BUSINESS IN ISRAEL'S BUSINESS AND WE SHOULD INVEST IN OUR COMMUNITY. OUR CITIZENS SEND $1.7 BILLION. A SPEAKER BEFORE ME CALLED FOR PEACE WHILE HE LITERALLY ATTACKED PEOPLE OUTSIDE THIS VERY MEETING. IT'S TIME TO PRACTICE WHAT YOU PREACH. HOW CAN PALESTINIANS HEAL WHEN THEY ARE CONTINUOUSLY BEING BOMBED AS WE SPEAK.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU FOR YOUR COMMENT. YOUR TIME IS UP. [APPLAUSE]

>> CITY CLERK: SO NOW WE HAVE SELIM WHO HAS THREE MINUTES. SELIM?

>> CAN YOU HEAR ME?

>> MAYOR ISHII: YES.

>> THANK YOU. EVERYTHING WE HAVE WITNESSED TONIGHT IS YET ANOTHER INDICATOR THAT THE CITY OF BERKELEY HAS LOST ITS CAPABILITY TO DISCUSS FOREIGN POLITICS IN A HEALTHY AND CIVIL MANNER. I AM FROM ISTANBUL TURKEY I'M A VICTIM. I HAVE SEEN MEMBERS OF MY COMMUNITY SHOT TO PIECES. CAME TO BERKELEY SIX

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YEARS AGO HOPING TO FIND PEACE. BUT PEOPLE ARMED WITH MISINFORMATION, CALLING OUT FELLOW COMMUNITY MEMBERS, COUNCILMEMBERS FOR HAVING A DIFFERENT OPINION ON A COMPLEX ISSUE. I'M SORRY, FOLKS, THAT'S EXACTLY WHAT FASCISM LOOKS LIKE. SO UNTIL YOU BUILD A DEMOCRATIC FORUM, BERKELEY HAS DIRECT TIES FROM BOTH SIDES, THEY HAVE IMMENSE PAIN AND STRONG OPINIONS, THAT'S FINE. THERE ARE MANY NONPROFITS PEOPLE CAN JOIN TO FIGHT FOR THEIR CAUSE. YET IN THE CITY'S FORUMS, LET'S HEAR FROM THE PALESTINIAN THAT ISRAELI BERKELEY RESIDENTS HOW THEY HAVE BEEN FEELING SINCE OCTOBER 7TH. LET'S HEAR FROM THOSE WHOSE SHOPS WERE VANDALIZED AND KIDS WERE TERRORIZED AND INTIMIDATED AT SCHOOLS AND UNIVERSITIES AND HAVE A DIALOGUE THAT MAYBE BERKELEY CAN CONTINUE TO SHINE AS A BEACON OF PEACE AND FREE SPEECH. I THEREFORE CALL FOR THE CITY COUNCIL TO STAND STRONG, BE BRAVE AND NOT SUPPORT THE HIGHLY DIVISIVE FOREIGN POLICY RESOLUTION. SOMETIMES DEMOCRACY IS ABOUT BEING ABLE TO STAND FOR THE RIGHT BUT UNPOPULAR OPINION. I SUPPORT COUNCILMEMBER TAPLIN'S RESOLUTION. THANK YOU. [APPLAUSE]

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU.

>> CITY CLERK: SO NEXT SPEAKERS ARE LAUREN ARNEST, CONFEDERATED VILLAGES OF LISJAN, BRIDGET AND MS. COBEL. LAUREN?

>> MY NAME IS LAUREN AND I SUPPORT THE PEACE AND JUSTICE RESOLUTION AND ARMS EMBARGO WITH NO CHANGES. SUPPORTING

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RELENTLESS BOMBING ON A PEOPLE WITH LITTLE MEANS TO DEFEND THEMSELVES AND INTENTION ALLEY STAFFING THEM WITH NO PLACE TO GO IS GENOCIDE. I THINK ABOUT HOW THE U.S. AND ISRAEL WERE THE ONLY TWO COUNTRIES THAT VOTED AGAINST THE 2021 U.N. RESOLUTION TO HAVE FOOD BE A HUMAN RIGHT AND HOW THEY ARE INFLICTING STARVATION ON THE PALESTINIAN PEOPLE NOW. THE MAJORITY OF THE PEOPLE AT THIS MEETING SUPPORT THE PEACE AND JUSTICE RESOLUTION WITH AN ARMS EMBARGO ON ISRAEL. THE MAJORITY OF THE WORLD SUPPORTS THE END THE U.S.-ISRAELI JAEN SIDAL WAR ON GAZA. WHAT YOU ARE SAYING IF YOU ARE AGAINST THIS RESOLUTION IS SAYING WANT PALESTINIANS TO KEEP DYING. SO WHAT, LIKE, WHAT'S WRONG WITH YOU? END THE GENOCIDE, ARMS EMBARGO NOW. [APPLAUSE]

>> CITY CLERK: NEXT IS CONFEDERATED VILLAGES OF LISJAN.

>> HELLO, EVERYONE, MY NAME IS KARINA GOULD, TRIBAL CHAIR FOR CONFEDERATED VILLAGES OF LISJAN NATION. I'M HERE TO APPY TO BE HERE, I KNOW WHAT GENOCIDE IS ABOUT, WE ARE SITTING IN A SETTLER COLONIAL STATE RIGHT NOW HELL BENT ON THE GENOCIDE AND EXTERMINATION OF ALL AMERICAN INDIANS, SPECIFICALLY CALIFORNIA. CALIFORNIA WAS BUILT ON SPENDING $1.7 BILLION TO EXTERMINATE ALL CALIFORNIA NATIVE PEOPLE, AND WE HAVE SURVIVED. VERY SMALL. BUT THE LANGUAGE I JUST SPOKE TO YOU IN WAS MY GREAT GRANDFATHER'S LANGUAGE, CHOCHENYO, THE FIRST LANGUAGE SPOKEN IN THE EAST BAY. WE DON'T HEAR THAT LANGUAGE. WE ARE THANKFUL THE CITY OF

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BERKELEY STOOD BESIDE US FOR EIGHT YEARS WHILE WE SAVED THE WEST BERKELEY SHELLMOUND. BUT BECAUSE OF THE HARD WORK OF US BEING HERE STILL. WE DON'T WANT THE SAME GENOCIDE TO HAPPEN TO OUR RELATIVES --

>> MAYOR ISHII: SORRY, YOUR TIME IS UP.

>> PLEASE PASS THE PEACE AND JUSTICE RESOLUTION.

>> MAYOR ISHII: ANDREA PRITCHETT IS ONLINE ON ZOOM TOO, AS LISTED. SO CAN GIVE HER THE TIME IF SHE IS STILL THERE.

>> CITY CLERK: OKAY, PLEASE CONTINUE.

>> THANK YOU. I WANT TO SUPPORT THE PEACE AND JUSTICE COMMISSION'S RESOLUTION TO INCLUDE THE ARMS EMBARGO. I THINK IT'S IMPORTANT AS A TRIBAL LEADER TO STAND UP AND SAY THAT I WISH THAT SOMEONE WOULD HAVE STOOD ON OUR SIDE, WOULD HAVE STOOD AND SAID SOMETHING AGAINST THE GENOCIDE HAPPENING TO MY PEOPLE AND CALIFORNIA NATIVE PEOPLE AND AMERICAN INDIAN PEOPLE WHEN THE UNITED STATES GOVERNMENT TOOK OVER OUR LANDS. I THINK IT'S IMPORTANT FOR US TO LOOK AT WHAT THE HISTORY HAS SHOWN US AND HOW WE NEED TO DO DIFFERENT. THIS HISTORY RIGHT NOW IS TELLING US WE NEED TO STAND ON THE RIGHT SIDE. THAT THERE IS NO WAVERING, THERE'S NO STANDING IN THE MIDDLE. THAT WE HAVE TO CHOOSE A SIDE RIGHT NOW. IT DOESN'T MEAN THAT WE ARE ANTI-SEMITIC. I HAVE JEWISH PEOPLE THAT COME ONCE A MONTH AND STAND IN PRAYER AT THE WEST BERKELEY SHELLMOUND AND WE ALSO STAND AND

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HOLD OUR PLACE IN CONNECTION WITH OTHER PLACES AROUND THE WORLD THAT HAVE GENOCIDE.

>> MAYOR ISHII: SORRY, YOUR TIME IS UP. THANK YOU. [APPLAUSE]

>> CITY CLERK: NEXT IS BRIDGET AND BRIDGET HAS TWO MINUTES.

>> MAYOR ISHII: YEAH, SID HAD GIVEN TIME EARLIER FOR BRIDGET.

>> THANK, I ALSO HAVE TIME CEDED BY BETH AND BOB SPIEZ ON ZOOM.

>> MAYOR ISHII: CAN WE PULL THOSE UP, MARK?

>> CITY CLERK: WHO?

>> MAYOR ISHII: BETH AND BOB S.

>> CITY CLERK: I SEE BETH. BETH, ARE YOU CEDING YOUR TIME TO BRIDGET?

>> YES, THIS IS BETH AND I'M CEDING MY TIME TO BRIDGET AND SUPPORT PASSING A PEACE AND JUSTICE RESOLUTION ARMS EMBARGO.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU, AND THEN BOB S.

>> CITY CLERK: BOB, OKAY. BOB, ARE YOU CEDING YOUR TIME TO BRIDGET?

>> YES, I'M CEDING MY TIME AS WELL.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU.

>> CITY CLERK: SO BRIDGET HAS FOUR MINUTES.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU.

>> CITY CLERK: GO AHEAD.

>> THANK YOU SO MUCH. I'M A MIDWIFE AND OAKLAND RESIDENT. THIS TIME LAST YEAR I WAS IN EGYPT PREPARING TO ENTER GAZA. I WAS IN

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GAZA FOR A MONTH AS A RESULT I WORKED PERSONALLY WITH THE INTERNATIONAL COURT OF JUSTICE, U.N., W.H.O. AND AS A FIRSTHAND WITNESS I WOULD LIKE TO CONFIRM THE COMMENTS I HAVE HEARD FROM OUR PRO-ISRAELI, ARE A HISTORICAL AND FILLED WITH DIVISIVE LIES AND PROPAGANDA. IT'S INTERESTING THE SPEAKER SO CONCERNED ABOUT THE ALLEGED HATE TOWARD ISRAELI WAS INFLICTING HATE ON COMMUNITY MEMBERS OUTSIDE THIS MEETING TODAY. WHILE IN GAZA I SUPPORTED WOMEN AS THEY GAVE BIRTH AND BOMBS DROPPED AROUND OUR HOSPITAL BUILDING. I WATCHED MOTHERS SUFFER INCREDIBLY AS THEY MOURNED THE LOSS OF THEIR LOVED ONES WHILE MANAGING THE PAIN OF CONTRACTIONS WITHOUT PAIN MEDICINE. I SAW BABIES DIE BECAUSE OF LACK OF ACCESS TO RUDIMENTARY MEDICAL CARE. I SAW INNOCENT PEOPLE, I SAW PEOPLE STRIPPED OF THEIR DIGNITY. AS I EXITED GAZA I DROVE ON A BUS FROM ISRAEL TO JORDAN, ON A WELL-MAINTAINED HIGHWAY, WHERE CROPS WITH WATERED AND GROWING, PEOPLE FED, HOUSED, HYDRATED AND SAFE, SHOPS OPEN, THE DUALITY WAS SHOCKING. THERE ARE NO EQUAL SIDES HERE, THE IDEA OF BIPARTISAN SHIP IS A FARCE. AS A HEALTH CARE WORKER MY PROFESSIONAL ASSESSMENT WHAT WAS HAPPENING IS CONSISTENT WITH VARIOUS REPORTS PUBLISHED BY U.N., AMNESTY INTERNATIONAL AND OTHER REPUTABLE ORGANIZATIONS. I WITNESSED A GENOCIDE, A SYSTEMATIC ATTACK ON ALL THINGS NECESSARY FOR PEOPLE TO LIVE. HEALTH CARE SYSTEM, FOOD, WATER, SAFETY. IT'S CLEAR THE SITUATION HAS BECOME MORE DIRE, OVER

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300,000 DEAD MOSTLY WOMEN, CHILDREN AND ELDERLY WITH NO AID COME TOGA TO GAZA. OUR TAX DOLLARS FUNDING THIS HELL ON EARTH MAKE THIS A VERY LOCAL ISSUE. IT'S BEEN 569 DAYS OF THE GENOCIDE. WHAT MORE IS THERE TO DISCUSS? WHEN DID BERKELEY BECOME PRO-WAR AND VIOLENCE? WHY HAS VOTING TAKEN THIS LONG? I SEE THE BLACK LIVES MATTER AND LGBTQ+ FLAGS HANGING ABOVE YOU, A CLEAR SYMBOL OF BERKELEY'S COMMITMENT TO LIBERATION OF OPPRESSED AND MARGINALIZED PEOPLE. I HAVE HEARD THE COUNCILMEN COUNCIL MENTION PEACE AND JUSTICE. I WANT TO BE CLEAR; FIRST COMES JUSTICE AND THEN COMES PEACE. ANYTHING BUT PASSING THE RESOLUTION PROPOSED BY THE P.J.C. IN ITS ENTIRETY WOULD BE AN INJUSTICE. THE BARE MINIMUM AFTER TWO AND A HALF YEARS IS VOTING FOR AN ARMS EMBARGO TODAY. THANK YOU FOR YOUR TIME. [APPLAUSE]

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. OKAY, FOLKS WE ONLY HAVE -- WE HAVE LESS THAN 20 MINUTES NOW. SO LET'S GET TO THE NEXT FOLKS.

>> CITY CLERK: MS. COBEL, JOAN, AND CLIMATE PACIFIC ENVIRONMENT. THOSE ARE THE NEXT THREE. MS. COBEL, YOU SHOULD BE ALLOWED TO UNMUTE. MS. COBEL, YOU CAN UNMUTE. WE CAN COME BACK. JOAN SHOULD BE ABLE TO UNMUTE. JOAN, ARE YOU THERE? CLIMATE PACIFIC ENVIRONMENT?

>> HELLO, CAN YOU HEAR ME?

>> CITY CLERK: YES.

>> HI, JACKIE ON ZOOM WANTS TO CEDE HER MINUTE TO ME.

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>> CITY CLERK: THE NAME AGAIN?

>> JACKIE.

>> CITY CLERK: DO YOU HAVE YOUR HAND RAISED?

>> MAYOR ISHII: JACKIE'S HAND IS NOT RAISED, OH, NOW IT IS.

>> CITY CLERK: JACKIE, ARE CEDING YOUR TIME?

>> YES, I CONFIRM.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU.

>> CITY CLERK: TWO MINUTES FOR CLIMATE PACIFIC ENVIRONMENT.

>> HELLO, BERKELEY CITY COUNCIL, MY NAME IS DANYEL HIDARI, I'M A PH.D. STUDENT IN ETHNIC STUDIES AT U.C. BERKELEY, FOCUSING MY RESEARCH ON THE WEAPONS TRADE TO ISRAEL, AS WELL AS HOW CRISTIAN NATIONALIST MOVEMENTS CONCEIVE OF ISRAEL PALESTINE. I'M AN IRANI AMERICAN TRANSGENDER WOMEN WHO IDENTIFIES AS CRISTIAN. I WANT TO SHARE ABOUT THE FINDINGS OF MY RESEARCH, WE HEARD ABOUT THE PAIN AND HURT AND WHY SO MANY MEMBERS OF THE COMMUNITY THINK THE ARMS EMBARGO IS IMPORTANT. I WANT TO SHARE A LITTLE ABOUT THE IDEOLOGY BEHIND WHY THE UNITED STATES SENDS SO MUCH MILITARY AID TO ISRAEL, WHY WE SUPPLY 67% OF THE I.D.F.'S WEAPONRY. PART OF THE REASON IS BECAUSE OF CHRISTIAN NATIONALISM. THIS IS IMPORTANT BECAUSE WE HAVE AN ADMINISTRATION GUIDING ISRAEL-PALESTINE POLICY. ONE OF TRUMP'S CLOSEST ADVISOR, JOHN HEGY, END OF TIMES BATTLE OF ARMAGEDDON, ACCORDING TO HIS WORLD VIEW, A VENGEFUL JUDAO-CHRISTIAN GOD AT END OF TIME WILL ELIMINATE

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ISRAEL'S ENEMIES THROUGH ETHNIC CLEANSING, READING THE BOOK OF EZEKIEL CHAPTERS 38 AND 39 LITERALLY. IN THE CONTEXT OF THIS RELIGIOUS FUNDAMENTALIST EMPIRE MAKING THAT TRUMP'S POLICY IS AIMING TO ACCOMPLISH BY COLONIZING THE GAZA TRIP WE NEED TO SHOW ANOTHER WAY. WE ARE IN DIRE NEED OF A HOPE.

>> MAYOR ISHII: YOUR TIME IS UP, I'M SORRY. THANK YOU FOR YOUR COMMENT.

>> CITY CLERK: MS. COBEL.

>> MAYOR ISHII: FOLKS, WE HAVE 15 MINUTES LEFT FOR PUBLIC COMMENT ON ZOOM. CAN YOU READ THE NEXT THREE?

>> CITY CLERK: MS. COBEL, JOAN, AND LEAH SIMON-WEISBERG. MS. COBEL, SHOULD BE ABLE TO UNMUTE. LET'S TRY JOAN. JOAN, SHOULD BE ABLE TO UNMUTE. THERE YOU GO.

>> THANK YOU, CAN YOU ALL HEAR ME?

>> MAYOR ISHII: YES.

>> SO FIRST I WANT TO SAY THANK YOU TO BERKELEY CITY COUNCIL FOR YOUR INCREDIBLE PATIENCE SITTING THROUGH THIS FOR ABOUT SIX HOURS NOW. IT'S REALLY AN ACT OF ENDURANCE AND I RESPECT YOU FOR THAT. I'M JOAN AND I'M SPEAKING AS A PHYSICIAN. IN OUR PROFESSION WE PLEDGE TO DO NO HARM, WE LEARN THE POWER OF PROTECTING AND SUPPORTING THE VULNERABLE, WE LEARN THAT ALL LIFE IS PRECIOUS AND WE ARE ALL CONNECTED. WAR AND SUFFERING BRINGS TERRIBLE SPIRITUAL, MENTAL HEALTH AND THOSE WHO STAND BY

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ANGUISHED BY WHAT THEY ARE SEEING. I URGE THE COUNCIL TO SUPPORT PEACE TO SUPPORT HEALING, RATHER THAN HARMING BY PASSING THE P.J.C. RESOLUTION FOR A COMPLETE ARMS EMBARGO AND USING OUR TAX DOLLARS TO BUILD OUR COMMUNITY RATHER THAN CONTRIBUTING TO THE SUFFERING THAT WILL LAST FOR GENERATIONS, THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU, YOUR TIME IS UP. I WOULD LIKE TO MAKE A MOTION TO EXTEND THE TIME, OTHERWISE OUR MEETING AUTOMATICALLY ENDS AT 11:00. I WOULD LIKE TO MAKE A MOTION TO EXTEND THE TIME TO, WHAT TIME WOULD BE GOOD? YEAH, UNTIL MIDNIGHT.

>> C. LUNAPARRA: SECOND.

>> MAYOR ISHII: A SECOND FROM COUNCILMEMBER LUNAPARRA.

>> CITY CLERK: TO EXTEND THE MEETING --

>> MAYOR ISHII: THE CLOCK IS STOPPED. GO AHEAD, WHAT WERE YOU SAYING, MARK?

>> CITY CLERK: COUNCILMEMBER KESARWANI?

>> R. KESARWANI: I'M SORRY, I DIDN'T HEAR. WHAT IS THE TIME WE ARE EXTENDING TO?

>> MAYOR ISHII: TO MIDNIGHT.

>> R. KESARWANI: OH, OKAY, YES.

>> CITY CLERK: TAPLIN?

>> T. TAPLIN: UNTIL MIDNIGHT?

>> CITY CLERK: YES.

>> T. TAPLIN: YES.

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>> CITY CLERK: BARTLETT?

>> B. BARTLETT: YES.

>> CITY CLERK: TREGUB?

>> I. TREGUB: AYE.

>> CITY CLERK: O'KEEFE?

>> S. O'KEEFE: YES.

>> CITY CLERK: BLACKABY?

>> B. BLACKABY: YES.

>> CITY CLERK: LUNAPARRA?

>> C. LUNAPARRA: YES.

>> CITY CLERK: HUMBERT?

>> M. HUMBERT: YES.

>> CITY CLERK: AND MAYOR ISHII.

>> MAYOR ISHII: YES. THANK YOU.

>> CITY CLERK: MOTION CARRIES.

>> MAYOR ISHII: LET'S TAKE YOU'RE NEXT COMMENTS. WE HAVE LEAH SIMON-WEISBERG, LEAH CARROLL, AND LIVIA BELMAN-WELLS. LEAH SIMON-WEISBERG.

>> I'M A BERKELEY RESIDENT; I AM JEWISH AND I AM HERE SPEAKING IN HONOR OF MY GRAND MOTH WHO IS A HOLOCAUST SURVIVOR. AT 11 SHE LOST ALMOST ALL OF HER FAMILY AND ONLY SURVIVED BECAUSE A GENTILE FAMILY HID HER. AND GROWING UP SHE TALKED A LOT ABOUT BEING A RIGHTEOUS GENTILE, EVEN AS A JEWISH PERSON THAT WAS A

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VERY IMPORTANT VALUE IN OUR FAMILY. WHAT IS HAPPENING NOW IS INCREDIBLY REFLECTIVE OF WHEN WE ALL NEED TO BE THE RIGHTEOUS GENTILE. TERRIBLE THINGS HAPPEN WHEN GOOD PEOPLE DO NOTHING. I THINK THAT WE HAVE ALL BEEN TALKING ABOUT THAT WE CANNOT EXPECT THAT JUST THIS RESOLUTION WILL END A WAR. BUT I THINK IN LIGHT OF HOW THE TRUMP ADMINISTRATION HAS RESPONDED TO HARVARD TAKING A STAND, BERKELEY TOO NEEDS TO TAKE A STAND THAT WE DO CARE WHAT IS HAPPENING IN GAZA.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. [APPLAUSE]

>> CITY CLERK: OKAY. LET'S TRY MS. COBEL ONE MORE TIME. MS. COBEL? OKAY.

>> MAYOR ISHII: LET'S MOVE ON.

>> CITY CLERK: LET'S MOVE ON. LEAH CARROLL. GO AHEAD.

>> MY NAME IS LEAH CARROLL. AS SOMEONE DESCENDED FROM JEWS WHO BARELY ESCAPED THE HOLOCAUST YOU SAY NEVER AGAIN MEANS NEVER AGAIN FOR ANYONE. I URGE YOU TO SUPPORT THE RESOLUTION IN ITS ORIGINAL FORM AS PASSED BY THE PEACE AND JUSTICE COMMISSION AND CALLING FOR AN ARMS EMBARGO AGAINST ISRAEL. NOT THE WATERED-DOWN VERSION PROPOSED BY COUNCILMEMBER TAPLIN. USE OUR TAX DOLLARS TO SUPPORT OUR COMMUNITIES, NOT GENOCIDE IN GAZA. FOLLOW BERKELEY'S PROUD LEGACY OF SOCIAL JUSTICE. PLEASE DON'T BE COWARDLY, THERE'S TOO MANY COWARDS THESE DAYS. DARE TO STAND UP AGAINST GENOCIDE AND FASCISM BOTH HERE AND ABROAD.

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>> CITY CLERK: THANK YOU. [APPLAUSE] NEXT IS LIVIA BELMAN-WELLS.

>> MAYOR ISHII: FOLLOWED BY MEERA AND THEN MARIA SOL.

>> HI. DESPITE WHAT OTHERS HAVE CLAIMED, THAT SAY THOSE THAT CALL FOR AN ARMS EMBARGO HAVE NO SAY IN THIS OR DON'T UNDERSTAND, I HAVE -- I'M JEWISH, I'M A BERKELEY RESIDENT. I HAVE FOLLOWED THIS ISSUE AND WHAT I WANT TO ASK PEOPLE THAT DISAGREE HOW CAN YOUR COMPASSION BE SO SHALLOW WOULD NOT ONLY NOT TRY TO HELP PEOPLE DYING, CHILDREN DYING, PEOPLE STARVING, BUT YOU WOULD GO OUT OF YOUR WAY TO HINDER THOSE TRYING TO PROVIDE AID? PLEASE, PLEASE SUPPORT AN ARMS EMBARGO. THERE ARE PEOPLE DYING. AND TO TURN A BLIND EYE TO THAT IS A CRIME THAT WILL BE REMEMBERED.

>> MAYOR ISHII: YOUR TIME IS UP. THANK YOU. [APPLAUSE]

>> CITY CLERK: OKAY. MEERA SRIRAM.

>> MAYOR ISHII: CAN YOU GIVE ME A TIME CHECK

>> CITY CLERK: TEN MINUTES AND 39 SECONDS LEFT.

>> I WOULD LIKE TO USE A MINUTE FROM ANOTHER PERSON WHO IS LOGGED IN UNDER THE NAME SRIRAM GOPALAKRISHNAN.

>> I WOULD LIKE TO CONFIRM THAT.

>> CAN I GO AHEAD?

>> CITY CLERK: YES, GO AHEAD.

>> HI, ARE YOU ABLE TO HEAR ME?

>> MAYOR ISHII: WE CAN HEAR YOU.

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>> OKAY, THANK YOU, GOOD EVENING, MY NAME IS SRIRAM, A RESIDENT OF DISTRICT FIVE. I'M HERE BECAUSE SILENCE IS NOT AN OPTION BUT NEITHER IS FALSE NEUTRALITY. I WOULD LIKE TO REMIND THE MAYOR YOU WERE ELECTED ON THE PROMISE OF SUPPORTING A PERMANENT CEASE FIRE, BACK IN AUGUST 2024, WHEN YOU TEXTED ME ASKING FOR SUPPORT FOR CANDIDACY I ASKED WHAT IS YOUR STANCE ON ISRAEL PALESTINE ISSUE YOUR RESPONSE I SUPPORT AN IMMEDIATE CEASE-FIRE. THIS MUST HAVE A CEASE FIRE, FULL ARMS EMBARGO AND CALL FOR RELEASE OF ALL PALESTINIAN HOSTAGES, NOT PRISONERS BUT HOSTAGES AND PROTECTION OF FREE SPEECH FOR STUDENTS AND WORKERS IN BERKELEY. WHAT I'M HEARING ARE THE SAME SPINELESS ARGUMENTS. WHAT I'M HEARING IS DANGEROUS DISHONEST FRAMING THAT SIMPLY CALLS FOR "PEACE FOR EVERYONE" WHEN YOU SAY ISRAEL MUST UPHOLD INTERNATIONAL LAWS THERE COULD BE NO HUMANITARIAN KILLING OF CIVILIANS. JUSTICE BRINGS SAFETY AND FREEDOM FOR ALL PEOPLE. IF YOU LOOK BEHIND YOU, THE BIG SIGN THAT SAYS BLACK LIVES MATTER, YOU ALL SOUND LIKE THOSE PEOPLE WHO SAY ALL LIVES MATTER. WE HAVE HEARD FROM SOME ASKING WHY SHOULD BERKELEY BE INVOLVED IN FOREIGN POLICY? FIRST, IF OUR NATIONAL GOVERNMENT WAS DOING ITS JOB, WE WOULD GLADLY FOCUS ON LOCAL ISSUES. SECOND, NONE OF YOU QUESTION WHEN WE PASSED A RESOLUTION AGAINST RUSSIA FOR THEIR INVASION OF UKRAINE NOT TOO LONG AGO. WHY THE DOUBLE STANDARDS TODAY? COUNCILMEMBER TREGUB AND TAPLIN, YOU HAD NO HESITATION VOTING

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FOR THAT RESOLUTION, WHY THE DOUBLE STANDARDS. IF RICHMOND CAN DO IT, SO CAN WE, WE WILL REMEMBER WHO HAS THE COURAGE TO STAND FOR TRUTH. FREE PALESTINIAN HOSTAGES AND ISRAELI JAILS, THANK YOU. [APPLAUSE]

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. FOLKS, A REMINDER, YOU ARE EATING INTO THE TIME.

>> CITY CLERK: WE NEED PEOPLE TO LOWER THEIR SIGNS. THEY ARE BLOCKING THE VIEWS OF THE CAMERAS OF THE DAIS, PLEASE. LOWER, LOWER. LOWER. ARMS EMBARGO NOW, PLEASE LOWER YOUR SIGN.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. FOLKS, PLEASE. ARE EATING INTO OUR TIME. I WOULD LIKE TO MAKE IT THROUGH SOME MORE FOLKS. AND A REMINDER TO PEOPLE TO ADDRESS THE COUNCIL AS A WHOLE BODY AND NOT INDIVIDUALS.

>> CITY CLERK: MARIA SOL.

>> OH YES, THANK YOU SO VERY MUCH, AND I HAVE TWO EXTRA MINUTES, FROM ONE CATHERINE HUTCHING AND ONE FROM AYLAT AND THEY ARE SITTING IN THE CHAMBER.

>> CITY CLERK: RAISE YOUR HAND, PLEASE.

>> MAYOR ISHII: I SEE ONE PERSON. I DON'T KNOW WHERE THERE'S A SECOND.

>> CITY CLERK: OKAY, SO TWO MINUTES, MARIA.

>> MAYOR ISHII: MARIA, I ONLY SEE ONE PERSON HERE. TWO MINUTES TOTAL.

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>> THANK YOU VERY MUCH. AND THANK YOU, MAYOR. I KNOW THIS IS CHALLENGING. BUT IT SURE IS LESS BLOODY THAN SHOOTING, SO EVERYONE HERE WHO TOOK THE TIME TO SPEAK AND TO LISTEN TO ONE ANOTHER, IT'S SUCH A PRIVILEGE TO BE WITH ALL OF YOU AND ALL OF US STAYING UP SO LATE. SO THANK YOU, COUNCIL. AND I APPRECIATE YOUR REAL TEARS, BY THE WAY, MS. MAYOR. SO MY PRIMARY CONCERN HAS BEEN MENTIONED A NUMBER OF TIMES, RECENTLY. AND THAT IS THAT THERE'S A LOT OF FORCES AT PLAY. AND YOU THINK AFTER ALL OF THESE EONS OF HISTORY AND BARBARITY WE WOULD RECOGNIZE THAT HUMANS COULD BE HUMANE OR BARBARIC AND WOULD THINK PERHAPS WE MIGHT LEARN BY NOW THAT WHAT IS HAPPENING IN SO MANY PLACES IS NOT GOING TO WORK. IT HASN'T IN THIS COUNTRY. I KNOW THAT WE CONQUERED THE LAND OF THE INDIANS AND IT NEARLY EXTERMINATED THEM. SO WE HAVE, IN OUR SOUL, THINGS THAT ALANA MENTIONED WE NEED TO HEAL BECAUSE IT'S PEOPLE THAT PERPETUATE TRAUMA THAT NEED TO BE PROTECTED FROM THAT TRAUMA, JUST LIKE -- I HELP YOU, HELP YOURSELF BY NOT LETTING YOU HURT ME, SO WHY IS IT THE MOST OPPRESSED AND VILLAINIZED AND EXCLUDED PEOPLE, THE JEWISH PEOPLE FROM EUROPEAN COUNTRIES AND PLACES ALL OVER THE WORLD, SO SADLY, FOR SO LONG, WOULD HAVE LEARNED THE LESSON OF HOW TO OPPRESS AND LEARN HOW NOT TO. THIS IS WHY I'M SO CONCERNED ABOUT ISRAEL. I REALLY, REALLY HOPE THEY CAN HEAL THEMSELVES AS WE ALL MUST FROM THE TRAUMA AND THE HURT THAT EITHER WE OR PEOPLE --

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>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. MARIA, YOUR TIME IS UP. THANK YOU VERY MUCH FOR YOUR COMMENT.

>> MAYOR ISHII: MARK, TIME CHECK?

>> CITY CLERK: WE HAVE FIVE MINUTES LEFT. WE HAVE LUCHI. SPEAKER GOOBS, AND THEN AL.

>> MAYOR ISHII: IT'S POSSIBLE THOSE MIGHT BE OUR FINAL SPEAKERS. JUST TO GIVE PEOPLE'S HEAD'S UP.

>> CITY CLERK: LUCHI, YOU CAN SPEAK.

>> HI, I JUST WANT TO SAY THANK YOU FIRST OF ALL TO ALL OF OUR INCREDIBLE COMRADES WHO HAVE BEEN HERE SINCE 4:00 OR 5:00 P.M. TODAY. I FRANKLY WISH FOR THE COUNCIL THAT YOU HAVE SLEEPLESS NICE THE WAY MANY OF US HAVE SUFFERED WAITING TO HEAR IF OUR LOVED ONES IN GAZA ARE STILL ALIVE. I'M SHOCKED BY SOME OF THE PEOPLE WHO THINK THIS DON'T THINK WE SHOULD PASS AN ARMS EMBARGO RESOLUTION. I WANT TO REMIND YOU ALL THIS IS A LOCAL ISSUE. IF I'M STAYING UP LATE WAITING TO HEAR FROM MY LOVED ONES THIS IS A LOCAL ISSUE. IF WE CANNOT HOUSE NEIGHBORS, THIS IS A LOCAL ISSUE, IF OUR TAX DOLLARS ARE GOING TO BEHEAD CHILDREN THIS IS A LOCAL ISSUE. DO YOUR JOBS LISTEN TO YOUR CONSTITUENTS, REMEMBER IN THE YEAR YOU HAVE BEEN IGNORING US, WE HAVE BEEN BUILDING COMMUNITY. THEY CAME FROM MAHMOUD; WE WILL BE THERE BUILDING COMMUNITY WITHOUT YOU. WE WILL MAKE SURE HISTORY REMEMBERS YOU HOWEVER YOU VOTE TONIGHT. THANK YOU.

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>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU FOR YOUR COMMENTS. [APPLAUSE]

>> CITY CLERK: AND JUST AS A REMINDER, THE RULES OF PROCEDURE STATE THERE ARE NO STICKS OR ANYTHING LIKE A STICK ALLOWED IN THE COUNCIL CHAMBERS. SO YOU CAN REMOVE YOUR STICK FROM THE SIGN AND KEEP THE SIGN. CAN STILL HAVE THE SIGN, JUST CAN'T HAVE THE STICK. CAN HAVE THE SIGN.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THEY ARE WORKING ON TAKING THE STICK OFF. IN THE MEANTIME LET'S MAKE SURE WE GET ON -- FOLKS, PLEASE.

>> CITY CLERK: NEXT IS GOOBS. YOU SHOULD BE ABLE TO UNMUTE. G-O-O-B-S. SHOULD BE ABLE TO UNMUTE. ALL RIGHT. WE WILL SKIP THAT. MOVE ONTO AL. AL, YOU SHOULD BE ABLE TO UNMUTE. AL?

>> HI, CAN YOU HEAR ME?

>> CITY CLERK: YES, GO AHEAD.

>> THANK YOU. I'VE HEARD A LOT OF ALTERNATIVE THOUGHTS TONIGHT BY SUPPORTERS OF THE PEACE AND JUSTICE COMMISSION RESOLUTION. IF EVEN HALF WERE TRUE WE WOULD HAVE A LOT OF COMMON GROUND BUT UNFORTUNATELY THIS IS A VERY COORDINATED GLOBAL PROPAGANDA CAMPAIGN BY THE I.R.G.C. AND HAMAS TO LEGITIMIZE --

>> MAYOR ISHII: FOLKS?

>> PARTICIPATING IN THIS CAMPAIGN IS NOT PEACE, NOT JUSTICE AND NOT WORTHY OF BERKELEY. IT'S TERRIBLE FOREIGN POLICY AND LOCAL POLITICS THAT AFFECT MY COMMUNITY AND FAMILY VERY BADLY. PLEASE REJECT VIOLENT AND HATEFUL EXTREMISM, PLEASE FOLLOW THE

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LEADERSHIP OF TERRY TAPLIN AND VOTE FOR HIS RESOLUTION WHICH REPRESENTS A TRUE PATH TO PEACE THAT UNIFIES BERKELEY. THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. I THINK WE HAVE TIME, HOW MUCH TIME DO WE HAVE LEFT?

>> CITY CLERK: WE HAVE TIME FOR TWO MORE SPEAKERS. WE HAVE KARIS KAZUKO. GO AHEAD.

>> HELLO, CAN YOU HEAR ME?

>> CITY CLERK: YES.

>> MY NAME IS KARIS KAZUKO TAYLOR, SPECIAL EDUCATION TEACHER AT BERKELEY HIGH SCHOOL. TO TRY TO HELP MYSELF UNDERSTAND THE HISTORY OF PALESTINE ISRAEL AND HISTORY OF THIS MOMENT, I READ HOWARD ZEN, NAOMI KLEIN, NELSON MANDELA TO NAME A FEW. LET THE CITY OF BERKELEY BE ON THE SAME SIDE OF HISTORY AS ANGELA DAVIS AND HOWARD ZIN AND PASS THE PEACE AND JUSTICE RESOLUTION CALLING FOR AN ARMS EMBARGO. THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU.

>> CITY CLERK: ONE LAST CALL FOR G-O-O-B-S. GO AHEAD.

>> HI, CAN YOU HEAR ME?

>> CITY CLERK: YEAH, GO AHEAD.

>> MY NAME IS GABRIELLE; I SUPPORT AN ARMS EMBARGO. FOR THOSE EARLIER WHO SAID WE ARE THE MINORITY, LOOK AROUND DO WE LOOK LIKE THE MINORITY. MAJORITY OF BERKELEY SUPPORT GUN CONTROL TO

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PREVENT THINGS LIKE SCHOOL SHOOTINGS. I DON'T KNOW HOW YOU CAN JUSTIFY BEING OKAY WITH YOUR HARD-EARNED MONEY FUNDING WEAPONS THAT KILL INNOCENT PEOPLE AND CHILDREN IN GAZA. IS IT BECAUSE THEY ARE MIDDLE EASTERN? ARE THEIR LIVES WORTH LESS TO YOU? I DON'T SEE THAT DISCONNECT THERE, HOW YOU WANT GUN CONTROL HERE BUT YOU ARE OKAY WITH FUNDING A GENOCIDE IN THE MIDDLE EAST. THANK YOU.

>> CITY CLERK: OKAY, LAST SPEAKER IS LYNN. LAST SPEAKER.

>> HI, MY NAME IS LYNNE, I'M A BAY AREA CHINESE BORN AMERICAN WITH NO TIES TO ISRAEL OR PALESTINE. I SUPPORT THE ARMS EMBARGO RESOLUTION WITH NO CHANGES OR AS ANOTHER SPEAK HE SO ELOQUENTLY PUT IT, FOOLERY, THAT WAS PUT FORTH BY THE P.J.C. THIS IS NOT A COMPLEX ISSUE, IT'S ONLY COMPLICATED IF YOU TRY TO WORD SALAD YOURSELF FROM A GENOCIDE BEING BROADCAST LIVE IN FRONT OF OUR EYES. I JUST WANT TO SAY KEEP THE SIGNS UP, THEY DON'T BOTHER ME, ESPECIALLY YOU, ARMS EMBARGO NOW. THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR ISHII: OKAY.

>> CITY CLERK: SO THAT CONCLUDES PUBLIC COMMENT. THE TIME HAS ELAPSED ON PUBLIC COMMENT.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. THANK YOU, MARK. FOLKS? I WOULD LIKE TO ASK YOU TO PUT YOUR SIGNS DOWN NOW. BECAUSE WE ARE BACK IN CHAMBERS AND FOLKS IN THE BACK CAN'T SEE, SO PLEASE PUT YOUR SIGNS DOWN. PLEASE PUT YOUR SIGNS, THE PERSON IN THE SECOND ROW.

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YOU CAN PUT IT TO THE SIDE BUT PEOPLE NEED TO BE ABLE TO SEE. THANK YOU. OKAY. WE ARE GOING TO MOVE ONTO COUNCIL COMMENTS. FOLKS? PLEASE. WE AGREED AT OUR LAST COUNCIL RETREAT WE WOULD GIVE COUNCILMEMBERS FIVE MINUTES FOR THEIR COMMENTS. SO I WOULD LIKE TO ASK THE COUNCIL IF THEY HAVE ANY COMMENTS. COUNCILMEMBER HUMBERT?

>> M. HUMBERT: THANK YOU, MADAM MAYOR. FOR ME, THE PEACE AND JUSTICE COMMISSION'S RESOLUTION IS A NON-STARTER. IT FAILS TO

>> MAYOR ISHII: LET HIM CONTINUE.

>> M. HUMBERT: IT FAILS TO CONDEMN HAMAS, A TERRORIST ORGANIZATION DEDICATED IN COMPLETE DESTRUCTION OF ISRAEL. THE RESOLUTION DOES NOT REPRESENT ANY KIND OF CONSENSUS --

>> MAYOR ISHII: PLEASE GIVE HIM TIME TO SPEAK.

>> [OFF MIC]

>> MAYOR ISHII: PLEASE GIVE HIM TIME TO SPEAK. EXCUSE ME. EXCUSE ME. DECORUM.

>> DECORUM?

>> MAYOR ISHII: PLEASE. FOLKS? PEOPLE ASKED TO HAVE THIS MEETING. YOU ASKED TO HEAR -- I'M SORRY, THESE ARE THE COMMENTS BEING GIVEN RIGHT NOW. SO YOU CAN GIVE FOLKS, YOU CAN GIVE OUR COUNCILMEMBERS RESPECT AND LET THEM FINISH THEIR COMMENTS OTHERWISE WE WILL ADJOURN THE MEETING WITHOUT ANYTHING. I ASK YOU TO PLEASE BE QUIET AND ALLOW OUR COUNCILMEMBERS TO SPEAK.

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YOU NEED TO BE RESPECTFUL AND ALLOW THEM TIME. WE HAVE BEEN LISTENING RESPECTFULLY FOR HOURS. PLEASE.

>> M. HUMBERT: I'M GOING TO GO AHEAD. THE RESOLUTION DOES NOT REPRESENT, IN MY VIEW, ANY KIND OF CONSENSUS AMONG THE MEMBERS OF THE BERKELEY COMMUNITY. THAT'S COMPLETELY CLEAR TO ME HAVING READ AND LISTENED TO THOUSANDS OF COMMENTS FROM BERKELEY RESIDENTS ABOUT THIS RESOLUTION, WHICH WAS IN FACT ADOPTED BY A DEEPLY SPLIT COMMISSION. AND IN FACT, I WILL DO WHAT MY CONSCIOUS COMPELS ME TO DO AND WON'T BE BULLIED BY THE LOUD ANGRY DEMANDS AND THREATS, I SHED MY CONVICTIONS AND BELIEFS.

>> MAYOR ISHII: PLEASE DON'T CALL OUR COUNCILMEMBERS NAMES. PLEASE GO AHEAD.

>> M. HUMBERT: WHILE I'M SURE THIS IS NOT THE INTENT, I THINK SHOWS FURTHER MISTRUST AND DIVISION WITHIN OUR COMMUNITY. WITH ONE MAIN POINT, IT CHARACTERIZES THE OCTOBER 7TH EVENT AS A MILITARY ESCALATION. IT WAS NOT A MILITARY ESCALATION. IT WAS A VIOLENT TERRORIST ATTACK ON CIVILIANS DURING WHICH HAMAS TERRORISTS PERPETRATED OUTRAGEOUS ACTS OF MASS MURDER, TORTURE, SEXUAL VIOLENCE AND KIDNAPPING OF CIVILIANS INCLUDING BABIES.

>> MAYOR ISHII: FOLKS, PLEASE. PLEASE BE QUIET AND ALLOW HIM TO SPEAK.

>> M. HUMBERT: I'M NOT LYING, IT'S TRUE.

>> MAYOR ISHII: FOLKS, PLEASE ALLOW HIM TO SPEAK. OKAY, HOLD ON,

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ONE SECOND. COUNCILMEMBER --

>> M. HUMBERT: PLEASE LET ME SPEAK.

>> MAYOR ISHII: COUNCILMEMBER. LET ME JUST SAY ONE THING, I'M SORRY. FOLKS, I HAVE ALREADY PROMISED THAT WE ARE NOT GOING TO HAVE THIS MEETING IN THE BACK ROOM. IF YOU KEEP INTERRUPTING THERE WILL BE A MOTION TO ADJOURN. I'M ASKING THAT YOU BE RESPECTFUL AND ALLOW PEOPLE TO SPEAK THEIR PEACE.

>> M. HUMBERT: THERE ARE PARTS OF THE RESOLUTION THE MAYOR HAS BROUGHT I CAN AGREE WITH. I DEEPLY GRIEVE THE SUFFERING AND DEATH OF THE PALESTINIAN AND ISRAELI PEOPLES. BUT THE RESOLUTION PURPORTS TO DIRECT AMERICAN FOREIGN POLICY WHICH IS NOT WITHIN THE COMPETENCE OR BAILEY WICK OF THE CITY COUNCIL. I SUPPORT COUNCILMEMBER TAPLIN'S RESOLUTION. IT FOCUSES ON THE WELFARE OF OUR RESIDENTS. THE RESIDENTS OF BERKELEY. AND THE DEVASTATING IMPACTS THE AWFUL WAR IN GAZA HAS HAD AND CONTINUES TO HAVE ON THE MEMBERS OF OUR COMMUNITY. THE WELFARE AND HAPPINESS OF OUR BERKELEYANS IS THE APPROPRIATE FOCUS OF THIS COUNCIL AND FOR THAT REASON I WILL BE VOTING YES ON COUNCILMEMBER TAPLIN'S RESOLUTION. THANK YOU. [CHEERS AND APPLAUSE] [BOO'S]

>> MAYOR ISHII: FOLKS, PLEASE, I CAN'T HEAR. OKAY, COUNCILMEMBER BLACKABY?

>> B. BLACKABY: THANKS, MADAM MAYOR. THE ONGOING CONFLICT IN ISRAEL AND GAZA IS DEVASTATING, AS WE HEARD HERE TONIGHT. SHOULD

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WE FINISH, OR SHOULD I CALL THE QUESTION ON THE MOTION AND WE CAN JUST FINISH? THE TRAGEDY OF HUMAN SUFFERING OF LOSS OF HUMAN LIFE IS ABHORRENT TO ALL OF US, ON A PERSONAL AND HUMAN LEVEL. WE ALL URGENTLY WANT PEACE IN THE MIDDLE EAST AND WE WANT AN END TO THE BLOODSHED AND SUFFERING. AS WE HAVE HEARD HERE TONIGHT THERE ARE MANY DIVERGENT OPINIONS ABOUT THE MIDDLE EAST. PASSING A RESOLUTION IN SUPPORT OF CEASE FIRE OR ARMS EM BAR BARGO OR PLACING MORE OR LESS BLAME WOULD FEEL SUPPORTING TO SOME AND OSTRACIZING OTHERS. MY GOAL IS TO BRING THE COMMUNITY AS BEST I CAN, TO TRY TO BRIDGE THE STRONGLY HELD PERSPECTIVES ON ALL SIDES. AND ULTIMATELY TO REASSERT OUR SHARED VALUES AS BERKELEY RESIDENTS. TO AFFIRM THAT HATE HAS NO PLACE IN BERKELEY, ANTI-ARAB, ANTI-MUSLIM, ANTI-JEWISH HATE HAS NO PLACE HERE. YOUR CITY COUNCIL, STAFF 0 OR POLICE DEPARTMENT AND ALL BERKELEY COUNCIL STAND TOGETHER FOR THAT. I WANT TO THANK YOU FOR BEING HERE TONIGHT, EVEN THOSE HECKLING, THANK YOU FOR BEING HERE. I'VE BEEN SO MOVED BY THE PERSONAL TESTIMONY YOU HAVE SHARED WITH US. I'VE MET WITH MANY GROUPS ABOUT THIS TOPIC IN THE DAYS AND WEEKS, I HAVE READ EVERY EMAIL AND LISTENED TO THE COMMENTS TONIGHT. I WANT TO THANK THE PEACE AND JUSTICE COMMISSION FOR BRINGING FORWARD THEIR RECOMMENDATION, THEY WORKED HARD ON THEIR SOLUTION. I WANT TO THANK THE MAYOR, COUNCILMEMBER BARTLETT AND THEIR STAFFS FOR WORKING SO DILIGENTLY FOR REACHING OUT TO A

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RANGE OF GROUPS TO TRY TO CRAFT A COMPROMISED SOLUTION AND COUNCILMEMBER TAPLIN AND HIS STAFF FOR MAKING THE SAME EFFORT. TONIGHT I SUPPORT THE RESOLUTION OFFERED BY COUNCILMEMBER TAPLIN BECAUSE IT COMES CLOSEST TO REPRESENTING MY FEELINGS ON THE MATTER. MOST IMPORTANTLY TO ME IT CENTERS ALMOST ALL OF ITS LANGUAGE WHAT THE PRIORITY OF THIS CITY COUNCIL MUST BE. THE PEOPLE OF BERKELEY, OUR COMMUNITY, AND OUR VALUES. I FEEL LIKE THAT'S THE MOST IMPORTANT STATEMENT I CAN MAKE HERE TONIGHT BECAUSE I'M ILL EQUIPPED TO OPINE ON FOREIGN POLICY FROM THIS STATE AND EVEN IF I WERE, COULD HAVE NO IMPACT ON IT. I COULD TRY TO HAVE AN IMPACT HERE, ALL OF YOU, DO MY SMALL PART BRINGING OUR COMMUNITY BACK TOGETHER AFTER MANY MONTHS OF DISCORD IN RESPONSE TO WELL-INTENTIONED RESIDENTS WHO HAVE BEEN PERSONALLY AFFECTED BY THE VIOLENCE, WHO THEMSELVES ARE RESPONDING TO THE TERRIBLE BLOODSHED AND HUMANITARIAN CRISIS IN GAZA. WHATEVER HAPPENS TONIGHT, I KNOW THERE ARE MANY RESIDENTS, MANY IN THIS ROOM AND ONLINE WHO WILL BE STATE FRUSTRATED, ANGRY, BY THE ACTION OUR CITY COUNCIL TAKES.

>> MAYOR ISHII: FOLKS.

>> B. BLACKABY: I REALLY APPRECIATE, WE LISTENED TO YOU SIX HOURS, I WAS PLEASED TO DO IT, I ASK, ALL I'VE GOT IS TWO MORE MINUTES. ALL I CAN ASK IS WE STRIVE TO OVERCOME OUR PERSONAL DIFFERENCES; I PLEDGE TO REACH MY HANDOUT TO EVERYONE HERE.

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THANKS A LOT. IN THE DAYS AND WEEKS AHEAD AND TO FIND COMMON GROUND IN OTHER AREAS WHERE WE CAN WORK TOGETHER FOR THE COMMON GOOD OUR COMMUNITY. THAT'S WHAT WE ARE HERE TO DO. SO THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU, COUNCILMEMBER. COUNCILMEMBER O'KEEFE, I THINK THAT'S YOUR HAND THAT'S UP. IS IT? YES.

>> S. O'KEEFE: USUALLY I SPEAK EXTEMPORANEOUSLY, BUT I'M NOT FEELING MY BEST SO I WILL READ PREPARED COMMENTS. YOUR ANGER MAKES A LOT OF SENSE. WHAT'S HAPPENING IN GAZA IS BEYOND HORRIFIC. THERE ARE NO WORDS TO DESCRIBE THE HORROR, THOUGH MANY OF YOU DID YOUR BEST TO BRING IT ALIVE IN YOUR IMPASSIONED COMMENTS TONIGHT. IN THE FACE OF SUCH HORRORS, TO FEEL POWERLESS IS INTOLERABLE. I GET THAT YOU'RE FRUSTRATED, ANGRY AND DESPERATE TO DO SOMETHING. IT MAKES SENSE. I THINK I UNDERSTAND WHY MANY PEOPLE ARE PUTTING SO MUCH IMPORTANCE ON THIS. IT MUST FEEL LIKE THE ONLY OR BEST WAY TO MAKE YOUR VOICE HEARD BECAUSE THERE ARE SO FEW OPTIONS. I GET THAT. I WANT TO MAKE IT CLEAR THAT I SYMPATHIZE WITH AND UNDERSTAND WHERE YOU ARE COMING FROM. BUT IF I HAD A BUTTON THAT I COULD PRESS TO END THIS HORRIFIC WAR I WOULD PRESS IT. I DO NOT HAVE SUCH A BUTTON. I DO NOT EVEN HAVE A BUTTON THAT CAN GET HOMES FOR THE HOMELESS IN BERKELEY.

>> MAYOR ISHII: FOLKS, PLEASE. ALLOW HER TO SPEAK.

>> S. O'KEEFE: DON'T WORRY, I'M A TEACH ER, I'M THE QUEEN OF "I'LL WAIT" BUT HOPEFULLY I WON'T NEED TO. BUT THAT ISSUE,

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HOMELESSNESS IS SOMETHING THAT OUR CITY GOVERNMENT CAN AND INDEED MUST HELP WITH, AND THAT'S ACTUALLY THE WORK THAT I SIGNED UP FOR WHEN I RAN FOR OFFICE. THAT WORK.

>> MAYOR ISHII: FOLKS, PLEASE.

>> S. O'KEEFE: WHEN I WAS A STUDENT AT BERKELEY HIGH SCHOOL, I FIRST BECAME AWARE OF CITY GOVERNMENT AND ITS ROLE IN MY LIFE. AND IT WAS THEN I LEARNED ABOUT BERKELEY'S PRACTICE OF WEIGHING IN ON INTERNATIONAL AFFAIRS. AND HONESTLY, IT CONFUSED AND BOTHERED ME, EVEN THEN. IT'S JUST, IT'S HOW I ORGANIZE MY UNDERSTANDING OF THE WORLD. AND I'VE ALWAYS BEEN DEEPLY ROOTED IN PRACTICALITY, AND TO ME, DOING THIS MADE NO SENSE, TO ME. AND WE CAN DISAGREE ABOUT THAT, AND THAT'S OKAY. I'VE FELT FOR A VERY LONG TIME THAT CITY COUNCIL SHOULD FOCUS ON LOCAL AFFAIRS AND THINGS THAT ARE WITHIN OUR SPHERE OF INFLUENCE. SO, I WILL BE ABSTAINING IF A MOTION IS MADE TO PASS THE P.J.C. RESOLUTION, I WILL BE ABSTAINING, BECAUSE I DON'T WISH TO COMMENT ON THE CONTENT. I JUST DON'T WANT TO COMMENT ON INTERNATIONAL AFFAIRS. HOWEVER, THANK YOU FOR THE -- I APPRECIATE IT. I WILL BE SUPPORTING COUNCILMEMBER TAPLIN'S RESOLUTION. I APPRECIATE --

>> MAYOR ISHII: FOLKS, FOLKS, PLEASE STOP CALLING HER NAMES. IT'S REALLY UNACCEPTABLE.

>> S. O'KEEFE: DO I LOOK LIKE A COWARD? ALL RIGHT.

>> MAYOR ISHII: FOLKS!

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>> S. O'KEEFE: I'M GOING TO GO AHEAD AND KEEP SAYING THAT I'M GOING TO SUPPORT COUNCILMEMBER TAPLIN'S RESOLUTION BECAUSE IT GOES OUT OF ITS WAY TO FOCUS ON BERKELEY, WHICH IS A MINIMUM REQUIREMENT FOR ME TO SUPPORT ANYTHING. THANK YOU FOR LISTENING. [APPLAUSE]

>> MAYOR ISHII: FOLKS. COUNCILMEMBER TAPLIN? FOLKS, PLEASE. PLEASE.

>> T. TAPLIN: THANK YOU VERY MUCH, MADAM MAYOR. JUST KEEP ME ABREAST IF THERE'S ANY DISCOURTESY.

>> YOU ARE --

>> T. TAPLIN: YEAH.

>> MAYOR ISHII: ALLOW HIM TO SPEAK.

>> T. TAPLIN: THANK YOU VERY MUCH, MADAM MAYOR. I WOULD LIKE TO THANK AND COMMEND THE MEMBERS OF THE JEWISH COMMUNITY AND OTHERS WHO LIVE IN MY DISTRICT AND THROUGHOUT THE CITY OF BERKELEY FOR COURAGE AND FORTITUDE SHARING THEIR VOICES AND EXPERIENCES TONIGHT DESPITE HARASSMENT, HECKLING AND EVERY ATTEMPT TO MAKE OUR SPACES HOSTILE FOR DIFFERENT VIEWPOINTS.

>> MAYOR ISHII: PLEASE STOP SPEAKING. SORRY, GO AHEAD, COUNCILMEMBER.

>> T. TAPLIN: NO WORRIES. I SAY THIS AS GENTLY AS POSSIBLE. THESE SYMBOLIC INTERNATIONAL RESOLUTIONS ARE SO -- AT BEST AND WORSE WASTEFUL DISTRACTION FROM THE LOCAL ISSUES WE ARE

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OBLIGATED AND AUTHORIZED TO ADDRESS WHILE HAVING ZERO IMPACT ON FOREIGN AFFAIRS AND SERVING NO OTHER PURPOSE THAN EXPOSING OUR COMMUNITY TO TRIGGER OF TRAUMA. SIX HOURS OF VITRIOL HAVE FAILED TO CONVINCE ME OTHERWISE. EXPRESS A TRUE WILL FOR LASTING PEACE. NO ONE IS GOING TO THREATEN OR FORCE ME INTO REGURGITATING LANGUAGE ON COMMAND IN PURSUIT OF A POLITICAL AGENDA THAT HAS NOTHING TO DO WITH LOCAL GOVERNANCE. I RAN ON UNWAVERING LASER SHARP FOCUS ON PRAGMATIC SOLUTIONS TO LOCAL PROBLEMS. THAT IS A PROMISE I HAVE MADE TWICE TO MY DISTRICT, TO MY CITY AND I'LL MAKE IT AGAIN. I'LL BE SUPPORTING MY RESOLUTION. THANK YOU.

[APPLAUSE]

>> MAYOR ISHII: COUNCILMEMBER, FOLKS? FOLKS? EXCUSE ME. COUNCILMEMBER KESARWANI HAD YOUR HAND UP BEFORE, DID YOU WANT TO SPEAK STILL?

>> R. KESARWANI: I WILL WAIT TO HEAR FROM OTHERS, I'M OKAY FOR NOW.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU, COUNCILMEMBER TREGUB? SHHHH, FOLKS.

>> I. TREGUB: THANK YOU TO ALL MEMBERS OF THE COMMUNITY WHO HAVE SPOKEN UP ON THIS ISSUE. SINCE THIS CONFLICT BEGAN AND WHO CAME OUT TONIGHT TO EXPRESS YOUR VIEWS.

>> MAYOR ISHII: COUNCILMEMBER, CAN YOU SPEAK UP A BIT, WE CAN'T HEAR YOU THAT WELL HERE.

>> I. TREGUB: YES, HOW IS THIS?

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>> MAYOR ISHII: IT'S BETTER, THANK YOU.

>> I. TREGUB: THANK YOU. MY OFFICE AND I HAVE MET WITH MANY OF YOU AND WHATEVER YOUR OPINION IS ABOUT WHICH, IF ANY RESOLUTIONS YOU PREFER WE VOTE ON TONIGHT, I HAVE LEARNED SOMETHING NEW FROM, AND WAS DEEPLY MOVED BY EACH OF THESE CONVERSATIONS. AS A JEWISH IMMIGRANT FROM UKRAINE, I KNOW HOW DEEPLY PERSONAL, PAINFUL AND COMPLICATED THESE CONVERSATIONS ARE. I COME TO THIS MOMENT WITH A COMMITMENT TO HONORING EVERY LIFE AND A BELIEF THAT OUR SHARED HUMANITY MUST GUIDE THE PATH FORWARD. I CARRY AND FEEL THE PAIN EXPRESSED BY SO MANY OF YOU. REGARDLESS OF WHERE WE COME FROM. THERE IS NO GOOD OUTCOME OTHER THAN A LASTING PEACE, A JUST PEACE, A PROMPT PEACE. I CANNOT SAY WHETHER THIS OR ANY RESOLUTION WILL BRING THAT. BUT I AM WILLING TO TAKE A STEP AND ADD MY VOICE IN THE HOPE OF MOVING US CLOSER TO ENDING THE VIOLENCE. I HAVE STRUGGLED AND WRESTLED MIGHTILY OF THE QUESTION IF THERE'S ANY LANGUAGE IN ANY RESOLUTION THAT CAN FULLY CAPTURE THE COMPLEXITY OF THE ISRAEL-HAMAS CONFLICT WHICH HAS ONLY BEEN EXACERBATED IN A DEEPLY PAINFUL WAY SINCE OCTOBER 7, 2023. A DAY THAT WILL FOREVER LIVE IN INFAMY. I WOULD LIKE TO THANK THE MAYOR FOR SUBMITTING A RESOLUTION THAT, WHILE NO RESOLUTION IS PERFECT, GOES A LONG WAY TOWARD TRYING TO CAPTURE THE BELIEFS OF A MAJORITY OF STAKEHOLDERS IN THE BERKELEY COMMUNITY. I ALSO APPRECIATE COUNCILMEMBER TAPLIN'S

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RESOLUTION. BECAUSE IT SAYS WHAT SO MANY OF US BELIEVE. THE BERKELEY CITY COUNCIL, AND THE MAYOR OF BERKELEY GRIEVE THE TERRIBLE LOSS OF LIFE AND EMPATHIZE WITH COMMUNITY MEMBERS WHOSE FAMILIES ARE IMPACTED BY THE CONFLICT, AND SHARE THEIR HOPE FOR A PROMPT, JUST AND ENDURING PEACE. TONIGHT, I AM READY TO VOTE IN ALIGNMENT WITH OUR SHARED BERKELEY VALUES, INCLUDING SUPPORT FOR THE DIGNITY, SECURITY, CIVIL RIGHTS AND SELF-DETERMINATION FOR ALL PEOPLE. MOST IMPORTANTLY, TONIGHT I AM READY TO VOTE JUST AS EVERY DAY AND NIGHT I YEARN, I PRAY FOR A PROMPT, JUST AND LASTING PEACE. THANK YOU. [APPLAUSE]

>> MAYOR ISHII: OKAY, COUNCILMEMBER LUNAPARRA?

>> C. LUNAPARRA: I UNDERSTAND THE SENTIMENT THAT THIS ISSUE IS OUTSIDE OF OUR PURVIEW GIVEN IT DOESN'T DIRECTLY RELATE TO BERKELEY, HOWEVER, THAT SEEMS TO WILLFULLY NEGLECT THE FOLLOWING, ONE OUR TAX DOLLARS ARE NOT ONLY FUNDING BUT FACILITATING THIS GENOCIDE IN GAZA. THIS IS ABOUT THE ROLE WE PLAY IN ENABLING SYSTEMIC VIOLENCE AND INJUSTICE. WE CA NOT DISTANCE OURSELVES FROM CONSEQUENCES WHERE OUR RESOURCES ARE BEING SPENT. TWO, WE HAVE SEEN DEVASTATING CONSEQUENCE OF INACTION TIME AND TIME AGAIN. WHEN OUR CITIZENS AREN'T HEARD IT LEADS TO A SENSE OF BETRAYAL. IT HAS FANNED THE FLAMES OF HATRED AND RESENTMENT WITHIN OUR OWN COMMUNITY. HATE CRIMES HAVE SURGED IN OUR MUSLIM, PALESTINIAN AND JEWISH RESIDENTS MANY OF WHOM

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HAVE CLOSE FAMILY TIES ARE LIVING IN FEAR, QUESTIONING WHETHER THEIR CITY STANDS WITH THEM IN THIS TIME OF CRISIS. DESPITE THE OBVIOUS PAIN AND DIVISION THIS BODY HAS FAILED TO TAKE ANY MEANINGFUL ACTION. THREE, THE CHAIN OF REPRESENTATION IS CRUCIAL, WE ARE MEANT TO SERVE OUR CONSTITUENTS FOR OVER A YEAR AND A HALF, MANY CONSTITUENTS JEWISH AND PALESTINIAN ALIKE HAVE BEEN PLEADING FOR US TO TAKE A STAND. MANY HAVE CALLED OUT FOR US TO SPEAK OUT OR USE POSITION TO AMPLIFY VOICES TO DEFEND LIVES OF FAMILIES AND COMMUNITIES BEING MASSACRED YET OUR SILENCE CONTINUES TO ECHO. THEY FEEL ABANDONED AS IF THEIR LIVES AND PAIN DON'T MATTER TO THIS COUNCIL. THEY FEEL BETRAYED BY A SYSTEM MEANT TO PROTECT THEM. THE COMMISSION OF OUR OWN APPOINTEES MADE IT CLEAR IT'S NOT JUST A MORAL IMPERATIVE, IT'S A RESPONSIBILITY WE CAN'T CONTINUE TO IGNORE, WHETHER OR NOT YOU BELIEVE THIS IS WITHIN THE SCOPE OF OUR DUTIES OUR CONSTITUENTS BELIEVE IT IS, THEY HAVE BEEN CLEAR IN THEIR CALLS FOR ACTION, IT'S OUR DUTY TO LISTEN AND RESPOND. COUNCILMEMBER TAPLIN'S SUPPLEMENTAL RESOLUTION CITES, THE CITY OF BERKELEY HAS NO JURISDICTION OVER FOREIGN AFFAIRS. HOWEVER JUNE 2022, THIS COUNCIL CORRECTLY UNANIMOUSLY ADOPTED A RESOLUTION CALLING FOR A CEASE FIRE IN UKRAINE. IF WE DON'T ADOPT THIS WE ARE PICKING AND CHOOSING WHICH WAR CRIMES. SIX, ENDING U.S. MILITARY SUPPORT WEAPONS TRANSFER TO ISRAEL IS THE BEST LEVERAGE WE HAVE. WE HAVE

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FAILED TO PASS A CEASE-FIRE RESOLUTION AND JOIN IN WITH [RAPIDLY NAMING SURROUNDING COMMUNITIES] THE CITY OF BERKELEY'S RENT STABILIZATION BOARD AND OUR CITY'S LARGEST PUBLIC UNION. IN REFUSING TO DO SO OUR CONSTITUENTS WATCHING A GENOCIDE BEING LIVE STREAMED HAVING THEIR FRIENDS AND FAMILY MEMBERS SLAUGHTERED, WHO SEE IMAGES OF DEAD CHILDREN EVERY DAY FEEL THEIR ELECTED OFFICIALS DO NOT CARE AND ARE NOT LISTENING. THIS HAS LED TO A FRACTURED COMMUNITY. IT'S CLEAR NOW OUR FASCIST FEDERAL GOVERNMENT WILL NOT CHANGE THEIR FOREIGN POLICY OBJECTIVES BECAUSE OF THE OPINION OF THE BERKELEY CITY COUNCIL. THE PURPOSE OF THIS RESOLUTION NOW IS TO SHOW OUR COMMUNITY WE ARE LISTENING. IT'S TO SHOW OUR NEIGHBORS IN STANDING UP TO WHAT IS RIGHT. RECENT POLLING SHOWS 71% OF DEMOCRATS SUPPORT AN ARMS EMBARGO AND I'M WILLING TO BET THAT NUMBER IS HIGHER IN BERKELEY. 62% OF JEWISH VOTERS WOULD SUPPORT UNITED STATES WITHHOLDING SHIPMENT TO ISRAEL UNTIL NETANYAHU AGREES TO PROPOSAL FOR AN IMMEDIATE CEASE FIRE. GESTURE SOMETHING OUR CONSTITUENTS WANT IS THE SAME PATERNALISM AND OUT OF TOUCH THAT FUELED -- IF WE CALL OURSELVES A CITY THAT VALUES PEACE, JUSTICE, AND HUMAN DIGNITY WE MUST STAND UP EVEN WHEN IT IS UNCOMFORTABLE AND INCONVENIENT. WE CAN DEMONSTRATE WE WILL NOT BE PASSIVE IN THE FACE. LET US SHOW OUR COMMUNITY WE ARE LISTENING, COMMITTED TO JUSTICE, AND NOT LET THEIR VOICES GO

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UNHEARD. I WANT TO READ AN ABBREVIATED VERSION OF A LETTER, DEAR BERKELEY CITY COUNCIL, MY NAME IS -- COHEN, FATHER OF THE HOSTAGE, NIMROD COHEN HELD IN TUNNELS FOR 18 MONTHS NOW. WE ARE CALLING FOR A HOSTAGE DEAL AND CEASE FIRE. WE KNOW THERE'S NO SENSE IN PROLONGING THE WAR, THE DECISION IS A POLITICAL REASON, DECISION OF NETANYAHU'S GOVERNMENT IS TO HAVE A PERMANENT MILITARY OCCUPATION ON THE GAZA STRIP TO BUILD SETTLEMENTS NOT TO RELEASE THE HOSTAGES. WHAT ISRAEL NEEDS IS A CEASE-FIRE, WHAT THE HOSTAGES NEED IS A CEASE-FIRE, IT'S GOOD FOR ISRAEL, THE HOSTAGES, IT'S GOOD FOR THE REGION, THANK YOU. [APPLAUSE]

>> MAYOR ISHII: FOLKS, THANK YOU. COUNCILMEMBER KESARWANI?

>> R. KESARWANI: THANK YOU VERY MUCH. AND I'M SORRY I COULDN'T BE THERE IN PERSON TONIGHT. CAN YOU HEAR ME?

>> MAYOR ISHII: YES, WE CAN HEAR YOU.

>> R. KESARWANI: OKAY, I WANT TO THANK THE MAYOR FOR HER LEADERSHIP IN MODERATING THIS MEETING. I KNOW IT'S BEEN CHALLENGING. I JUST WANT TO START BY ACKNOWLEDGING THE PROFOUND AND ONGOING SUFFERING IN GAZA AND SURROUNDING REGION. THE PAIN ETCHED IN THE LIVES OF PEOPLE THERE IS IMMENSE, A SHARED HUMAN TRAGEDY THAT DEMANDS OUR UNWAVERING ATTENTION AND EMPATHY. IT'S IMPOSSIBLE TO SPEAK OF THIS CONFLICT WITHOUT RECOGNIZING THE DEVASTATING IMPACT IT HAS HAD ON ALL CIVILIANS IN GAZA, FAMILIES HAVE ENDURED UNIMAGINABLE LOSS. HOMES HAVE BEEN REDUCED TO

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RUBBLE, DREAMS SHATTERED, AND THE FUNDAMENTAL RIGHT TO SAFETY AND SECURITY HAS BEEN CRUELLY DENIED. WE MOURN THE DEATHS OF INNOCENT MEN, WOMEN AND CHILDREN. THE DAILY STRUGGLE FOR SURVIVAL, THE LACK OF ACCESS TO BASIC NECESSITIES, AND CONSTANT FEAR HAVE CREATED A HUMANITARIAN CRISIS THAT WEIGHS HEAVILY ON OUR COLLECTIVE CONSCIENCE. SIMULTANEOUSLY, I BELIEVE WE MUST ACKNOWLEDGE THE DEEP-SEATED FEARS AND TRAUMA EXPERIENCED BY ISRAELIS, THE THREAT OF VIOLENCE AND THE PAIN OF LOSS ARE ALSO STARK REALITIES FOR COMMUNITIES LIVING IN THE SHADOW OF THIS CONFLICT. AND WE PRAY FOR THE SAFE RETURN OF HOSTAGES. THE YEARNING FOR SECURITY AND PEACE IS A FUNDAMENTAL HUMAN DESIRE THAT RESONATES DEEPLY. AS WE ALL KNOW, AS WE HEARD TONIGHT, AND I WANT TO THANK EVERYONE WHO GAVE PUBLIC COMMENT TONIGHT. THE HISTORY OF THIS CONFLICT IS COMPLEX AND DEEP-ROOTED. AND AS WE HAVE HEARD, TONIGHT AND ON OTHER OCCASIONS IT TOUCHES THE LIVES OF OUR RESIDENTS PROFOUNDLY. I HAVE SPENT HOURS LISTENING TO YOUR PUBLIC COMMENTS, NOT ONLY TONIGHT BUT DURING PRIOR MEETINGS FOR MORE THAN A YEAR. I HAVE READ YOUR EMAILS AND MET WITH YOU INDIVIDUALLY AND IN GROUPS. AND I APPROACH THIS ISSUE WITH AN INCREDIBLE AMOUNT OF HUMILITY. AND A DEEP FEELING OF DOUBT THAT IT COULD BE POSSIBLE TO ARRIVE AT A CONSENSUS STATEMENT ON SUCH A COMPLEX ISSUE. I AM ALSO SYMPATHETIC TO THOSE WHO POINT TO THE VERY REAL CHALLENGES WE FACE IN OUR OWN COMMUNITY. AND ASK US TO

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FOCUS ON THOSE LOCAL ISSUES. HOWEVER, NOW THAT THIS SPECIAL MEETING HAS BEEN CALLED, IT IS MY VIEW THAT BOTH THE MAYOR'S RESOLUTION AND THE RESOLUTION BY COUNCILMEMBER TAPLIN REFLECT OUR COMMUNITY'S CONSENSUS YEARNING FOR PEACE AND SECURITY AND I SUPPORT BOTH OF THOSE RESOLUTIONS. AND I HOPE THAT OUR SYMBOLIC ACTION TONIGHT MAY CONTRIBUTE TO A WORLD WHERE SUCH PROFOUND PAIN IS NO LONGER A REALITY. THANK YOU. [APPLAUSE]

>> MAYOR ISHII: COUNCILMEMBER TAPLIN, DO YOU HAVE A MOTION?

>> T. TAPLIN: DO YOU?

>> MAYOR ISHII: SORRY?

>> T. TAPLIN: I HAVE NOT MADE A MOTION.

>> MAYOR ISHII: DO YOU HAVE ONE?

>> T. TAPLIN: ARE THERE OTHER PEOPLE WAITING TO SPEAK?

>> MAYOR ISHII: WE'RE GOING TO TAKE A FIVE-MINUTE RECESS. [RECORDING STOPPED] [BREAK] [CROWD CHANTING "FREE PALESTINE”] [BREAK] [RECORDING IN PROGRESS] [CHEERS AND APPLAUSE]

>> MAYOR ISHII: FOLKS, PLEASE. PLEASE QUIET DOWN. WE'VE GOT 20 MINUTES LEFT IN THIS MEETING. COUNCILMEMBER LUNAPARRA, HAVE YOUR MIC ON.

>> C. LUNAPARRA: THANK YOU. FOR THE PURPOSES OF DISCUSSION I WOULD LIKE TO MAKE A MOTION TO MOVE TERRY, COUNCILMEMBER TAPLIN'S SUPPLEMENTAL RESOLUTION.

>> MAYOR ISHII: I'LL SECOND THAT. I WOULD ALSO LIKE TO MAKE A

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MOTION TO PUT FORWARD MY RESOLUTION.

>> B. BARTLETT: SECOND.

>> MAYOR ISHII: A SECOND FROM COUNCILMEMBER BARTLETT.

COUNCILMEMBER TAPLIN?

>> T. TAPLIN: YES, MADAM MAYOR, I'M WOND IRING WHETHER YOU WOULD ENTERTAIN SOME FRIENDLY AMENDMENTS TO YOUR RESOLUTION, I'M HAPPY TO SHARE SCREEN.

>> MAYOR ISHII: I'D BE CURIOUS TO HEAR WHAT THEY ARE, SEE WHAT THEY ARE.

>> T. TAPLIN: SURE, I CAN TAKE US THROUGH THEM. CAN SEE THIS?

>> MAYOR ISHII: YEAH, WE CAN. CAN YOU MAKE IT A LITTLE BIT BIG HE, PLEASE?

>> T. TAPLIN: YEAH. SO THE WHEREAS HATE HAS NO PLACE IN BERKELEY CLAUSE, I AM PROPOSING TO ADD THE TEXT IN RED, WHICH READS "WITH THE 2024 BERKELEY POLICE DEPARTMENT'S ANNUAL CRIME REPORT SHOWING ANTI-JEWISH INCIDENTS ACCOUNTING FOR ABOUT 20% OF HATE AND BIAS INCIDENTS AND ANTI-ARAB AND ANTI-MUSLIM INCIDENTS ACCOUNTING FOR 7 AND 5% RESPECTIVELY IN THE CITY OF BERKELEY. AND THE WHEREAS CLAUSE THAT INCLUDES THE DRAFT, HAVE IT READ WHEREAS INDIVIDUAL BERKELEY RESIDENTS AND MEMBERS OF BAY AREA GROUPS HAVE PREVIOUSLY PARTICIPATED IN PEACE AND UNIVERSAL HUMAN RIGHTS MOVEMENTS INCLUDING THE ANTI-VIETNAM, INDO CHINA WAR MOVEMENT, -- WHEREAS DECADES LONG CONFLICT BETWEEN ISRAELI

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GOVERNMENT AND SURROUNDING NATIONS IN THE REGION ESCALATED WITH THE TERRORIST ATTACK ON ISRAEL ON OCTOBER 7TH 2023. AND THE FOLLOWING CLAUSE, ISRAELI GOVERNMENT RESPONDED MILITARILY, THE REST IS THE SAME. AND THEN, SORRY THE FORMATTING GOT A LITTLE WEIRD. BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, CLAUSE I'M ADDING, PROPOSING WE ADD CALLS FOR PROMPT, JUST AND ENDURING PEACE IN ISRAEL AND PALESTINE. FOLLOWED BY THE BERKELEY CITY COUNCIL URGES COMPLIANCE WITH INTERNATIONAL HUMANITARIAN LAW AND CONDEMNS TARGETING OF NONCOMBATANTS, OBSTRUCTION OF HUMANITARIAN RELIEF, UNLAWFUL POPULATION TRANSFER, AND CONDEMNS THE USE OF HOSPITALS, SCHOOLS, CENTERS OF WORSHIP AND ALL CIVILIAN INFRASTRUCTURE FOR THE STATIONING OF COMBATANTS, THE STORING OF MUNITIONS AND COMMAND OF MILITARY OPERATIONS AND BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED CITY OF BERKELEY COUNCIL CONDEMNS ANTI-SEMITISM IN SCHOOLS AND ON UNIVERSITY CAMPUSES ACROSS THE NATIONAL AND IN BERKELEY AND CALLS UPON LEADERSHIP OF OUR EDUCATIONAL INSTITUTIONS UNIVERSITY OF CALIFORNIA, PERALTA COMMUNITY COLLEGE DISTRICT, BERKELEY UNI NEED SCHOOL DISTRICT TO PROTECT FREE SPEECH ON CAMPUSES, WHILE ALSO ADDRESSING RISING ANTI-SEMITISM AND ENSURING CAMPUSES ARE NOT MADE HOSTILE ENVIRONMENTS [READING PROPOSED AMENDMENTS] THOSE ARE MY PROPOSED AMENDMENTS.

>> MAYOR ISHII: COUNCILMEMBER, I THINK THAT'S TOO MANY THINGS TO TAKE IN FROM THE DAIS WE SPENT A LONG TIME WORKING ON A

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RESOLUTION. I'M SORRY, BUT I WILL HAVE TO DECLINE YOUR FRIENDLY AMENDMENT.

>> T. TAPLIN: I APPRECIATE THE OPPORTUNITY TO READ THEM. I AM DISAPPOINTED THAT THEY WILL NOT BE CONSIDERED. I DO APPRECIATE THE TIME YOU SPENT ON YOUR RESOLUTION. I ALSO SPENT TIME ON MINE. I RECOGNIZE WE ARE NOT IN A CIRCLE TOGETHER ON THIS ONE. BUT WITHOUT THOSE AMENDMENTS, I WILL NOT BE ABLE TO SUPPORT YOUR RESOLUTION. THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU, COUNCILMEMBER. AND I DO APPRECIATE THE TIME YOU SPENT ON YOURS AS WELL. I WOULD LIKE TO CALL THE QUESTION, UNLESS THERE'S OTHER HANDS RAISED. OKAY. ALL RIGHT. COUNCILMEMBER KESARWANI, DID YOU HAVE A COMMENT?

>> R. KESARWANI: YEAH, I ACTUALLY FIND THAT COUNCILMEMBER TAPLIN'S AMENDMENTS MAKE THE RESOLUTION STRONGER AND MORE BALANCED AND SO, I WOULD RESPECTFULLY REQUEST THEY ARE ALL INCLUDED.

>> MAYOR ISHII: I'M SORRY, I JUST SAID THAT I'M NOT ENTERTAINING THAT. I'M WONDERING IF THERE'S -- YOU ARE REQUESTING IT --

>> [OFF MIC]

>> MAYOR ISHII: SHHHH. OKAY.

>> CITY CLERK: SHOULD I CALL THE ROLL ON THE SUBSTITUTE MOTION, WHICH IS TO ADOPT THE RESOLUTION SUBMITTED BY MAYOR ISHII AND COUNCILMEMBER BARTLETT? SO CALLING THE ROLL ON THE SUBSTITUTE

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MOTION, COUNCILMEMBER KESARWANI?

>> R. KESARWANI: SO I'M SORRY, CAN YOU REPEAT, WHICH IS THE SUBSTITUTE MOTION?

>> CITY CLERK: THE RESOLUTION SUBMITTED BY MAYOR ISHII AND COUNCILMEMBER BARTLETT.

>> R. KESARWANI: AND THIS IS WITHOUT ANY OF THOSE AMENDMENTS THAT WERE JUST INTRODUCED BY COUNCILMEMBER TAPLIN?

>> CITY CLERK: CORRECT.

>> R. KESARWANI: OKAY, PASS.

>> CITY CLERK: COUNCILMEMBER TAPLIN?

>> T. TAPLIN: ABSTAIN.

>> CITY CLERK: BARTLETT?

>> B. BARTLETT: YES.

>> CITY CLERK: TREGUB?

>> I. TREGUB: AYE.

>> CITY CLERK: O'KEEFE?

>> S. O'KEEFE: ABSTAIN.

>> CITY CLERK: BLACKABY?

>> B. BLACKABY: NO.

>> CITY CLERK: LUNAPARRA?

>> C. LUNAPARRA: YES.

>> CITY CLERK: HUMBERT?

>> M. HUMBERT: ABSTAIN.

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>> CITY CLERK: MAYOR ISHII?

>> MAYOR ISHII: YES.

>> CITY CLERK: AND COUNCILMEMBER KESARWANI?

>> R. KESARWANI: ABSTAIN.

>> CITY CLERK: THAT MOTION FAILS. ON THE MAIN MOTION, WHICH IS COUNCILMEMBER TAPLIN'S RESOLUTION, AS SUBMITTED, COUNCILMEMBER KESARWANI?

>> R. KESARWANI: YES.

>> CITY CLERK: TAPLIN?

>> T. TAPLIN: YES.

>> CITY CLERK: BARTLETT?

>> MAYOR ISHII: PLEASE STOP. [CROWD CHANTING]

>> MAYOR ISHII: DECORUM. FOLKS, WE NEED TO FINISH THE ROLL. FOLKS! FOLKS, WE NEED TO FINISH THE VOTE. WE ARE RUNNING OUT OF TIME FOR THE MEETING. PLEASE SIT DOWN. FOLKS!

>> CITY CLERK: COUNCILMEMBER BARTLETT?

>> MAYOR ISHII: WE NEED TO FINISH TAKING THE ROLE.

>> CITY CLERK: COUNCILMEMBER BARTLETT?

>> MAYOR ISHII: I'M SORRY. COUNCILMEMBER BARTLETT? FOLKS!

>> MAYOR ISHII: FOLKS, PLEASE STOP.

>> CITY CLERK: COUNCILMEMBER TREGUB?

>> I. TREGUB: THIS IS ON THE --

>> MAYOR ISHII: EXCUSE ME, WE ARE TAKING THE ROLL. WE HAVE 15

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MINUTES LEFT.

>> CITY CLERK: ON THE TAPLIN RESOLUTION.

>> I. TREGUB: AYE.

>> CITY CLERK: TREGUB VOTES AYE. COUNCILMEMBER O'KEEFE?

>> MAYOR ISHII: FOLKS, IF YOU'RE NOT QUIET WE AREN'T GOING TO VOTE ON ANYTHING.

>> CITY CLERK: COUNCILMEMBER BLACKABY?

>> MAYOR ISHII: ALL RIGHT, WE ARE GOING -- SORRY, I'M GOING, WE ARE GOING TO -- WE ARE GOING TO STOP.

>> CITY CLERK: WHAT'S THAT? COUNCILMEMBER LUNAPARRA? ARE YOU VOTING? [CROWD CHANTING "NO JUSTICE, NO PEACE"]

>> CITY CLERK: COUNCILMEMBER LUNAPARRA, DO WISH TO REGISTER A VOTE? NO. COUNCILMEMBER HUMBERT? YES. MAYOR ISHII? [CROWD CHANTING "NO JUSTICE, NO PEACE"]

>> MAYOR ISHII: FOLKS, I ALREADY SAID, I'VE ALREADY SAID -- FOLKS. I'VE ALREADY SAID, I'VE ALREADY SAID THAT WE'RE GOING TO -- ALL RIGHT. THAT'S IT. OKAY. IS THERE A MOTION TO ADJOURN THEN? THERE'S A MOTION TO ADJOURN, IS THERE A SECOND? A SECOND.

>> SECOND.

>> CITY CLERK: TO ADJOURN, COUNCILMEMBER KESARWANI, TO ADJOURN?

>> MAYOR ISHII: COUNCILMEMBER KESARWANI, THERE'S A MOTION TO ADJOURN.

>> R. KESARWANI: YES.

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>> MAYOR ISHII: FOLKS. [CROWD CHANTING "NO JUSTICE, NO PEACE"]

>> T. TAPLIN: I CAN'T HEAR ANYTHING. [CROWD CHANTING "NO JUSTICE, NO PEACE"]

>> CITY CLERK: MAYOR ISHII HAS VOTED YES. THE MOTION PASSES. THE MOTION CARRIES. [CROWD CHANTING "NO JUSTICE, NO PEACE"]

>> MAYOR ISHII: THERE WAS A VOTE ALREADY.

>> CITY CLERK: COUNCILMEMBER KESARWANI TO ADJOURN.

>> MAYOR ISHII: DO YOU WANT TO KNOW WHAT'S GOING ON? YOU DON'T WANT TO KNOW WHAT'S GOING ON.

>> CITY CLERK: COUNCILMEMBER KESARWANI TO ADJOURN THE MEETING?

>> R. KESARWANI: YES.

>> CITY CLERK: TAPLIN TO ADJOURN THE MEETING?

>> T. TAPLIN: YES.

>> CITY CLERK: BARTLETT, TO ADJOURN? YES? TREGUB, TO ADJOURN?

>> I. TREGUB: AYE.

>> CITY CLERK: O'KEEFE? BLACKABY?

>> B. BLACKABY: YES.

>> CITY CLERK: LUNAPARRA?

>> C. LUNAPARRA: NO.

>> CITY CLERK: HUMBERT? MAYOR ISHII TO ADJOURN?

>> MAYOR ISHII: YES.

>> CITY CLERK: MEETING'S ADJOURNED.

[ADJOURNED 11:51 P.M.]

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